



ON HIS FIRST VISIT TO VALLEY, ENVOY SAYS 'INCREDIBLE STEPS' TAKEN TO MAKE UNION TERRITORY SAFE

J&K important part of India, will relook at travel warnings: US envoy in Srinagar

Conversation will be taken forward between Gor and Washington, and New Delhi and I, says Omar after meeting

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, August 19

IN A strong endorsement of New Delhi's long-standing position on Jammu & Kashmir, US Ambassador Sergio Gor, who was in Srinagar Wednesday on his maiden visit to the Valley, described J&K as "an important part of India" and signalled that Washington would review the situation in the Union Territory to downgrade and ease travel warnings for US citizens.

Gor met Chief Minister Omar Abdullah at his Gupkar Road residence, marking the

first standalone visit to the Valley by a serving US Ambassador since the abrogation of Article 370 in August 2019. In January 2020, Kenneth Juster, the then Ambassador, had visited the Valley as part of a government-facilitated delegation of foreign envoys.

Stating that he was "thrilled" to be in the Valley, Gor said, "This is an important part of India. I am here, visiting for the first time. It's an incredibly beautiful place."

He is expected to travel to Ladakh Thursday.

He said he had "a very

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



US Ambassador Sergio Gor with Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah in Srinagar on Wednesday. ANI

Post-Op Sindoor chill, message underlines Delhi stand, signal to Pak too

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 19

US AMBASSADOR Sergio Gor's declaration from Srinagar that Jammu and Kashmir is "an important part of India" is not just Washington's public affirmation of New Delhi's long-standing position on J&K, but it is also being seen as a message to Islamabad and Beijing, especially post the Pahalgam terror attack and Operation Sindoor.

A close confidant of President Donald Trump, Gor is also

his special envoy to South and Central Asia. His meeting with Chief Minister Omar Abdullah signals both acknowledgement and engagement with J&K's first elected government post the 2019 constitutional changes.

For New Delhi, this has significance given that the India-US chill was precipitated by the India-Pak conflict amid Trump's repeated claims of brokering the ceasefire following Operation Sindoor last year. From Srinagar, however,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Congress leaders Sonia Gandhi, Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi at the CWC meeting in New Delhi, Wednesday. ANIL SHARMA

Cong invokes Tagore, Mahatma: Will sing only first 2 stanzas of Vande Mataram

Party firms up strategy to corner Govt over paper leaks, 'theft' at Ram temple

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, August 19

DAYS AFTER the Congress was embroiled in a controversy over the rendition of the national song, the Congress Working Committee (CWC) on Wednesday decided that the party will only sing the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram at its programmes.

The Congress's highest decision-making body cited a 1937 CWC resolution to back its stand, arguing that the leading lights of the freedom movement, including Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore, had backed limiting the public rendition of Vande Mataram to its first two stanzas.

Following a CWC meeting convened by the All India Congress Committee (AICC) chief, Mallikarjun Kharge, at the party

INSIDE PAGE 6
BJP HITS BACK: 'CONG NEW MUSLIM LEAGUE'

headquarters Indira Bhavan in Delhi, AICC general secretary in charge of organisation K C Venugopal told a press conference that there was "no confusion" over the rendition of Vande Mataram within the Congress.

"The Congress president (Kharge) categorically said it yesterday. It was clarified. But again today, it was discussed by the Congress Working Committee. Our stand is very clear. The CWC resolution of 1937... Mahatma Gandhi, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, Rabindranath Tagore, Subhas Chandra Bose and Sardar Patel. We will abide by the decision taken by them."

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

GS-II
BY DR. SATVIK BHAN
Starting from
23rd
August, 2026
9540886666
B-20, 2nd Floor, ORN, New Delhi

Happening today

● **UNION HOME** Minister Amit Shah will chair the 31st meeting of the Southern Zonal Council in Tamil Nadu's Mamallapuram.

● **A NINE-JUDGE** Constitution Bench will pronounce its verdict on reference against expansive definition given to "industry" in Industrial Disputes Act, 1947.

● **FINANCE MINISTER** Nirmala Sitharaman will lead a ministerial delegation for the fourth India-Singapore Ministerial Round-table, a key platform for discussions on bilateral economic and strategic cooperation.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



EXPRESS investigation

Workers protesting for higher wages got over 50 days on average in jail — until courts stepped in

April protests in Noida met with police crackdown; courts granted relief in 84% bail pleas on FIRs with substantive allegations: 'mere presence not enough to deny bail, specific evidence needed, can't equate workers with instigators'

Drishti Jain & Kaunain Sheriff M
New Delhi, August 19

IT'S A tale of two protests — and two very different outcomes.

Last month, the Jantar Mantar protest demanding a leak-proof exam system ended with the Union Education Minister's resignation and an assurance by the Centre and states that the police will not pursue any case against the protesters.

In sharp contrast, the week-long protest starting April 10 by factory workers in private firms in neighbouring Noida, demanding higher wages, got no such assurance. Indeed, a police crackdown saw up to 200 people taken into custody, including two booked under the stringent National Security Act (NSA), which allows detention without trial for up to a year. On April 14, the UP government raised the wages (see page 7) but it took the courts to grant relief to most of the jailed protesters.

The Indian Express investigated 106 arrests with substantive allegations, ranging from rioting and arson to attempt to murder — the average period a protester spent in custody was 53 days. These arrests led to 222 bail orders linked to seven FIRs. The investigation revealed that relief was granted in as many as 188, or 84 per cent. Significantly, the orders had a consistent



ON BAIL: 19-year-old says stepped out for food, was arrested; (right) 20-year-old says picked up from lane outside home. PRAVEEN KHANNA

● 106 arrests, days in jail

FIR No	Max	Min	Avg
151	74	8	32
149	81	25	36
164	118	49	89
165	105	34	71
169	120	25	54
172	81	27	35

DATA FOR FIR NO. 163/2026 NOT AVAILABLE

ent pattern. Judges repeatedly found that the police case rests on treating a crowd as the accused, rather than establishing what any one worker actually did.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Parents now ring up six times a day, worrying the police would pick me up again"

REPORTS PAGE 7

Where bail denied: Govt slapped NSA, cited book, library, articles and Gaza

Drishti Jain & Kaunain Sheriff M
New Delhi, August 19

IN THE Noida labour protests, where nearly eight of every 10 people arrested have got bail, those denied relief face a common accusation: an alleged role in the conspiracy.

Books read, WhatsApp texts, and participation in Gaza and NRC protests have all been cited as evidence, with police even using the term "andolan-

jeevi" in one case.

Those denied bail include activists, a former journalist and a Delhi University graduate — the latter two held under the draconian National Security Act (NSA), which permits detention of up to a year without trial.

On May 13, nearly a month after the protests turned violent, UP invoked the NSA against Satyam Verma, a 60-year-old former journalist from

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

'CONFLICT OF INTEREST' Can look at more safeguards: Ministry on deep tech fund

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, August 19

WHILE MAINTAINING that the safeguards on avoiding conflict of interest in the disbursement of Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund were fairly robust, Science and Technology Minister Jitendra Singh on Wednesday said the government was open to considering suggestions for strengthening the process further.

Singh's remarks, made at the monthly meeting of Secretaries of scientific departments under his charge, come in the wake of an investigative report by The Indian Express earlier this month that showed that 15 of the 22 private companies selected for the first round of funding from the RDI Fund had investment ties to seven members of the selection panel, raising questions of conflict of interest and propriety.

Though the panel members concerned had declared their interest and recused themselves from evaluating the company they had a stake in, as per the guidelines, the matter underlined the need for additional safeguards in the system.

At Wednesday's meeting, Singh reviewed all the procedural safeguards being adopted to avoid a conflict of interest situation, and emphasised that due diligence and verification

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NATION PAGE 8 BANGLADESHIS AMONG 9 KILLED IN KOLKATA HOTEL BLAZE

● SONIPAT ACADEMY SET UP BY FORMER INDIA PLAYER PRITAM RANI SIWACH SENDS FOUR WOMEN TO ONGOING WORLD CUP

She captained Team India, now son in Hockey World Cup — via her academy

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 19

THE 1998 Hockey World Cup in the Netherlands gave former India captain Pritam Rani Siwach one of the fondest chapters of her career. Twenty-eight years later, the same tournament and the same country have given her another memory to cherish: watching her son, Yashdeep, make his World Cup debut, making them the first mother-son duo to play in the marquee event.

Pritam has another reason to cheer. Besides Yashdeep, a defender, there are four players in India's women's squad at the

ongoing Hockey World Cup — defender Jyoti, midfielders Neha Goyal and Shilpi Dabas, and teenage forward Sakshi Rana — from the academy that she and her husband, Kuldeep, set up in Haryana's Sonipat.

Five World Cup players. One academy. One hockey family. "It's a big tournament. Yashdeep is playing in the same country where I also played my first World Cup. It is special," Pritam, 51,

tells The Indian Express. "Mazdoor jab ghar banata hai, toh banata hi rehata hai" (When labourers build a home, they just keep building). That's what I am doing. Coaching is my

passion. I don't see it as my son playing the tournament. My daughters are there, too. There's no difference for me."

Over the years, Pritam and Kuldeep have quietly built one of India's most productive talent pipelines for women's hockey — Yashdeep, too, trained at the academy in his early years, before moving on to a men's academy. The Pritam Siwach Academy, which once stood on land used for grazing cattle, is now a breeding ground for elite players, producing internationals such as Neha Goyal, Nisha Warsi and Sharmila Devi.

The couple have relied less on infrastructure and more on persistence, providing young



Yashdeep Siwach with mother Pritam, a former India captain, and father Kuldeep, a hockey coach.

players with coaching, equipment and, just as importantly, a space to train consistently.

Yet, for all the players she has helped shape, there was one who Pritam never intended

to coach: her own son.

One of Indian sport's earliest supermoms, Pritam never stopped going to the hockey ground throughout her pregnancy — initially training lightly before coaching the players there.

Seven months after Yashdeep was born, she was back chasing her own dream. She was summoned for the Manchester Commonwealth Games selection trials after deciding to make a comeback to the national team. She shed 18 kg in three or four months to earn her place in the squad that went on to win India's famous gold medal.

Pritam eventually set up the academy in Sonipat. But when it came to her son, she wanted

a different path.

Yashdeep occasionally accompanied her to the training ground, but she encouraged him to try other sports. She also worried that if he made the national team, his selection would be viewed through the prism of his mother's influence, even if he had earned it on merit.

So, Yashdeep turned to swimming. Given the sporting genes in the family — his father was also a hockey player and his sister, Kanika, currently plays for India — it was hardly surprising that he excelled. Then, one winter, the swimming pools shut. Yashdeep picked up a hockey stick to pass time, and soon found himself hooked.

Yashdeep may have been late to structured hockey, but the sport itself was hardly new to him. "Since childhood, I have been surrounded by hockey. At home, our dinner table conversations would revolve around the game and if I accompanied my parents to their work, it would be at a hockey field," he had told The Indian Express in an earlier interview. "That atmosphere really helped me grasp the sport faster."

Meanwhile, Pritam and Kuldeep continued to scout and train players from across Haryana, moulding them into India stars. Many like Neha, whose mother worked at a

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

3 CNG station employees killed as truck’s tank explodes during refuelling

Pragynesh
New Delhi, August 19

THREE EMPLOYEES at a CNG station died in Outer Delhi’s Tikri Kalan on Wednesday afternoon and three people were injured as the gas tank of a truck exploded when it was being refuelled.

The employees, their families claimed, were not rushed to hospital despite the seriousness of the injuries until they arrived at the station. While relatives of the staff have also claimed that the fuel station was recently closed for repairs due to incidents of CNG leak, police said that they are still verifying whether the blast happened due to a malfunction in the vehicle or a leak. A case would be registered as per the findings of the probe, said officers.

According to the Delhi Fire Service, the incident was reported at 3:47 pm at the CNG pump. Officials said that the truck’s gas tank exploded when a CNG pipe was being connected to it. Four fire tenders were rushed to the spot, located near the Tikri Kalan Metro station. The station was cordoned off. The fuel station employees who died were identified as Manish, Brahamjeet and Sunny.



The CNG station where the truck cylinder exploded at Tikri Kalan area in New Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

The driver of the vehicle, a Tata truck, is among those injured. Apart from the truck, a scooter and a Eeco car also suffered damage.

Families mourn

Manish, 25, was a resident of Baba Haridas Colony in West Delhi. “He was the one refuelling the truck,” said a senior police officer. When Manish’s friend Ashish and uncle Vijay Prasad got a call about him getting injured, they rushed from their homes in Baba Haridas Nagar, assuming that he would be in the hospital by the time

they reach. “For half an hour, he was lying there at the station. He had severe burn injuries... We had to take him to the hospital,” said Ashish. Manish, father of a five-month-old, got married last year. He had taken up the job just eight months ago and fed a family of five, including his elderly parents, according to the relatives. Ashish also claimed that Manish had been talking about leaks at the station for some days.

“He and the others were even given leave as repair work was going on,” he added. Brahamjeet’s nephew,

Aditya, said that he got a call at about 4:30 pm that he had been critically injured. “I went to the station but an ambulance had not arrived even then. I took him to the Jeevan Jyoti Hospital in Bahadurgarh. I don’t know what to tell his wife and kids,” he said.

The third deceased, Sunny, 30, who lived in Nizampur area, had been working at the station for three years, and lived with his parents, widowed sister-in-law and her children. “He was the sole breadwinner. Finally he had some savings, and we were thinking of getting him married,” said Balraj, Sunny’s uncle.

Delhi SIR schedule revised third time, final rolls to be released on November 4

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, August 19

THE TIMELINE for the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in Delhi was revised for the third time on Wednesday after the exercise was launched with door-to-door distribution of enumeration forms among voters on June 30. This is the second time within this month that the Capital saw a revision in the SIR schedule.

The deadlines for the publication of the draft and final electoral rolls have been pushed by a week.

While the rationalisation and rearrangement of polling stations was originally scheduled to be completed by August 17, the deadline has been pushed to August 24.

The draft electoral roll will now be published on August 31, instead of August 24. The final rolls will be published on November 4, instead of October 27, as per the revised timeline.

Officials said the revision in the schedule is aimed at giving

• Revised deadlines	
Rationalisation of polling stations	August 24
Release of draft rolls	August 31
Filing claims, objections	August 31 to September 30
Notice phase for disposal of claims, objections	August 31 to October 29
Release of final rolls	November 4



authorities more time for the rationalisation of polling stations.

The SIR enumeration phase got over on Monday. During the close to one-and-a-half month long process, forms of 97.51 lakh electors - about 67% of the 1.45 crore electors recorded initially when the SIR exercise began in Delhi - had been collected and uploaded to the official portal, as per the data from the office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO). The remaining 47.58 lakh electors, constituting about 33% of the electorate — who were absent, may have moved or died; are covered under duplicate entries, or “Other” reasons — were

marked “uncollectible” and will have their names struck off.

This indicates that the names of roughly one out of every three electors in the Capital are expected to be deleted from the draft roll.

The revised schedule shifts the window for filing claims and objections from August 24-September 23 to August 31-September 30.

The notice phase for the disposal of claims and objections has also been extended from August 24-October 22 period to August 31 to October 29.

This revision comes after the Election Commission had or-

dered two previous extensions to the SIR due to the slow progress on digitisation of enumeration forms.

However, Delhi’s estimated 33% deletions at the draft stage is less than the other major metro cities. Bengaluru is set to see around 45% deletions, Hyderabad 41% deletions and Mumbai is set to see roughly 35% deletions.

The final number of exclusions from the electoral roll will be known only on November 4 when the final electoral rolls will be published.

Electors who may have submitted forms with incomplete details will get notices over the next two months asking for proof of their eligibility to remain on the electoral rolls. Some of them might be added back to the rolls.

The ECI has also said that genuine electors who may have been deleted in the draft rolls can be added to the final roll in the one-month claims-and-objection period as fresh electors.

Can’t use all construction rights? Delhi Master Plan 2047 lets you sell them

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, August 19

IF YOU cannot use all the construction rights available on your plot, Delhi’s new Master Plan will allow you to sell unused rights to another developer who can use them for a different plot. This is the idea behind Transferable Development Rights (TDR), a new provision in the Master Plan for Delhi (MPD)-2047, which was approved by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) last week.

The MPD is awaiting final approval and notification from the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).

TDR has been used extensively in Mumbai, particularly to accelerate slum rehabilitation and redevelopment. According to research by think tank Observer Research Foundation (ORF), more than 8 crore sq ft of slum TDR were used by developers to build towers and redevelop housing societies in suburban Mumbai over a period of two decades until 2021.

In Delhi, the DDA aims to use this market-based mechanism that is designed to incentivise private property owners and to encourage them to participate in heritage preservation and slum rehabilitation efforts.

Under the new TDR mechanism, these unused development rights can be used on another plot, or sold to another developer

on a part of slum land, and the remaining portion can be developed commercially and sold.

The idea is that the developer will recover the cost of building homes for slum residents through the profits from this commercial, or “free sale”, component. Since many slums are located on high-value land in parts of central Delhi, the model is expected to work.

However, a developer may not be able to use all the development rights available to build flats, shops, or offices for profit because of the size or location of the land parcel in question, or due to height restrictions.

Under the new TDR mechanism, these unused development rights can be used on another plot, or sold to another developer.

The site from which TDR originates will be termed the ‘Generating Site’, while the site where it is utilised will be called the ‘Receiving Site’.

The potential for unused rights is very significant because the new MPD provides a Floor Area Ratio (FAR) of 500 for slum rehabilitation, which allows for the building of highrises.

FAR determines how much total floor space can be built on a plot. Consider a land parcel of 2,000 sq m. If the builder builds his building covering just 50% of the land and has a FAR of 500, then he will be able to build 10 floors, each with an area of 1,000 sq m. With the same FAR, if the builder uses just 25% of the land for building, he will be able to build 20 floors of 500 sq m each.

The additional building rights (TDR) are likely to be used in Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) zones, which already have a FAR of 500.

will be transferable among properties.

However, these rights can be used only in designated ‘Receiving Areas’ which will be identified by the DDA from time to time. These are expected to include areas notified for transit-oriented development, including areas on both sides of Metro corridors. This geographical limitation is expected to ensure that development remains controlled and aligned with the city’s planning objectives.

A dedicated portal to trade TDRs

DDA will create a dedicated single-window portal to facilitate the trading of TDRs. This portal, a key feature of the new mechanism, is expected to streamline the process of buying, selling, and utilising development rights across the city.

A joint government-industry task force set up by the previous Lieutenant Governor V K Saxena in 2024 too had recommended a provision in the new slum policy along these lines.

“Private developers are incentivised to participate in slum redevelopment by granting them additional Floor Space Index (FSI). This additional FSI can be used for commercial purposes or sold in the open market, making the projects financially viable for developers,” the task force had said.

On run for 8 months, man caught after 2-km on-foot chase by police

Accused of holding scrap dealer captive and demanding Rs 2 crore ransom

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 19

HE THOUGHT he could give police the slip. But when Mohammed Wamiq took off in New Ashok Nagar on Tuesday after noticing a team of officers waiting for him, a nearly 2-km on-foot chase followed — ending his eight-month run from the law. Wamiq, the alleged mastermind of a January 2 abduction in which a 44-year-old scrap dealer was held captive and his family was asked to pay Rs 2 crore, was arrested on Tuesday, police said.

The chase began after a NDR Crime Branch team, acting on technical surveillance and local intelligence, tracked Wamiq to Southeast Delhi.

He was allegedly heading to New Ashok Nagar to meet his girlfriend when he noticed the police team and tried to flee. “The officers chased him on foot for nearly 2 km before apprehending him,” said DCP Chander Kumar Singh said.

Wamiq, who had been on the run since January, was declared a proclaimed offender by a court in March. Police said Nizamuddin, the scrap dealer, was abducted while he was travelling from his Delhi home to his factory in Ghaziabad.

Five men allegedly stopped

his vehicle near Okhla Metro station and forced him into a white Tata Punch.

“The accused allegedly made him inhale an unidentified substance, leaving him semi-conscious,” said the DCP.

Wamiq then called Nizamuddin’s house and demanded a ransom of Rs 2 crore and threatened to kill him if it was not paid.

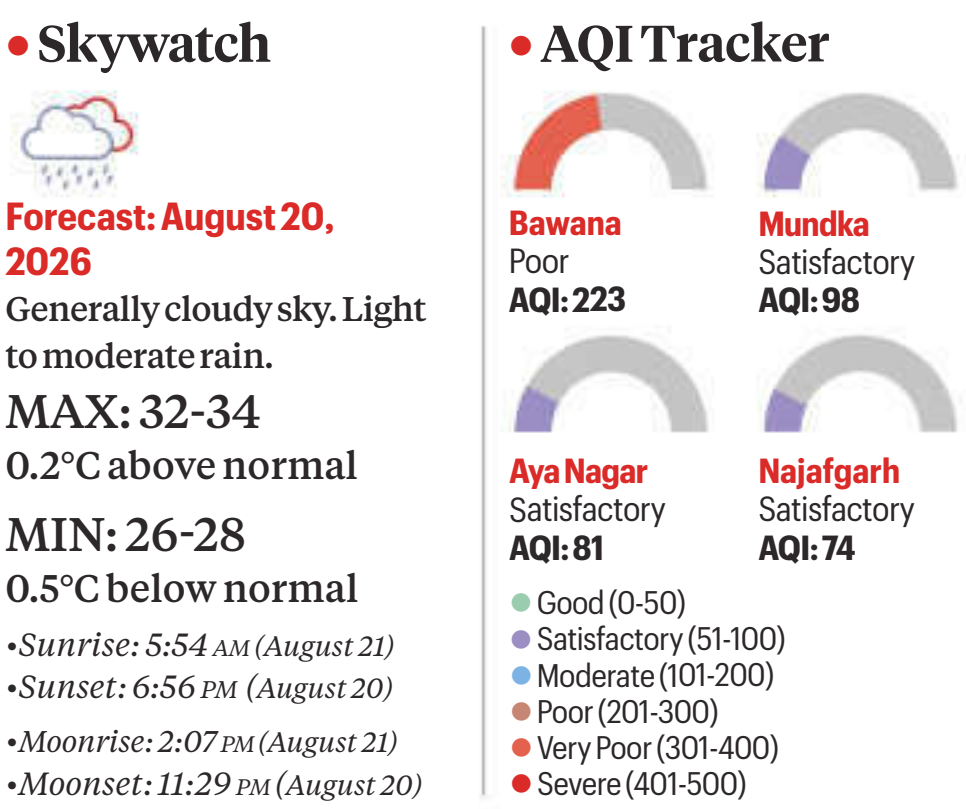
However, police said, Nizamuddin managed to escape when the vehicle stopped at a petrol pump. He jumped out, raised an alarm and fled before reaching his factory. He then approached the Shaheen Bagh police station, where an FIR was registered.

Police said Wamiq knew Nizamuddin and was aware that he could arrange a substantial ransom. He allegedly contacted his associates and arranged the Tata Punch used in the crime.

While three other accused — Rizwan, Taiyab and Ayaz Khan alias Bhura — were arrested in January, Wamiq and another accused, Noman, absconded and were declared proclaimed absconders. A reward of Rs 20,000 each was announced for information leading to their arrest. During questioning, Wamiq allegedly told police that he and Noman fled Delhi for Kotdwar after the incident. While Noman later travelled to Bengaluru, Wamiq remained in Kotdwar before returning to Delhi on August 18. Police said Wamiq had previously been involved in four criminal cases related to theft, robbery, cheating and Arms Act offences in Uttar Pradesh. He also ran a salon in Faridabad, which he shut last December after suffering losses.



Several parts of Delhi were lashed by rain on Wednesday. TASHI TOBYGAL



Aeronautical Development Agency
(Ministry of Defence, Govt. of India)
PB No. 1718, Vimanapura Post, Bangalore-560017

ADA:ADV-138:2026 **Date: 17-08-2026**

CANCELLATION

SUB: ENGAGEMENT OF PROJECT ASSISTANTS ON TENURE BASIS

Advertisement No. ADA:ADV:138:2026 dated 03.08.2026 for Engagement of Project Assistants on tenure basis at ADA stands cancelled due to administrative reasons.

Director (Admin & HR), ADA

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, पटना
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna
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No.: FTS-15070(XV)/Deputation/2026 Dated: 11.08.2026

VACANCY NOTICE ON DEPUTATION

Applications are invited in prescribed pro-forma from eligible Officers of Central/State Government/U.T/ Autonomous Bodies/Universities/Public Sector Undertaking/ Ministries /R&D Organization/Police Departments of Central/State/U.T/Armed Forces including Para Military Forces as applicable for filling up the following Group 'A' Posts on Deputation Basis at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna. The essential qualification, experience etc. required for applying for these posts are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Pay Matrix & Level	No. of post(s)
01.	Superintending Engineer	Level-13 (₹ 1,23,100 - ₹ 2,15,900)	1
02.	Chief Librarian	Level-13 (₹ 1,23,100 - ₹ 2,15,900)	1
03.	Senior Analyst (System Analyst)	Level-12 (₹ 78,800 - ₹ 2,09,200)	1
04.	Deputy Chief Security Officer	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 - ₹ 2,08,700)	1
05.	Hospital Architect	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 - ₹ 2,08,700)	1
06.	Senior Procurement-cum-Stores Officer	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 - ₹ 2,08,700)	1
07.	Executive Engineer (AC & R)	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 - ₹ 2,08,700)	1
08.	Executive Engineer (Electrical)	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 - ₹ 2,08,700)	1
09.	Chief Medical Social Service Officer	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 - ₹ 2,08,700)	1
10.	CSSD Officer	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 - ₹ 2,08,700)	1
11.	Senior Dietician (Assistant Food Manager)	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹ 1,77,500)	2
12.	Accounts Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹ 1,77,500)	3*
13.	Security Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹ 1,77,500)	1
14.	Chief Medical Record Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹ 1,77,500)	1
15.	Supervising Medical Social Service Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹ 1,77,500)	1

*** Two (02) posts are tentative, in anticipation of non-continuation of currently working two Accounts Officers.**

The last date for posting the completed application in the prescribed proforma along with required documents through proper channel is up to **30 days from the publication of the advertisement on the official website of AIIMS Patna** i.e. www.aiimspatna.edu.in. The format of application and details regarding age, qualifications, experience and other information to the posts are available on the official website of AIIMS Patna i.e. www.aiimspatna.edu.in. All further addendum, corrigendum and notifications, if any, will be available on the Institute's website www.aiimspatna.edu.in.

Sd/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Patna

EXPRESS Careers

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Advanced Stroke Centre, Christian Medical College, Ludhiana
Principal Investigator : Prof. Jeyaraj Pandian

JOB POSITION	QUALIFICATION/EXPERIENCE	VACANCY
Project Scientist III (Medical)	Post Graduate Degree in Medical Sciences, including integrated PG Degrees.	(1)
Project Scientist I (Non-Medical)	Post Graduate Degree in Non-Medical Sciences, including integrated PG Degrees.	(1)
Project Technical Support-III	Three Years' graduate in Science/ Commerce/IT with three relevant years' experience in relevant field OR Post Graduate Degree in Science/ Commerce/IT ; Good knowledge of Computer including proficiency in MS Excel, MS Word & MS Power Point.	(2)

Last date for Submission of Application : 28th August 2026.
Please submit your CV to the undersigned: CARneuro2025@gmail.com and jeyaraj.pandian@cmcludhiana.in

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Defence flags 27-month delay in arrest as court sends Jain to judicial custody

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, August 19

THE 27-MONTH delay between the registration of the FIR and the arrest of former Delhi minister and AAP leader Satyendar Jain and four others came under sharp focus in court on Wednesday, with the defence arguing that the accused had joined the investigation whenever called. The court, however, said their earlier cooperation did not prevent the investigating officer (IO) from arresting them later, and that the investigating agency's decision to arrest could not be "lightly brushed aside".

The court, however, rejected Jain's plea challenging his arrest and sent him and the other accused to two weeks of judicial custody a day after they were arrested by the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) in a multi-crore sewage treatment plant (STP) tender fraud. It also granted the ACB two-day police custody of former Delhi Jal Board (DJB) contractual consultant Ankit Shrivastava.

"Even though the accused persons may have joined investigation at earlier instances whenever called by the investigating agency, but merely on that ground today it cannot be claimed that the IO could not have arrested the accused when they lastly appeared before him. The subjective satisfaction of the investigating

• Other cases against Satyendar Jain

MONEY LAUNDERING CASE: Accused of laundering money through four firms linked to him when he was a minister in the Delhi government. Jain was arrested by the Enforcement Directorate on May 30, 2022. The case was based on a CBI FIR lodged against the AAP leader in 2017 under the Prevention of Corruption Act.

• After spending over 18 months, he walked out of Tihar jail in October 2024 when a Delhi court granted him bail and stated that the trial in the case was unlikely to commence soon.

• In the CBI case against him, Jain had already been granted regular bail by a trial court on September 6, 2019.

CCTV PROJECT CASE: In March 2025, the Anti-Corruption Branch booked Jain over alleged corruption in a Rs

571-crore CCTV project. Officials said he allegedly accepted a bribe of Rs 7 crore to waive off the liquidated damages (LD) penalty of Rs 16 crore imposed on Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL), which was installing CCTV cameras in the Capital.

PWD HIRING CASE: Jain was also booked in a case relating to alleged irregularities in hiring in the Public Works Department (PWD). This was one of the first major corruption cases filed against any senior leader of the AAP. After almost four years of investigation, the CBI reached the conclusion that there were no irregularities in recruitment, and no one had made any pecuniary gains. A Delhi court in August 2025 accepted a closure report filed by the CBI against Jain in the case.

NIRBHAY THAKUR

The others sent to judicial custody are Nagendra Yadav, proprietor of AN Enterprises; Raj Kumar Kurra, owner of Euroteck Environment Private Limited (EEPL) and Pankaj Verma, proprietor of Srijanhar.

The court issued notice on the bail applications filed by Jain and the others and listed the matter for hearing on August 25.

During the hearing, the defence flagged the delay in ar-

rest. "May 10, 2024, is the FIR date. The arrest has happened 27 months later. In the entire period, I have been called just once for questioning... this arrest was not justified and it is completely illegal," senior advocate N Hariharan said on behalf of Jain.

Senior advocate Maninder Singh, representing Yadav, added, "A premier investigating agency like ACB decides to arrest someone who is not arrested by the ED when a chargesheet was filed by them. This is a mockery. You assure people you're doing investigation and then you arrest them by evening. Grounds of arrest are a sham. I joined investigation when called via notices. They haven't mentioned the reason in the entire grounds of arrest. Law can't work on whims and fancies."

Advocate Rajat Bharadwaj, appearing for Shrivastava, argued that the accused had complied with notices issued under Section 41A of the CrPC, but the grounds of arrest did not disclose this.

"...There's a clear cut case of suppression and intentional concealment. In grounds of arrest, it is not disclosed that a 41A notice was issued. The grounds should say, 'after August 5, this is why we've arrested the accused'," he said.

The ACB, represented by Public Prosecutor Manish Rawat, alleged that Jain had or-

chestrated a multi-crore scam by manipulating tender conditions for the upgradation of five STPs in 2022.

According to ACB's remand papers submitted before the court on Wednesday, Jain, in collusion with former DJB CEO Udit Prakash Rai, allegedly enforced restrictive technical specifications - including unpiloted Integrated Fixed-Film Activated Sludge (IFAS) technology and strict oxygen transfer efficiency requirements - while deliberately omitting mandatory environmental safeguards prescribed by the CPCB.

On the agency seeking police custody of Shrivastava, the court said, "His police custody is indeed necessary for fair investigation, for recovery of his mobile phone which would be a crucial piece of evidence; his custodial interrogation is also necessary to unearth the other aspects of the conspiracy..."

A defence counsel, meanwhile, pointed out that an STP using similar technology had been installed in Surat and had become a model for the rest of the country. "IFAS technology was introduced pursuant to directions of the Supreme Court and the National Company Law Tribunal," the counsel added.

"Their case is that because you restricted it to this technology... therefore the cartelisation and therefore the corruption," Bharadwaj said.

proximately Rs 123 crore," it added. The agency called the decision of Jain "arbitrary" and "taken without adequate technical justification".

Link to Euroteck

According to sources in the ACB, Jain first met Kurra at his office in August 2021 regarding the deal. This was followed by a process in which Kurra allegedly secured the tender with the help of the other accused.

Further, the agency alleged that on December 22, 2021, a day after one of the meetings involving Jain and senior DJB officials, Euroteck entered into an agreement with Srijanhar Enterprises, a proprietorship concern of Verma, appointing it as an "authorised marketing agent entitled to receive commission at the rate of 3% of payments received by Euroteck from DJB tender works".

Verma is the nephew of Vinod Chauhan, who is a neighbour of Jain, the agency alleged.

Money trail

The ACB has so far traced around Rs 16 crore through cash transactions and bank transfers involving companies owned by Yadav and Verma, sources said. These transactions allegedly involved intermediaries known to Jain and Rai.

The agency has said that Rai had received bribes worth Rs 1.52 crore in his own and his relatives' bank accounts through banking channels linked to a company owned by Yadav.

EXPRESS special

From congestion to roadside parking, Delhi traffic police to target 'problem areas'

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, August 19

DELHI POLICE Commissioner Anurag Kumar has asked the traffic wing to draw up an action plan to tackle congestion, accident-prone stretches and chronic traffic choke points, with each traffic circle being tasked with identifying at least one "problem area". These could be stretches affected by encroachment, roadside parking or heavy traffic movement, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The directions, issued a few days ago, call to combine enforcement with engineering measures as well as public awareness and participation. "The plan is expected to focus on reducing congestion, improving traffic flow and strengthening road discipline," a senior officer said.

Traffic officials have been asked to identify roads and stretches requiring priority attention.

"The traffic unit has also been directed to undertake zero-tolerance drives against common violations such as triple riding, riding without helmets and driving on the wrong carriageway," the officer said.

The directions seek to combine enforcement with engineering measures as well as public awareness and participation

Kumar stressed that visible and sustained enforcement is essential to ensure traffic discipline, the officer added.

The emphasis is on making traffic policing more visible on the ground. Officials have been asked to increase their presence, make greater use of communication sets and use social media more actively for traffic alerts and traffic-management messaging.

Awareness programmes in schools and colleges are also being planned.

"Sector-specific engagement plans should be prepared for groups such as taxi operators, e-rickshaw drivers and truck operators to seek voluntary compliance and sensitise them about the impact of rash driving and unauthorised parking," the officer added.

One proposal that could im-

prove enforcement on Delhi roads is a review of the authority to issue traffic challans. At present, local police personnel seeking to issue a traffic challan have to inform traffic police officers to issue challans.

The matter is being examined by the Traffic Management Division.

"The notification needs to come from the government and it is under process. If approved, even local police will be able to issue such challans," the official said.

Further, Kumar has directed the traffic police to deploy personnel from the CP Reserve for integrated checking.

The directions come after last week, while on general gasht (night patrolling) before the Independence Day, Kumar had reached the RTR Flyover at around 12.30 am and found several vehicles parked on the loop connecting the flyover to the airport.

Angered by the parking on the flyover, he had suspended Delhi Cantonment Traffic Inspector Sushil Kumar, his JDO (joint duty officer), and the sub-divisional in-charge at Vasant Vihar police station and sent them to the Police Lines.



Delhi LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launch 200 new electric buses and 56 Ladies Special services in New Delhi on Wednesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

LG, CM flag off 200 electric buses, launch 56 Ladies Special services

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 19

DELHI'S ELECTRIC bus fleet crossed the 5,000-mark on Wednesday with the induction of 200 new buses, as Lieutenant Governor (LG) Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta flagged off the buses at the Delhi University Sports Complex, officials said. With the latest induction, Delhi's total bus fleet has reached around 6,800.

The government on Wednesday also launched 56 women-only e-bus services, including services connecting DU colleges.

Gupta said the expansion of electric buses and women-only services was aimed at making

public transport cleaner, safer and more convenient. "These initiatives will strengthen clean, green and sustainable public transport in the capital while also helping reduce vehicular pollution," Sandhu said.

The 200 new e-buses comprise 88 12-metre electric buses and 112 nine-metre Delhi EV Connector (DEV) buses, an official said. The government has set a target of expanding the fleet to around 14,000 buses by 2028-29, while converting all Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses to electric vehicles.

The new buses were launched alongside a new Delhi-Karnal interstate electric bus service, dedicated Ladies Special services and a public EV charging

station at DTC's Rajghat Depot 1.

Officials said that 30 Ladies Special trips will operate on 15 high-demand routes, while 26 University Ladies Special (USPL) trips will run on 13 routes.

These services will operate during peak hours in the morning and evening and will connect key employment, educational hubs, officials said.

The Ladies Special buses will have women police personnel and Home Guard marshals deployed on board and will be operated by women staff, an official said. Panic buttons installed in the buses have also been integrated with the Delhi Police's emergency response system, an official said.

• FOUR INCOMPATIBLE DONOR-RECIPIENT PAIRS FROM NAGALAND, KASHMIR, PUNJAB AND BIHAR BECAME PART OF A MEDICAL CHAIN IN WHICH EACH DONOR GAVE A KIDNEY TO ANOTHER FAMILY'S LOVED ONE

8 strangers, 4 kidneys, 1 lifeline: How a four-way kidney swap overcame a legal hurdle

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, August 19

THIS ONE sounds like a film script: Four families from four corners of India, who had never met, brought together by the same desperate hope — if they could not save their own, perhaps they could save each other's.

There was a family from Nagaland. Another from Kashmir. Yet another from Punjab. And the last from Bihar. Beyond different communities and faiths, they had a loved one, who needed a kidney transplant and was running out of time.

Each of the four patients also had someone willing to donate one. But there was a problem.

The kidneys belonged to the wrong people. In each family, the willing donor was a near relative of the patient — the category of donor contemplated

under India's transplant law — but the two were biologically incompatible.

In several of the patients, the problem was not simply blood-group compatibility. Three of the four recipients were highly sensitised and had positive cross-match results, meaning their blood contained antibodies capable of attacking the cells of a particular donor.

The families had found a possible answer: don't give the kidney to the person you love. Give it to someone else's loved one instead. Donor A would give to Recipient B. Donor B would give to Recipient C. Donor C would give to Recipient D. And Donor D would give to Recipient A. This was a circle of strangers, each saving a family they had never met, in the hope that another stranger would do the same for theirs.

Kidney-swap transplantation is not new in India. The

basic idea is relatively simple: when a willing donor cannot donate to their intended recipient because of biological incompatibility, another donor-recipient pair can enter the exchange. The two donors effectively swap recipients.

The difficulty grows rapidly as more pairs are added. A transplant team has to establish not merely that each donor is compatible with somebody, but that the entire chain works. A kidney has to move in such a way that the chain closes.

Immunological testing is central to that process. Previous pregnancies, blood transfusions and transplants can all contribute to sensitisation.

In a four-way exchange, there are many more possible combinations — and every link matters. "We have tried three-way swaps manually, but matching donors with unrelated recipients is a very tedious

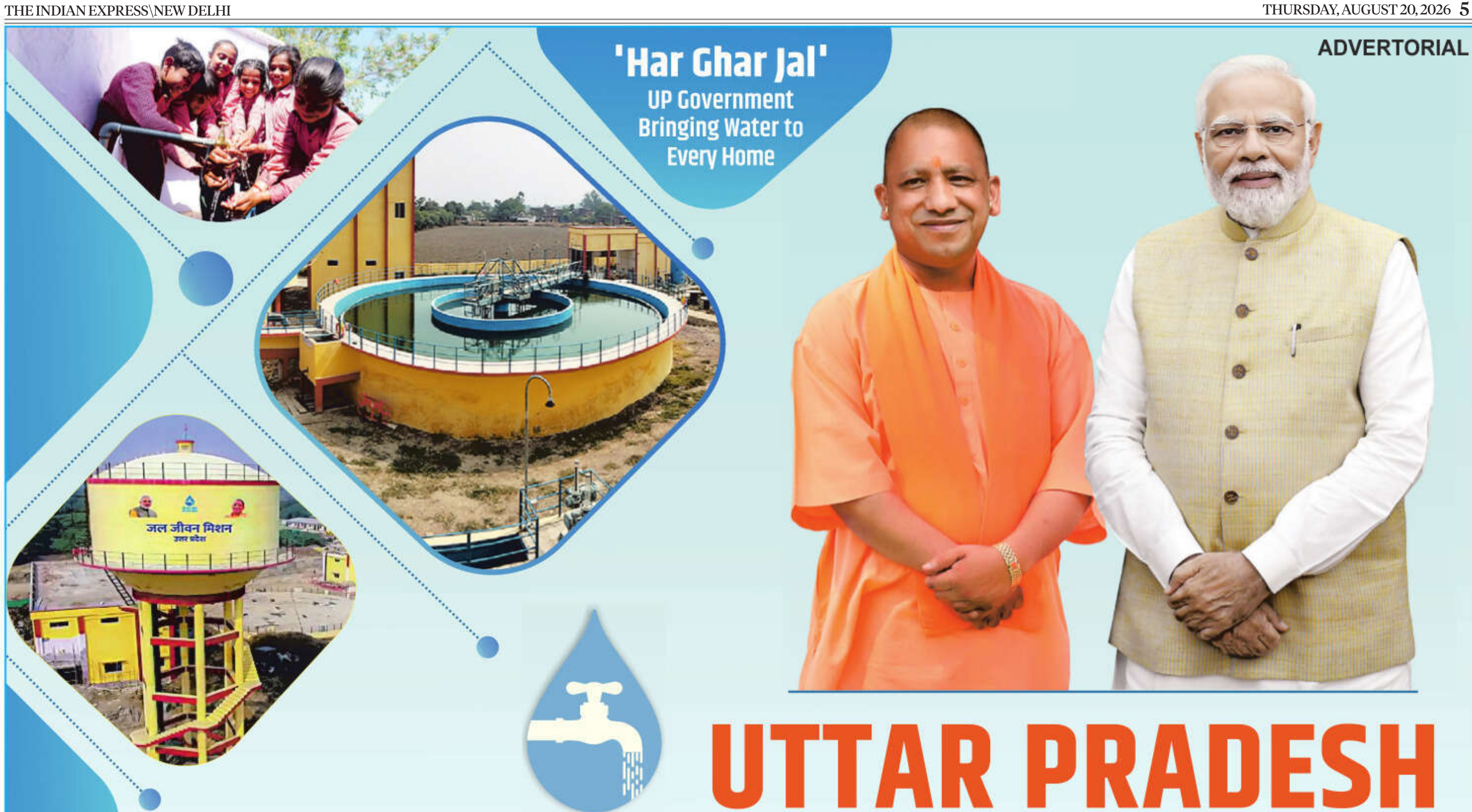
• THE LEGAL JOURNEY How the court battle played out

- 1. AUTHORISATION COMMITTEE** Rejected the proposal.
THOTA Act, Section 9(3A) — explicitly allows only a two-way (two-pair) swap.
- 2. APPELLATE AUTHORITY** Upheld the rejection.
- 3. DIRECTORATE GENERAL OF HEALTH SERVICES (DGHS)** Did not approve the proposal.
- 4. COMBINED SUIT FILED** The four families filed a combined suit in the Delhi High Court.
- 5. DELHI HIGH COURT**
 - Permitted the four-way kidney swap in this case.
 - Waived the requirement for permission from the respective State Governments.

and complex task," Dr Anant Kumar, who led the operation, told *The Indian Express*.

There was a bigger hurdle, that of the law. The proposal for a four-way kidney swap was rejected by the Authorisation Committee, a legal body established under India's Transplantation of Human Organs and Tissues Act (THOTA).





'Har Ghar Jal'

UP Government
Bringing Water to
Every Home

UTTAR PRADESH

LEADS THE NATION WITH HAR GHAR JAL

Under the Jal Jeevan Mission, the 'Har Ghar Jal' initiative has emerged as a transformative force for rural Uttar Pradesh. Under the visionary leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the state has made remarkable strides in expanding access to safe and reliable tap water, turning water security into a powerful catalyst for rural development and improved quality of life. Before 2019, only 1.97% of rural households in Uttar Pradesh had access to tap water. Today, coverage has risen dramatically to 91.99%, bringing the benefits of household tap connections to millions of families. More than 14.74 crore rural residents are now benefiting from the initiative. This remarkable transformation goes beyond infrastructure—it is reshaping everyday life by improving health, convenience, dignity and opportunities for rural communities.

Water for All, Prosperity for Every Village

Under the Leadership of Yogi Government, Jal Jeevan Mission Emerges as a Model of Rural Transformation



- 2.45 crore+ rural households with tap connections: Bringing functional household tap water closer to every family across Uttar Pradesh.
- 14.74 crore+ rural residents benefiting: Expanding access to safe, reliable drinking water.
- 27,650+ villages certified 'Har Ghar Jal': Ensuring verified tap connections and functional water supply.
- Less dependence on handpumps, wells & distant sources: Saving time, reducing effort and making rural life more convenient.

From Water to Health: Transforming Rural Lives

- Safe Water, Healthier Communities:** Reducing exposure to water-borne diseases and strengthening rural health.
- Water at the Doorstep, Opportunities for Women & Girls:** Saving time and opening doors to education, jobs, entrepreneurship and self-development.
- Better Water, Better Childhoods:** Improved facilities in schools and Anganwadi centres supporting hygiene, sanitation and healthier environments.
- Water with Dignity:** Reliable household water supply bringing greater convenience, dignity and social well-being to rural families.



Solar Power Driving a Greener Water Revolution

- 33,000+ water projects powered by solar energy: Bringing clean, sustainable power to rural water supply.
- Nearly 80% of drinking water projects solar-powered: Building a greener and more reliable water infrastructure.
- 900 MW of solar capacity: Accelerating the integration of renewable energy with essential public infrastructure.
- Solar-powered pumping: Reducing dependence on conventional electricity and improving operational efficiency.
- Water Security + Clean Energy + Environment: Building a greener, more resilient and sustainable rural water ecosystem.

Women as 'Jal Praharis' Guardians of Water Quality

- 4.80 lakh+ women trained in water testing: Creating a powerful, community-led network for safer drinking water.
- Women's groups in 97,000+ villages engaged: Using Field Testing Kits (FTKs) to strengthen grassroots water quality monitoring.
- 65,000+ water samples tested: Helping detect potential water: Quality concerns and enabling timely action.
- ₹20 per test, up to ₹400 honorarium: Turning water stewardship into an opportunity for income, skills and women's empowerment.

Water Brings Skills, Skills Bring Opportunities



- 8 lakh+ youth trained in technical skills: Building a skilled workforce for rural water infrastructure.
- Plumbing, electrical work, pump operation, fitting, masonry & motor mechanics: Equipping youth with job-ready, livelihood-oriented skills.
- 1.75 lakh+ masons | 1.66 lakh+ electricians | 1.16 lakh+ plumbers trained: Strengthening the skilled workforce at the grassroots.
- Local skills, local jobs, stronger villages: Trained manpower supporting operation, maintenance and repairs while giving a boost to the rural economy.

A New Milestone in
Uttar Pradesh's Water Revolution

5.20 lakh+

km of water pipelines—Building a vast rural water network and strengthening last-mile connectivity.



2.45 crore+

rural households with tap water—Bringing safe, reliable drinking water to families across villages.



5 lakh+

women trained in water testing
Empowering women as active partners in community-led water management.

33,000+

water projects powered by solar energy
Driving green, sustainable water supply with nearly 900 MW of solar-powered capacity.

- A New Era of Har Ghar Jal in Vindhy-Bundelkhand Region:** Functional household tap connections have reached over 20.69 lakh families across 9 districts, ensuring access to safe and clean drinking water.
- Uttar Pradesh Secures 2nd Place in the 5th National Water Awards:** The state has been honoured with the Second Prize for its outstanding performance and effective implementation of the Jal Jeevan Mission.
- Safe Water, Healthy Communities—Under Stop Diarrhoea Campaign-2026:** Uttar Pradesh is strengthening awareness, water quality testing, sanitation and hygiene practices, while the Jal Jeevan Mission has ensured piped drinking water in 1,16,340 schools and 1,55,136 Anganwadi centres.
- Uttar Pradesh Shines at Jal Mahotsav 2026 -** Outstanding performers from 14 districts under the Jal Jeevan Mission were honoured at the national Mega Event; Rachna Devi of Chitrakoot was felicitated by the Hon'ble President, while Shri Devaswaroop Kunjibihari, VWSC Chairman, was honoured by the Hon'ble Union Minister of Jal Shakti for "Exemplary Financial Sustainability through User Charge Collection."

Channi skips key Cong meeting for another MA exam

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, August 19

AT A time when the senior Congress leadership is busy dousing the organisational fireworks lit by Jalandhar MP Charanjit Singh Channi and his supporters in Punjab, the former Chief Minister is burning the midnight oil for an MA exam and skipped the CWC meet in New Delhi on Wednesday.

Channi is pursuing a masters degree in Public Administration from Panjab University, Chandigarh. One of the papers for the course is scheduled for Thursday. Channi, who had once declared himself a "lifelong student", is a qualified lawyer with two postgraduate degrees, one in business administration and another in political science, as well as a PhD in political science under his belt.

While he pursues another academic qualification, his absence at the meeting, attended by party chief Mallikarjun Kharge and LoP Rahul Gandhi, did not go unnoticed. This is the second time in recent weeks that he has skipped an event where Gandhi was to be present.



Meatless Row

A DAY after visuals of BJP national president Nitin Nabin enjoying traditional Andhra cuisine with the party's state leadership in Vizag snowballed into a controversy, with many accusing him of consuming non-vegetarian food in the holy month of Sawan, the party pulled out all the stops to take on the "fake narrative" on social media. The Chhattisgarh BJP's official handle put out a post insisting that the food item shown in the footage was actually a traditional raw jackfruit curry, a purely vegetarian dish.

Metro to Rescue

INDIAN YOUTH Congress (IYC) president Uday Bhanu Chib had a touch-and-go moment as he boarded a flight for Pune on Wednesday evening. Chib, who had to be present during the Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting at Indira Bhawan, left for the airport around 4.30 pm for his 5.40 pm flight. He was headed to Pune to oversee preparations for Rahul Gandhi's Chhatron ki Goonj programme on August 22. After getting stuck in crawling traffic, Chib decided to take the metro to the airport and reached just minutes before boarding for the flight was closed.

Kharge: Hurt that not many in CWC condemned 'purification' ritual

Manoj C G
New Delhi, August 19

AT THE meeting of the Congress Working Committee (CWC) on Wednesday, party president Mallikarjun Kharge vented out a personal anguish. And he has done that rarely. He told those present that he was "hurt" that many of the CWC members did not openly come out in support of him on the 'purification' issue by condemning it.

Kharge was referring to a 'purification' ritual organised in Uttarakhand's Haldwani after his visit some days ago. The Congress had alleged that those who organised the 'shuddhikaran havan' were linked to the BJP and said it reflected a casteist mindset. The BJP, on the other hand, had distanced itself from the event. Kharge had raised the issue in Rajya Sabha as well. He said he had never asked anyone to protect him because he is a Dalit, but the 'purification' event made him feel humiliated.

At the CWC meeting,



AICC chief Mallikarjun Kharge with Congress leaders Sonia Gandhi, Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, K C Venugopal, Ambika Soni, Jairam Ramesh and others at the CWC meet on Wednesday. ANI

Kharge broached the topic. He said he felt "hurt" that all the CWC members and especially those "good-looking people" who get space in the media did not speak about it. AICC general secretary K C Venugopal said the party did raise the issue and condemned it, but Kharge's body language suggested, those present at the meeting said, he was far from convinced.

Kharge did not take any

names, and Congress leaders could only speculate who all he was referring to. In fact, the Congress president — again without taking names — pointed out that some leaders are prone to making comments and writing articles not in consonance with the party line.

Briefing the media later on the deliberations in the CWC, Venugopal spoke about the 'purification' row, arguing that the

incident was "unacceptable" and "condemnable" and alleged that it reflected the mindset of the BJP.

The meeting also saw Kanhaiya Kumar, who is the AICC in-charge of the NSUI, talking about the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and telling the leadership that the party should not cede political space to such groups. Sources said many in the party share Kumar's view. The party has so far maintained distance from the CJP even while supporting the student protests and linking it to the larger issue of jobs.

Without naming CJP, the resolution passed by the CWC noted that "sustained pressure from student groups and the united Opposition — both inside and outside Parliament — compelled the Education Minister to resign".

The meeting also saw Lok Sabha MP Shashi Tharoor pointing out that the word "bullying" used in the draft resolution in the context of US pressure on India should be substituted with some other

word. While Kharge and others are said to have argued the word bullying was not unparliamentary, the final resolution merely said, "The Congress Working Committee is deeply concerned that the Modi government is sacrificing India's agricultural and energy security, as well as its strategic sovereignty, in the face of American pressure."

Sources said Rahul Gandhi, in the context of the student and youth protests and his 'Chhatron ki Goonj' campaign, reiterated that Prime Minister Narendra Modi was now India's past. Sources said he, however, did not agree with senior leader Manish Tewari's assessment that the last serious student movement was the anti-Mandal agitation in the 1990s, which led to 62 people immolating themselves and more than 100 killed in police firing. Rahul said the 'Chhatron ki Goonj' campaign was a very successful student movement.

The CWC resolution later said the 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' campaign was receiving an overwhelmingly positive response.

'Party above nation for Cong': BJP slams CWC's Vande Mataram stand

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 19

THE BJP on Wednesday condemned the Congress's resolution to sing only two stanzas of Vande Mataram, saying the "party was above the nation" for Congress members.

BJP national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi accused the Congress of becoming the "new Muslim League" by insisting on the same demand that the Muslim League had made regarding the national song. He said that the Congress' decision also raised questions on its "patriotism and loyalty" to the country. Trivedi stressed that the resolution passed in the Congress meeting on Wednesday was "extremely reprehensible".

"The Congress Working Committee's resolution seems more important to it than the powers granted by the Constitution and the laws made by Parliament. The Congress has also proven that it considers itself above the Constitution, above the country, and its party resolution above constitutional law."

Terming the Congress' decision "extremely condemnable", Trivedi said, "This decision has completely shattered its (the Congress') claim of being the self-proclaimed sole copyright holder of the freedom struggle. Trivedi said Congress had put an end to "speculation that it has become today's new Muslim League". "Because the same obstinacy that the Muslim League had in 1937 regarding Vande Mataram is the same obstinacy that the Congress is showing in 2026 regarding Vande Mataram," he posted on X.

"Instead of forgetting such a shameful chapter or rectifying the situation, the Congress has embraced it. It reveals the party's current state. There is no longer any doubt that its loyalty to the nation completely comes under suspicion," he said.

The Congress on Wednesday resolved that only the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram will be sung at all party events in future. The decisions were taken at a four-hour-long meeting of the Congress Working Committee (CWC).

Central Vista revamp: Future home of Budget Press likely at Kartavya Bhawan 9

Secure printing facility gained significance after a leak in 1956

Damini Nath
New Delhi, August 19

AS PART of the Central Vista redevelopment, the government is planning to set up the Budget Press, which is the secure printing facility where the annual union Budget is printed, at the under-construction Kartavya Bhawan 9 building, where the Finance Ministry could shift upon completion, said officials.

The Delhi Urban Art Commission in its meeting on July 16 approved a revised plan for the Kartavya Bhawan 8 and 9 project that includes a "Budget press added in the ground floor of Kartavya Bhawan 9", as per the minutes of the meeting. As part of the redevelopment project, 10 secretariat buildings named Kartavya Bhawan are being constructed along the Central Vista. KB 8 and 9 are under construction on the site of the old Vice-President's House and Vigyan Bhawan Annex, which have been demolished, on Maulana Azad Road.

The location of the press, which also prints the Economic Survey, gained significance after the Union Budget of 1956-1957 leaked from the printing press located at Rashtrapati Bhawan. It was then that the Finance Ministry decided that the Budget Press should be located within its own premises at North Block. Last year, when the Finance Ministry moved out of North Block into Kartavya Bhawan 1, the existing machinery could not be shifted due to space and weight con-



Officials said the Budget Press at North Block has been dismantled as the building is being renovated into a museum. FILE PHOTO

What happened in 1956

THE BUDGET Press was shifted to the basement of North Block after a leak of the Union Budget 1956-1957 from the press at Rashtrapati Bhawan. A case under the Official Secrets Act was lodged. The court proceedings show that the general foreman of the Rashtrapati Bhawan press, F X Jacobs, had leaked information about the taxation proposals in the Budget to a Delhi resident, D P Chadha, who further sold it to some Mumbai-based businessmen.

straints. On September 2, 2025, the Finance Ministry floated a tender for new, lighter printing machines to be fit into the space available at KB 1.

In the file notings, along with the tender document, the Ministry said: "Additionally, the load-bearing capacity of the floors, particularly on the ground level, was found to be inadequate for heavy-duty post-press machines such as paper-cutters and trimmers. These technical limitations necessitated a re-evaluation of the machinery options originally proposed."

The new press was still under trial at the time for the Union Budget 2026-2027 in February, leading to the Budget being printed in North Block, according to government sources.

The printing of the Budget is carried out under security cover,

with the officers concerned being "locked in" at the premises from the time the printing starts till the Finance Minister presents the Budget in Parliament.

The Housing and Urban Affairs and Finance Ministries did not respond to emails requesting comment. However, officials in the ministries said the Budget Press at North Block has been dismantled as the building is being renovated into a museum, and the press at KB 1 has been installed. The officials said though the allotment of the space would be done when the building is complete, the Finance Ministry could move into KB 9, which is under construction at Maulana Azad Road. Keeping that in mind, the Central Public Works Department has designed the building to house the Budget Press, they said.

Cabinet clears major rail projects to decongest Howrah-Chennai line

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, August 19

THE UNION Cabinet on Wednesday approved four railways multi-tracking, and one four lane highway project worth Rs 13,041 crore.

The multi-tracking railway projects have been approved to decongest the high-density Howrah-Chennai route.

These include the 173-km Kharagpur-Bhadrak (Ranital) 4th Line in West Bengal and Odisha, the 75-km Bhadrak-Haridaspur 4th Line in Odisha, the 90-km Gummidipundi-Gudur 3rd and 4th Line in Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu, and the 72-km Cuttack-Paradeep (Badabandha) 3rd and 4th line in Odisha.

These four projects together will cost around Rs 9,450 crore. Kharagpur-Ranital railway line is one of the main corridors connecting eastern and southern India. It carries long distance passengers and freight

traffic. Officials said the section is projected to remain saturated even after the commissioning of the third line, which has necessitated the construction of the fourth line as well.

The project links to the steel hubs at Jakhapura, Tatanagar and Durgapur with Paradip and Dhamra Ports for efficient movement of raw materials and finished goods.

Similarly, the existing Bhadrak-Haridaspur stretch in Odisha, presently at 91 per cent capacity, is expected to be near saturation from projected port and steel plant demand.

The Gummidipundi-Gudur section is an existing double line forming part of both the Delhi-Chennai and Howrah-Chennai High Density Network (HDN) routes. The section falls under the Vizag-Chennai Industrial Corridor and forms a key part of the planned East Coast Economic Corridor, India's first coastal corridor. The line capacity utilization is ex-

pected to reach 131%.

The fourth project, Cuttack-Badabandha, is a strategic corridor and part of the Jharsuguda-Cuttack-Paradeep Highly Utilised Network (HUN).

It connects Paradeep Port to key hinterland areas of major steel clusters, iron ore mines and coal fields.

Officials said the existing section is saturated at up to 101% utilisation, and is projected to rise further to 177%.

The multi-tracking works will increase the existing network of Indian Railways by about 410 km and result in additional freight traffic by 76 million tonnes per annum (MTPA), said the Railways.

On Wednesday, the Cabinet also approved development of 4-lane brownfield Muzaffarpur-Sitamari-Sonbarsa Corridor (NH-22) in Bihar worth Rs 3,591 crore. This is expected to reduce the current travel time between Muzaffarpur to Sonbarsa from two hours to one.

Ministers get social media fame check, asked to engage more with Gen Z

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, August 19

UNION MINISTERS attending the Cabinet meeting on Wednesday were given an account of their social media engagements in the past two and a half months, sources said.

The analysis, which also included a comparison of their digital outreach and engagement on four social media platforms, advised the ministers to step up their activities on these platforms to reach out to a larger audience.

Sources said each minister was handed an envelope after the Cabinet meeting. The envelope contained details of their activities from May 1 to August 15, assessing their performances across X, Instagram, Facebook

and LinkedIn. The metrics used were the average daily posts, engagement per post, total likes, follower country and the overall traction each post had created, sources said. The level of traction created by the social media posts of political leaders, including those from the Opposition, was also compared.

Senior ministers Nirmala Sitharaman, S Jaishankar and Piyush Goyal were not present in Wednesday's Cabinet meeting. Sitharaman is leading a ministerial delegation with Jaishankar, Goyal and Minister of State Jitin Prasada to Singapore for high-level talks aimed at deepening economic ties with that country.

A source said the ministers get such performance analysis of their social media posts from

time to time. The source said the assessment is "meant to urge the ministers to scale up their digital outreach". The latest analysis assumes significance in the wake of Prime Minister Narendra Modi emphasising engagement with Gen Z on social media.

The ministers and other BJP leaders have been advised to increase their social media activity and focus more on engaging with the youth. Modi has urged BJP leaders, including the ministers and chief ministers, to utilise social media for reaching out to citizens directly and for promoting the Central government-run welfare schemes. At the BJP-NDA chief ministers' conclave, an account of their activities on social media platforms is always a part of their performance analysis, sources said.

'HATE SPEECH' Arrest warrant against Mahua for skipping court summons



TMC MP Mahua Moitra

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, August 19

THE KRISHNANAGAR court on Wednesday ordered the immediate issuance of an arrest warrant against TMC MP Mahua Moitra for non-compliance with summonses in an alleged hate speech case. Meanwhile, Moitra said she would challenge the order in a higher court.

Noting that she had failed to appear despite repeated summonses, the 3rd Judicial Magistrate Court held in its order that the Krishnanagar MP showed "no respect for the court of law". "The series of disobedience of the order of this court... goes to show the lackadaisical approach of the accused to comply with the court order and accordingly this court is left with no other option but to issue a warrant of arrest against her," the court said.

The Lok Sabha MP did not appear on at least four hearing dates — August 4, 12, 18 and 19. Moitra, however, has maintained that she wanted to be represented by her lawyer in court.

On June 17, a case was filed against Moitra at the Court of Chief Judicial Magistrate, Krishnanagar, on the complaint of Chaina Nandi, also a resident of Krishnanagar. The complainant alleged that the Lok Sabha MP had made remarks against the Union Home Minister, Army personnel, and "certain religious beliefs and symbols revered by" the Hindu community.

'Make UP your second industrial home': Yogi to Japanese firms at investment meet

Express News Service
Lucknow, August 19

SIX MONTHS after he travelled to Japan with a high-level delegation to project the state as a big-ticket investment destination, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Wednesday exhorted Japanese business leaders to make the state their "second industrial home", calling for investments not only in manufacturing but also in research and development, technology, skill centres and global supply chains.

Addressing the participating delegates during the inaugural session of the five-day UP-Japan Investment Meet 2026 in New Delhi, the CM said that robotics, precision engineering

and green manufacturing coupled with Japanese practices such as Kaizen and 5S could help build an industry-ready workforce in UP.

Japan's strengths in precision, quality, technology and manufacturing could complement UP's young workforce, infrastructure and large market, he added.

Kotaro Nagasaki, Governor of Yamanashi Prefecture in Japan, who is leading the Japanese delegation, highlighted green hydrogen, human-resource development, tourism and governance as areas where Yamanashi and UP could collaborate.

Adityanath said, "Japan is the land of the rising sun, while Uttar Pradesh is the land of Su-

ryavansh. India-Japan ties are a partnership of shared growth, technology and prosperity."

At the CEO-level discussions, Union ministers Ashwini Vaishnaw and Shivraj Singh Chouhan also urged Japanese companies to make large investments in the state. Describing Japan as a long-term development partner, Chouhan urged Japanese companies to combine their technology with UP's workforce, scale and market.

Also, Indian firms Escorts Kubota and Minda Corporation held a virtual groundbreaking ceremony for projects worth Rs 3,191 crore at the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA), which are likely to generate



Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw and Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath with Yamanashi Prefecture governor Kotaro Nagasaki at the UP-Japan Investment Meet 2026 in Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

more than 10,000 jobs.

Officials said these projects could help create a larger Japa-

nese manufacturing and automotive supply chain in the state, bringing suppliers, ancil-

lary units, technology providers and skilled workers into the ecosystem.

Vaishnaw highlighted opportunities in infrastructure, manufacturing, electronics, semiconductors, railways, defence and agriculture, inviting Japanese companies to invest in India, particularly in UP.

As part of the state's long-term Japan strategy, the UP government proposed to build a 500-acre Japan City at YEIDA near Noida International Airport in Gautam Buddha Nagar district's Jewar to "create an integrated ecosystem" for Japanese companies, suppliers and ancillary industries.

"A Japan City will also be developed with all amenities just 3 kilometres from the Noida Inter-

national Airport where semiconductor and electronics manufacturing clusters as well as data centres are located nearby," CM Adityanath said, inviting Japanese firms to "build a long-term industrial ecosystem in UP, spanning manufacturing, semiconductors, clean energy, technology and skilling".

The state government also projected a "wider infrastructure network" as another advantage, including "17 operational airports, two dedicated freight corridors, metro connectivity in seven cities and more than 75,000 acres of industrial land bank".

Meanwhile, seeking to leverage the state's shared Buddhist heritage with Japan, the government has prepared a four-

day itinerary for the Japanese delegates to showcase cultural landscape and push for investments in tourism and wellness.

The delegation will start their UP tour on Thursday and will visit Agra, Lucknow, Varanasi and Buddhist heritage sites in Sarnath. In Agra, they will be given a Braj-themed welcome and visit the Taj Mahal before travelling to Lucknow, it is learnt.

Besides Sarnath, UP is home to major Buddhist destinations like Kushinagar, Shravasti, Kapilvastu, Kaushambi and Sankisa. The recent announcement of Sarnath's UNESCO World Heritage recognition has added fresh momentum to the state's effort to position its Buddhist circuit for international travellers, particularly from Japan.

Bail offers cold comfort, Noida workers face debt, fear: 'What if police pick him up again?'

New Delhi

Collectors in 6 border states, J&K, Ladakh get power to grant citizenship

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, August 19

THE UNION Home Ministry on Wednesday authorised District Collectors in Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, West Bengal, Assam and Tripura (except tribal areas), and Union Territories of J&K and Ladakh to grant naturalised citizenship to “fit and proper” applicants ordinarily residing in these regions.

The government notified the Citizenship (Third Amendment) Rules 2026 on Wednesday, granting Collectors in these states and UTs the authority to process citizenship-seeking applications for “registration or naturalisation”.

“The Collector, on being satisfied with the suitability of the applicant, that he is a fit and proper person to be registered or naturalised, as the case may be, shall grant him the citizenship of India,” the notified rules said. The Collectors in these states will replace the “Empowered Committees” and “Designated Officers” that previously held these powers.

In the gazette notification, the Ministry of Home Affairs authorised the Collectors in these areas to “receive, scrutinise, and dispose” of such applications in accordance with the laid-down parameters.

The new rules apply to citizenship-seeking applicants residing in Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, West Bengal, Assam, and Tripura, as well as the Union Territories of J&K and Ladakh. In Assam and Tripura, the rules specifically exclude tribal areas. The government has directed that all pending applications with those committees in the specified regions be immediately transferred to the relevant Collector.

STATE ORDERS FIRE-SAFETY AUDIT OF HOTELS & GUEST HOUSES; S.I.T. FORMED TO PROBE INCIDENT

5 Bangladeshis, one child among nine killed in Kolkata hotel fire

Ravik Bhattacharya
& Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, August 19

A FIRE AT a hotel in Central Kolkata in the early hours of Wednesday has claimed at least nine lives, including at least five Bangladeshi nationals. Most of the guests were asleep when smoke engulfed the hotel, suffocating nine persons including a child, the police said.

The fire broke out around 2 am on Wednesday at the Shikha Inn hotel located in a five-storeyed building on Free School Street in Central Kolkata. Officially known as Mirza Ghalib Street, the Free School Street area has several hotels catering especially to Bangladeshi nationals who often visit the city for medical treatment.

The incident comes close on the heels of a massive fire at a four-storey hotel in Tarapith in West Bengal’s Birbhum district early on Monday, in which nine people had died.

The state government has ordered a statewide fire-safety audit of hotels and guest houses, while an SIT has also been formed to probe the incident.

Exit gates locked, no fire alarms

The police said that Wednesday morning’s fire, believed to be caused by a short circuit, spread fast, making it difficult for the guests to escape. Police sources said the building also lacked proper firefighting systems.

Atiyar Rehman, a guest from Satkhira in Bangladesh, told *The Indian Express*, “There was no firefighting mechanism in the hotel. We woke up struggling to breathe in the smoke. We somehow managed to escape.”

As the news of the fire



Rescue and police personnel arrive at the hotel in Kolkata on Wednesday. PARTHA PAUL

spread, five firefighting engines and the Disaster Management Department rushed to the spot.

Most of the guests had rushed to the hotel terrace for safety. There was an emergency exit but the gates were locked, and there were no fire alarms at the hotel, police sources said.

A fire services team used ladders to scale the building, get inside through the windows, and rescue people from the building. Over 60 people were rescued from the fire.

The fire personnel who rushed to the spot claimed dense black smoke in the building led to difficulty in visibility and breathing.

“After prolonged and strenuous rescue efforts, the fire brigade and police personnel successfully rescued around 60 persons from the hotel and brought them to safety,” said a senior officer of

Kolkata Police. “The fire-fighting and rescue operations continued for over 2 hours and were completed by 4.30 am. A police team remained deployed throughout the operation to ensure safe and effective coordination and crowd control,” the officer said.

Nine people were rushed to Calcutta Medical College and Hospital, where they were declared dead. The police said the deceased included six men, two women, and a child.

Five of the deceased have been identified as Bangladeshi citizens — Akram Ali, Debasish Dutta, Afshana Shirmin and Swarnashish Dutta, all from the same family, apart from 37-year-old Babu Ahmed.

Two others have been identified as Indian nationals — 19-year-old Sandip Paswan from Bihar, and Yog Narayan Aggarwal, 68, from Siliguri. The

identities of two other deceased are yet to be ascertained.

The cramped-up entrance of the Shikha Inn hotel is covered with boards with names of other hotels and lodges. Locals say that each floor of the five-storeyed building had around 5-6 hotels, with each hotel housing 4-5 tiny rooms.

Hardly any windows were visible in the hotel building, which is lined by iron staircases located at its backside.

The locals alleged that the owners had linked two buildings together, flouting all rules and regulations. The iron staircases also got heated up from the fire, making it difficult for the guests to escape.

The locals alleged that no fire safety rules were being followed at the hotel, and that the number of the hotels suddenly spurt in the area from 2015 onwards, without obtaining any

proper permissions.

Minister of State for Fire and Emergency Services, Koushik Chowdhury told mediapersons, “There are several hotels inside this building. I am shocked to see what was going on here...”

Chowdhury said the preliminary information pointed to a short circuit behind the fire, and that more details would be available after the forensic examination is conducted.

Municipal Affairs and Urban Development Minister, Agni-mitra Paul, also questioned the alleged flouting of rules by the building owners. Visiting the spot on Wednesday, Paul questioned how several air conditioners were operating and whether the electrical load caused the short circuit leading to the fire. She added that the Calcutta Electric Supply Corporation (CESC) should also take responsibility.

Meanwhile, a five-member Special Investigation Team (SIT) has been formed and it will be headed by Bhagirath Ghosh, Assistant Commissioner of Police (Admn), Detective Department, Kolkata. The police have filed a suo motu FIR in the case, under sections of the BNS relating to culpable homicide not amounting to murder, rash or negligent acts that endanger human life or the personal safety of others, negligent or rash conduct involving fire or combustible matter, and certain sections under the Fire Service Act.

While the owner of the hotel, Bireshwar Mitra is absconding, his wife, Lipi Mitra told mediapersons, “My husband was there in the hotel till 10.30 pm last night. How this incident happened, we do not know. It has to be investigated. We have all the required licences and permits.”



Relatives of people taken ill after drinking spurious liquor at Sir Takhtasinhji General Hospital in Gujarat’s Bhavnagar. EXPRESS

4 dead, 8 critical after consuming spurious liquor in Gujarat

Brendan Dabhi
Ahmedabad, August 19

FOUR PERSONS have died and 18 others were hospitalised, eight of them in critical condition, in Gujarat’s Bhavnagar district after consuming spurious liquor that had been illegally brought from Madhya Pradesh, police said.

Four bootleggers have been detained in this connection, they said, adding that the victims had consumed duplicate liquor of a popular Indian-Made Foreign Liquor (IMFL) brand. Gujarat is a ‘dry’ state where manufacturing, sale and consumption of alcohol are banned.

The first death was reported on Tuesday evening, another one in the night of the same day and two others died on Wednesday, police said.

Bhavnagar District Collector Manish Kumar Bansal on Wednesday said the spurious liquor affected at least 22 people.

While deaths of three persons — Kartik Makwana (40), Upendra Gohil (25), and Ghan-shyamsinh Jadeja (50) — had been confirmed due to consumption of spurious liquor,

the postmortem and toxicology reports of the fourth victim, identified as Narendra Yadav, are awaited, Bansal said. All the deceased are from Bhavnagar district.

Of the 18 people currently admitted to five hospitals including Sir Takhtasinhji General Hospital and four private hospitals, two remained in critical condition, four are in the Intensive Care Unit (ICU), two are on ventilator support and 10 others are in stable condition, the collector said.

In a video statement, Bansal said the district administration received information around 6 pm on Tuesday about a group of four persons falling ill after consuming illicit liquor during a party held at Kharkadi village in Ghogha taluka of the district on August 16. The collector said that one person from Surat was currently undergoing treatment there, while the person from Jamnagar is asymptomatic.

The same batch of spurious liquor was allegedly sold to several people across at least two talukas — Ghogha and Bhavnagar.

Bansal said that senior government doctors had been deputed at the private hospitals for supervision.

Railway police begins probe into ‘custodial’ death of Nigerian man

Express News Service
Surat, August 19

GOVERNMENT RAILWAY Police (GRP) on Wednesday initiated an inquiry into the alleged custodial death of a foreign national who died under suspicious circumstances after questioning by RPF officials at the Surat Railway Station.

While the man has been identified as a Nigerian national, the officials didn’t disclose his name. He was travelling from Mumbai to Delhi on the Golden Temple Express before his detention at the Surat railway station.

He was detained and questioned after an alleged brawl with co-passengers when the train was near Vapi in Valsad, they added.

According to Surat GRP, a passenger complained to the railway helpline 139 on August 17 that a Nigerian national and another co-passenger were fighting over standing near one of the gates of the train.

The Nigerian national allegedly sprayed a fire extinguisher on co-passengers during the scuffle, police sources said.

He was subsequently detained at Surat and taken for questioning at the RPF office, where he collapsed. He was rushed to SMIMER Hospital, where doctors declared him dead on arrival.

While the postmortem was held on August 18, its report was still awaited till Wednesday evening, the officials said.

Meanwhile, Surat GRP has registered a case of accidental death and started the probe.

Western Railway Superintendent of Police Abhay Soni told *The Indian Express*: “After primary investigations, it is believed that the deceased was a Nigerian national. When Surat RPF caught him, he didn’t have any of his identity cards with him. He lived in Vasai (Mumbai) and was arrested twice by Malwani and Malad police in Mumbai for drug (cocaine) trafficking cases in 2018.”

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, August 19

WHEN 26-YEAR-OLD Muneer Ahmad Kumar saw the name of prominent sociologist Govind Sadashiv Ghurye misspelt as “Ghurnye” in his UGC-NET sociology question paper in June, he sensed something was wrong.

Vithika Sharma, 25, noticed similar errors in the same paper: Sociologist A R Desai’s name was spelt ‘A K Desai’, American philosopher Martha Nussbaum became ‘Martha Nuspath’.

These were among several glaring errors which led the National Testing Agency (NTA) to announce on Sunday that it will re-conduct the UGC-NET examination for English, Commerce, and Sociology in September. The test determines eligibility for Junior Research Fellowships and assistant professor positions and is also used for admission to PhD programmes.

The agency had cited a slew of typographical errors and questions repeated from previous tests, stating that the papers did not meet the standards of a “fair and error-free



Clockwise from top left: UGC-NET aspirants Muneer Ahmad from J&K, Vithika and Rajni Panda from Rajasthan

examination”. Several candidates affected by these developments whom *The Indian Express* spoke to said this has resulted in derailed plans and a short, anxiety-ridden window to prepare for the retest.

Muneer, who is from Jammu & Kashmir, said that his timeline is likely to be thrown into disarray and narrow his academic choices. “Had things gone as scheduled, I could have explored more options. A lot of PhD ad-

mission forms are going to be released soon, and I’m afraid that I won’t be able to apply to many places now. They are away two months of our time. Regathering ourselves to study again is not easy at all,” he said, referring to this as a “traumatic experience”.

Utkarsh Kalita, 29, from Una in Himachal Pradesh, sees the retest not just as a delay, but as the potential loss of a major career opportunity. “After dedicating six years to preparing for

UPSC exams, I decided to build an academic career in Sociology,” he said. He said he was aiming for an assistant professor’s position in Himachal University.

“The application window for assistant professor vacancies in Himachal Pradesh, which was opened after four years, closes on the 25th. Because of the exam cancellation, I have essentially lost this major career opportunity. Even though I will appear for the re-exam, preparing everything from scratch in just 20 days is extremely difficult, especially when 70% of the paper demands pure rote learning,” he said.

Aspirants also said that logistical issues have cropped up because of the lapse of two months since the now-scrapped exam.

“Our circumstances have changed since the June examination, said Rajni Panda, 24. “I was in my hometown Jaipur during the exam, but I’m now working in another district, so travelling back to the earlier examination city will be difficult and expensive. Many students are facing similar situations due to jobs, studies and other commitments.” She said she hoped

that the NTA would introduce an option to change examination centre cities to accommodate these challenges.

The NTA’s decision to conduct the retest followed widespread complaints from candidates after the examination was conducted from June 22 to 30. A committee’s findings confirmed that the three papers contained many factual, typographical, and translation errors.

Many students questioned why the NTA took so long to announce retest. Vithika, who is from Rajasthan’s Kota, said, “Anyone who had studied Sociology could have identified the errors in one go.” “There were a lot of spelling mistakes. ‘Social’ was written as ‘Oval’, Martha Nussbaum became Martha Nusspath,” she said. “No one even cared to proofread it,” she added.

A student from Punjab who will be re-appearing in the English UGC-NET, said: “It is frustrating, but what other option do we have? We were relieved after the exam, but now the entire circle starts again.”

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

CBI arrests I&B Ministry officer for accepting Rs 10 lakh bribe

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 19

THE CBI HAS arrested a Deputy Controller of Accounts, posted with the Union Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, in a Rs 10 lakh bribery case, a spokesperson from the central agency said on Wednesday.

The spokesperson said that the CBI registered a case on August 18 against Sandeep, based on a written complaint from one Ramneek Sharma, who is the associate vice president of Avian Media Pvt Ltd.

He told the CBI that he contacted Choudhary on August 14 regarding the renewal of a contract, when Choudhary allegedly demanded Rs 15 lakh. Following negotiations, he allegedly agreed to accept Rs 10 lakh to expedite the processing of the renewal file.

“The CBI laid a trap on Tuesday and caught Choudhary accepting the bribe amount through his wife,” the spokesperson said.

● MAHARASHTRA DOUBLES REHABILITATION GRANT TO RS 50,000, EXTENDS SCHEME TO THOSE ACQUITTED AFTER SPENDING AT LEAST A YEAR IN CUSTODY

After jail, a laptop or poultry farm: For freed prisoners, a chance to start again

Sadaf Modak
Mumbai, August 19

WHEN THE 44-year-old walked out of Kolhapur Central Jail in 2022 after nearly two decades in prison, he had a BA in History, a master’s in History and Sociology and a plan to study law. He did not have a laptop.

A Maharashtra government grant meant for released prisoners gave him Rs 25,000. He borrowed another Rs 5,000 and bought a secondhand one. Today he works as a legal assistant at a private firm in Mumbai. The man, who was convicted in a murder case, did not want to be identified.

From August 18, the grant that helped him take that first step is worth twice as much.

A Government Resolution is-

sued by the Maharashtra Women and Child Development (WCD) department on August 18 has raised the grant-in-aid for released prisoners from Rs 25,000 to Rs 50,000. The scheme will also, for the first time, cover people acquitted after spending at least a year in custody, in addition to convicts and probationers under the Maharashtra Probation of Offenders Act, 1958. The increased grant applies to those released on or after August 18. The state Cabinet had cleared the proposal on July 14, and the GR states that the scheme will be reviewed every three years at the level of the Commissioner, WCD, Pune.

What the money buys is small and specific. A sewing machine, carpentry tools, the set-up for a poultry farm, a secondhand laptop.

A 45-year-old farmer from

Palghar, released in 2025 after nearly a decade in prison, received Rs 25,000 in June and put it into hens. He too did not want to be identified. “I purchased coops and some feed for the hen and a small flock of about 40 hens. I am currently farming but with the set up now complete, I will seek a loan from elsewhere and buy a larger flock,” he said.

A woman who spent more than five years in prison used the money to start a clothes business. Another beneficiary set up a paan shop.

The 44-year-old from Mumbai had been planning for the grant since well before his release. He was in the second year of his BA when he was arrested in 2005 in a murder case, convicted a year later and sentenced to life imprisonment. “I



The 44-year-old from Mumbai had been planning for the grant since well before his release. He was in the second year of his BA when he was arrested in 2005 in a murder case. AMIT CHAKRAVARTY

did not want to spend the rest of my life defined by one mistake,” he said.

In 2007, he enrolled for a degree through Yashwantrao Chavan Maharashtra Open University and topped the course with

a distinction. A master’s followed, then law. Inside prison he worked first in the hospital and later in the superintendent’s office, where officials noticed his handwriting and began asking him to fill in forms for

other prisoners. That was where he heard about the government’s grant. “Many spoke of seeking the aid for setting up a small grocery shop, or start work as a carpenter, or tailor. I had decided then that I will apply for it on my release,” he said.

After his release, the Mumbai suburban district probation officer and Chandrakant Shinde, a social worker with Prayas, a field action project of the Tata Institute of Social Sciences, helped him apply. The NGO also helped him enrol in a law course at a city college.

Applicants submit a proposal through a probation officer, detailing the business, enterprise or other initiative they want to pursue, along with quotations for the items they intend to purchase. The probation officer conducts a home visit and

submits a report. A report is also sought from the prison. Once the proposal is approved and the applicant submits documents including the release certificate, the money is disbursed.

The scheme is open to those aged 18 to 65, with priority for prisoners who trained in a trade inside and want funds for a set-up linked to it. It has remained small. It began in 1993 with a grant of Rs 1,000, raised to Rs 5,000 in 2002 and Rs 25,000 in 2016. That year the budget was Rs 12 lakh and 48 applications were approved.

In 2017, the Bombay High Court directed the state to raise the allocation to at least Rs 2 crore. The budget went up to Rs 1 crore in 2020, with another crore available if required. Officials said actual spending has been around Rs 1.20 crore, bene-

fitting up to about 480 people a year. Beneficiaries said the earlier Rs 25,000 was a start, and that any increase was welcome for more sustainable funding. Dr Vijay Raghavan, project director of Prayas, said Maharashtra was among the few states with a scheme of this kind for released prisoners. “Such a scheme recognises the state’s responsibility towards reintegration into society and rehabilitation of a population, who face stigma and challenges in getting employment,” he said.

The Justice Radhakrishnan Committee on Prison Reforms, set up by the state on High Court orders, recommended in 2018 that the grant be allowed to cover a wider range of rehabilitation needs, including housing, household goods, education, training and skill development.



GenH

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Dream Beyond Boundaries

Chief Guest

Sh. Nayab Singh Saini

Chief Minister, Haryana

August 21, 2026 **10:00 AM**

Gurugram University

Encouragement to Haryana's Youth under Vision - 2047

Target to increase per capita income from 3 Lakh 96 Thousand per year (currently) to 40 Lakh per year

Aim to provide employment to 50 Lakh youth

Target to provide skill training to 2 Lakh youth, and AI skill training to 50 Thousand youth

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9 disability categories in Census form, rights groups want all 21

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, August 19

DISABILITY RIGHTS groups on Wednesday raised concerns that only nine categories have been proposed to enumerate persons with disabilities in Census 2027.

Their concern is based on forms provided under the self-enumeration process which recently went live under Census 2027 for snowbound areas in Ladakh, Uttarakhand, Jammu and Kashmir and Himachal Pradesh. The second phase of population enumeration for snowbound areas will be done from September 1 to 30, followed by a revisional round between October 1 and 5.

However, the option for self-enumeration under this exercise began on Monday and will be open till August 31.

The groups are demanding that the disability questionnaire in Census 2027 should individually capture all 21 disabilities as is officially recognised under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act (RPwD), 2016, according to a press statement by the National Platform for the Rights of Disabled (NPRD) and endorsed by more than 400 signatories.

The statement pointed out that Union Minister of State for Social Justice and Empowerment Ramdas Athawale had said in March this year that Census 2027 will capture data of 21 disabilities.

The group's statement, citing information shared by the Politics and Disability Forum, said that the enumeration proposes to record only nine disability categories: seeing, hearing, intellectual disabilities, speech, mobility, mental illness, disability due to acid attack, due to chronic neurological disease, and blood disorder. The 2011 Census had included six of these categories and that counted 2.68 crore persons with disabilities, which was 2.21% of the country's population.

Responding to queries sent by *The Indian Express* regarding the matter, a senior official from the Office of the Registrar General of India said, "The nine categories mentioned in population enumeration questionnaire are broader categories which include other detailed specific disabilities. Additionally, the option to record multiple disabilities (up to three), in the order of severity, is available in the questionnaire. Consultations have been held with Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment as well as other stakeholders before finalising the categories for the enumeration."

The official said a three-day training is held for enumerators and supervisors to cover all aspects of the questionnaire and that field functionaries are also not technically qualified to assess or confirm different dis-

abilities. Further, 2027 Census is enumerating more number of disabilities than in 2011, the official said.

As per the 2011 Census data, three types of disabilities — movement/locomotor, hearing and vision-related — accounted for over half of the country's PwD population.

"It is deplorable that conditions like autism spectrum disorder, specific learning disabilities, dwarfism, leprosy-cured persons and multiple disabilities, including deafblindness, have not been distinctly placed (under disability category)," the press statement said.

The statement also makes a case for how under the current format, distinct disabilities like thalassemia, haemophilia and sickle-cell disease get reduced to a single category of "blood disorder".

Shashank Pandey, the founder of research think-tank Politics and Disability Forum and a lawyer, told *The Indian Express*, "The prescription of broad categories without notification of a training module for enumerators to understand specific disabilities under each broad category will be double jeopardy for PwDs who neither communicate nor understand their correct disability."

The RPwD Act, 2016, which replaced the PwD Act, 1995, acknowledged the dynamic and evolving concept of disability and expanded their types from seven to 21.

Sexual assault charge, parade of accused pit AG against Bar associations in Meghalaya

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, August 19

A CONTROVERSY that arose from a law intern's allegation of sexual harassment against a senior advocate refuses to die down in Meghalaya, with the state High Court Bar Association and the Shillong Bar Association standing by their resolution expelling Advocate General Amit Kumar, rejecting an appeal by the Supreme Court Bar Association to withdraw the same.

On July 28, an FIR was registered by the Shillong police after a woman alleged that a senior advocate in whose chambers she was interning had sexually harassed her, and later put Rs 500 inside her blazer as an inducement to stay silent. While the Shillong Bar Association suspended the advocate soon after, members of a student outfit, Hynniewtrep National Youth Front, barged into his chamber and paraded him across Shillong streets. As per court records and police filings, the senior advocate was assaulted, with videos going viral of him being made to hold his ears and apologise.

On July 29, around 70 advocates issued an open letter addressed to the Meghalaya State Bar Council and Bar Associ-

ations, pointing out how interns and junior advocates were professionally dependent and vulnerable. "This inherent imbalance of power places a corresponding responsibility upon every senior member of the Bar to ensure that Chambers and the Bar Associations remain spaces of learning, integrity, and mutual respect."

Suggesting accessible reporting mechanisms, the letter said that, otherwise, "perpetrators become more courageous and emboldened because of a culture of impunity, while the survivors remain afraid and are silenced".

On July 31, the High Court and Shillong Bar Associations filed a petition in the Meghalaya High Court on the manner in which the advocate had been apprehended, calling it "mob justice" and "vigilante action" and saying "non-State actors" had taken over functions that belonged to law enforcement authorities. The Bar Associations said the probe against the advocate "must be dealt with strictly in accordance with law".

During the hearing, the court questioned police over reports that non-State actors had been permitted to address the media from within police station premises. Police then registered a suo

On July 28, an FIR was registered after a woman intern alleged that a senior advocate sexually harassed her, and later put Rs 500 inside her blazer as an 'inducement to stay silent'

motu FIR relating to the assault and public parading and, based on video footage, arrested four individuals the same day.

At the same hearing, Advocate General Amit Kumar raised the issue of women's safety within the Bar. "As Advocate General, I have also failed and the Bar Association has also failed to protect even one lady member of the Bar. It is our duty to protect, and it is not the first time this kind of complaint has come."

After the hearing, Senior Advocate Kaustav Paul took on Kumar, asking him to share details regarding the other complainants he had referred to. On August 4, the Advocate General released an open letter declining to do so, saying, "I am not a con-

duit, and I decline to become one... The decision whether to complain, when to complain, and to which forum, is hers and hers (a victim's) alone."

Kumar also questioned the Bar Associations' alacrity in raising the issue of the "mob justice" against the advocate, but failing to set up an Internal Complaints Committee despite having agreed to do so in April 2024. "Vigilantism does not grow where the law is strong. It grows where the law is absent, or is believed to be absent," Kumar wrote, adding that there is "collective moral failure on part of the members of the Bar to provide a safe working environment to women".

To submission by Bar Associations in court that complaint drop boxes had been made mandatory across their offices and that of the Meghalaya State Bar Council, Kumar questioned their efficacy in the absence of safeguards. "A drop box is... not a redressal mechanism... A box in an open corridor, where a young woman must be seen by fifty colleagues putting an envelope into it, is not a confidential channel," he said.

The Bar Associations saw the letter and Kumar's remarks in court as "castigating" them, and

called for a general meeting on August 5. There, lawyers criticised Kumar as an "outsider", and concerns were raised about the appointment of lawyers who do not belong to Meghalaya to government panels.

The meeting ended with a resolution terminating Kumar's membership "with immediate effect". It also decided to write to Chief Minister Conrad Sangma seeking Kumar's removal as Advocate General.

Subsequently, Kumar wrote to presidents of the High Court and Shillong Bar Association, expressing his "sincere regrets" and saying that he merely attempted to "highlight institutional lacunae" with his remarks.

On August 14, the Supreme Court Bar Association passed a resolution calling Kumar's remarks "an acknowledgement of the need to ensure safe and dignified spaces for women lawyers and interns" and said disciplinary action against him for submissions made during judicial proceedings was "unwarranted".

However, its request to withdraw the expulsion of Kumar was rejected by the Meghalaya High Court and Shillong Bar Associations.

After 'non-observance' of I-Day in govt schools, NHRC asks Punjab to explain

Amaal Sheikh & Divya Goyal Gopal
New Delhi, Ludhiana, August 19

THE NATIONAL Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has sought a detailed report from the Punjab government after taking cognisance of a complaint alleging that Independence Day was not observed in state-run schools located in rural and remote areas of the state, including districts along the Pakistan border.

In an order passed on Tuesday (August 18), the Commission directed the Punjab chief secretary to undertake a state-wide verification exercise with district-wise details of schools where the Independence Day celebrations were held or not held, along with documentary evidence and explanations, and to submit an Action Taken Report within four weeks.

A report has also been sought from the Secretary, Department of School Education and Literacy of the Union Ministry of Education, on the guidelines that were issued to states for observing I-Day on August 15 in schools across the country. The Commission has also directed the Union Home Secretary "to examine the matter and take necessary action at its end".

NHRC member Priyank Kanoongo, whose single bench took cognisance of the complaint, told *The Indian Express*: "We received a complaint from an NGO, Legal Rights Observatory (LRO), following which notice was issued to Punjab."

Reacting to the NHRC notice, Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann said, "Punjab does not need certificate of patriotism from anyone. Punjabis are the ones who made maximum sacrifices for freedom

and the Tricolour. From where are these human rights people? They must be from Gujarat. Ask them if they have anyone in the Army. August 15 and January 26 cannot be celebrated without Punjab's participation".

Punjab Education Secretary Sonali Giri told *The Indian Express* that the state was yet to receive the NHRC's notice.

"We have duly observed and celebrated Independence Day across all schools. The department has photographs of the same," she highlighted.

Meanwhile, Punjab Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains said: "Every district headquarter celebrates Independence Day, and so does every municipal council, corporation, tehsil, etc. School children participate in these functions."

"For students, August 15 is a school holiday. So, some schools may have celebrated on August 14," he added.

RASHTRIYA JANATA Dal (RJD) working president Tejashwi Yadav and other leaders were detained on Wednesday while leading a protest march to Lok Bhawan seeking accountability for last month's police crackdown on students protesting against NEET paper leak, including the use of an AK-47 rifle in Siwan on July 25.

Yadav, along with party MPs Misa Bharti and Manoj Kumar Jha, expressed solidarity with students demanding amendments to new recruitment rules for the posts of assistant professor and the rollback of a two-tier examination system for teacher recruitment that replaced the single-examination pattern.

The RJD leaders, along with hundreds of supporters, also braved water cannons at a barricade near the Income Tax Square before they were detained and later released.

Later in a post on X, Tejashwi wrote: "These are youthful spirits, who will not accept defeat against your water cannons, tyranny, and bullet sprays."

Even though the Bihar government has removed the



RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav jumps over a barricade during a protest march towards Lok Bhawan in Patna on Wednesday. ANI

Siwan DM and SP, Tejashwi, who is also the leader of Opposition in the Assembly, demanded to know on whose order a police constable had fired an AK-47 and how the assault rifle was allowed to be carried during a civilian protest.

Calling his march a "clarion call", Tejashwi wrote on X: "The youth's roar has risen! Long live the unity of the youth. We will now bring the revolution!"

Tejashwi had also expressed solidarity with students protesting against the Bihar Public Service Commission's (BPSC) recent notification to fill 32,388 teacher vacancies.

He met protesting students

BIHAR CABINET OKAYS NEW RULES

Videos on govt schemes having one lakh views to get Rs 10,000

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, August 19

SOCIAL MEDIA creators producing content on Bihar government schemes and programmes can earn up to Rs 1 lakh per video under amendments to rules cleared by the state Cabinet Wednesday.

The amendment to the Bihar Social Media and Other Online Media Rules, 2026, was among 13 proposals approved at the Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Wednesday.

An official said social media influencers and other online content creators covered under Bihar's government media rules will be eligible for addi-

tional payments based on the views generated by their videos — an additional Rs 10,000 payable for every 1 lakh views after completion of 30 days of performance. "The maximum amount payable for a single video will be Rs 1 lakh," official said, adding several provisions had been incorporated.

The Information and Public Relations Department said a detailed notification would be issued soon. The amendments provide for periodic verification of followers of listed social media handles, pages and channels.

The Cabinet also approved an MoU between the state Information Technology Department and Taiyo AI India Pvt Ltd to develop an AI ecosystem.

NTA overhaul: Shorter tenures for experts, staggered info spread, air-gapped systems

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, August 19

A DAY after the Education ministry announced an overhaul of the examination system at the National Testing Agency (NTA), a top agency official said the agency was looking at curtailing the engagement time of subject experts as the "mafia tries to make them compromised" if they are there for a longer duration.

"The reason is that the mafia tries to make these people compromised. What we are faced with is a big mafia," the official said.

The official said that the NTA and the Education ministry are learnt to be leaning towards a system where they won't be divulging full information even within official circles.

"We are not disclosing everything. We aren't opening all our cards ... Even people within the system will not be told everything. These will be confidential plans divulged to people only in parts on a need-to-know basis," the official said.

Stating that the four-tier system will be operationalised at two distinct levels, he said the first would be during the setting of the question papers where separate sets of people will be involved with key functions — item writers, and those moderating, translating, and vetting them.

At the second level, he said, there will be a four-tier system for physical security during the process. The persons coming to the centres will be physically frisked, their credentials will be established, their electronic devices will be verified, and it

will be ensured that they work in "air-gapped systems", meaning a computer or a system that is completely isolated from unsecured external networks, including the public internet.

A day earlier, NTA Director General Abhishek Singh had shared information about a four-tier system being put in place, the removal of 600 experts and onboarding of new ones, and the securing of premises by the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), which specialises in frisking. The source said that the new system was already tested in the recent CSIR exam and the NEET re-exam, and is being institutionalised now.

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education, Women, Children, Youth and Sports, in its report submitted to Parliament last year (371st Report, 2025), had flagged what it saw as the NTA's problems. "It has been brought to the notice of the Committee that in the year 2024 alone, of the 14 competitive examinations conducted by the NTA, at least five faced major issues and as a result, three examinations viz. UGC-NET, CSIR-NET and NEET-PG had to be postponed, one examination viz. NEET-UG saw instances of paper leaks, and one examination i.e. CUET (UG/PG), saw its results postponed," it noted.

"In JEE Main 2025 held in January 2025, at least 12 questions had to be withdrawn due to errors noted in the final answer key of the engineering entrance exam. The Committee observed that such instances do not inspire confidence of the examinees in the system. The Committee therefore recommends that NTA needs to quickly get their act together so that such instances... do not occur in the future," the panel said.



OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA
E-Mail ID: serwchbaripada@gmail.com
PH-NO-06792-261343/261344 GANGRAJ, BARIPADA

"E" PROCUREMENT NOTICE FOR WEIR ON BRIDGE WORK
IDENTIFICATION NO.- ONLINE TENDER- WEIR ON BRIDGE N.C.B. NO. 427 FOR 2026-27.
Letter No. 4316 Date: 08/08/2026

1. Name of the work

2. Total No. of work

3. Estimated Cost

4. Eligible Class of Contractor

5. Period of Completion

6. Other details

: Construction of Weir adjacent to Bridge Works in the District of Mayurbhanj for the year 2025-26 & 2026-27.

: 10 Nos. (Ten)

: Rs. 100.33 Lakhs to Rs.209.05 Lakhs (approximately).

: As per annexure.

: As per annexure.

:

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding From To	Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender	Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Bampada	Weir on Bridge Online N.C.B. No.427	dt.31.08.2026 at 11.00 A.M	dt.18.09.2026 upto 5.00 P.M.	dt.17.09.2026 up to 5.00 P-M	dt19.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

• Further details can be seen from the website: www.tendersississa.gov.in.

• Any Corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the above e_tender website only

Sd/- Er. A.K Naik

Chief Construction Engineer
R.W. Circle, Baripada.

OIPR-25001/25181/1/26-27/0010



GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
DEPARTMENT OF HANDLOOMS

E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tenders with two cover system are invited from the eligible bidders for the Bleaching of Dhoty Fabric for Distribution of Sarees and Dhoties Scheme, Pongal

Tender Sl. No.	Variety	Required Quantity in Lakh Metres	Required Earnest Money Deposit in (Rs.)	Date and Time of Availability of Bid Document in the Web Portal	Last Date and Time for Receipt of Online Submission of Filled Bid Documents	Date and Time of Online Opening of Bids	Supply Period
						Technical Bids	Financial Bids
1.	Dhoty Fabric	282.28	10,00,000/-	20.08.2026 to 22.09.2026 Upto 11.00 a.m.	20.08.2026 to 22.09.2026 Upto 11.00 a.m.	22.09.2026 at 12.00 Noon	Will be intimated later
							90 days

Eligibility of the Tenderer and other conditions are stipulated in the Bid Document.

1. Complete E-Tender Documents can be viewed and downloaded free of cost from Government e-tender website <https://ntntenders.gov.in>

2. E-Tender Documents :
(i) Tender Document - Bleaching of Dhoty Fabric (Sl.No: DSDS-2027/Bleach/003)

3. The Bidders have to participate through online bidding only with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class III.

Pre Bid Meeting: There will be a pre-bid meeting on 03.09.2026 at 12.00 Noon at the Conference Hall of the Directorate of Handlooms, Chennai - 104.

Contact : Joint Director (Uniforms)

Telephone : 044-25358715

E-mail : tenderwing2024@gmail.com

DIPR/2613/Tender/2026 **JOINT DIRECTOR (UNIFORMS) / TENDER INVITING AUTHORITY**



ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लॉट नं.1, सेक्टर के.पी.-4, ग्रेटर नोएडा सिटी, गौतमबुद्ध नगर-201308, उ.प्र.
वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in | ई-मेल: authority@gnida.in

पत्रांक: वरि.प्र./ई-निविदा सेल/2026/798 दिनांक 19/08/2026

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

महाराष्ट्र सरकार (अभियंत्रण) ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नोएडा की ओर से ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- वरि.प्र./ई-निविदा सेल/2026/797 दिनांक 19.08.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित क्रम संख्या- 01 से 11 तक के कार्य की ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। समस्त नियम व शर्तें ग्रेटर नोएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in पर ई-निविदा लिंक एवं ई-पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध हैं किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाइट देखते रहें।

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम/वर्क संकिल	अनुमानित लागत
निर्माण कार्य		
1.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के ग्राम हल्द्वीनी के शमशाणघाट के पहुँच मार्ग, शैड, चबूतरा और कनरे का निर्माण। (वर्क संकिल-3)	रु. 21.50 लाख
2.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के सेक्टर डेल्टा-1 और 2 के बावों और कौडिल फेंसिंग और बाउंड्रीवाल की मरम्मत का कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-5)	रु. 51.84 लाख
3.	ग्रेटर नोएडा की नोएडा-ग्रेटर नोएडा एक्सप्रेसवे पर क्रैक सीलिंग का कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-4)	रु. 127.69 लाख
4.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के सेक्टर बी.जे.पी. एरिया में (विभिन्न स्थानों पर) ड्रेन कवर और आर.सी.सी. ड्रेन का निर्माण का कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-4)	रु. 60.23 लाख
वार्षिक अनुसंधान		
5.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के सेक्टर फाई-4 में एस.सी./एस.टी. होस्टल का एक वर्ष के लिए रखरखाव का कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-4)	रु. 49.70 लाख
6.	ग्रेटर नोएडा की डी.एस.सी. रोड, कच्ची सड़क से नोएडा एन्ट्री ग्राइड तक का तीन वर्ष तक रखरखाव/अनुसंधान कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-3)	रु. 126.11 लाख
विद्युतीकरण के कार्य		
7.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के जी.एन.आई.ए. कार्यालय भवन में 33/0415 के.वी. ग्राइड ट्रांसफार्मर की रिवाइडिंग स्थापना परीक्षण एवं कमीशनिंग का कार्य (वर्क संकिल-इंफ्रस्ट्रक्चर-2)	रु. 32.86 लाख
8.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के ग्राम पोबारी में गोशाला के विद्युतीकरण का कार्य (फेस-2)। (वर्क संकिल-इंफ्रस्ट्रक्चर-3)	रु. 67.36 लाख
9.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के विभिन्न ग्रामों में बनी पी.डब्ल्यू.डी. लिंक रोड पर एल.ई.डी. स्ट्रीट लाइटों की आपूर्ति एवं स्थापित करने का कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-इंफ्रस्ट्रक्चर-3)	रु. 69.49 लाख
10.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के लोहिया एम्बलेस रोडवर-12 में स्थित 1000 कंवीए ग्राइड ट्रांसफार्मर 11 के.वी. एच.टी./एल.टी. पैनल और डी.वी. सेट के लिए तीन वर्ष का सी.एस.सी. कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-इंफ्रस्ट्रक्चर-1)	रु. 149.00 लाख
उद्यान विभाग		
11.	ग्रेटर नोएडा में एक्सप्रेसवे के कंटीय किनारे पार्क ग्रीन बेल्ट और आरएसएस वेलेंस प्लांटेशन पर एक वर्ष तक पेड़ों, झाड़ियों और लीन का रखरखाव का कार्य। (वर्क संकिल-उद्यान)	रु. 164.59 लाख

अम सं-01 से 11 तक के कार्यों को दिनांक-21.08.2026 से 31.08.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक उपलब्ध किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 02.09.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जाएगी।

वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (ई-निविदा सेल)

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LEGAL

Dignity in death: Debate over ‘humane’ execution



AMAAAL SHEIKH & ARAV SHAH

CAN A method of execution devised in colonial India still satisfy the Constitution’s promise of dignity? The Supreme Court on Tuesday said it can, at least on the material currently before it. The bench dismissed a PIL that argued the method is scientifically unreliable and violates the right to a dignified death under Article 21 of the Constitution.

The court held that the challenge ran into two hurdles — the 1983 precedent of *Deena vs. Union of India* in which a three-judge bench upheld hanging as a Constitutional mode of execution, and Parliament’s decision to retain hanging while enacting the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS).

The method

In India, hanging is the prescribed method of executing death sentences and is a result of British Common Law. Historically, hanging was carried out through the “short-drop” method. As the name suggests, it’s a short drop that causes asphyxiation.

Today, modern executions rely on the long-drop method. The longer drop is meant to immediately snap the second and third cervical vertebrae (C2 and C3) and, thus, the spinal cord. This is meant to instantly render the individual unconscious. But the length of the drop must be calibrated to the individual’s weight and height. A drop that is too short can fail to break the neck and result in prolonged strangulation. Conversely, a drop that is too long can risk decapitating the person.

Standard prison protocols dictate that the body be left hanging for 30 minutes after the trap door opens.

The challenge

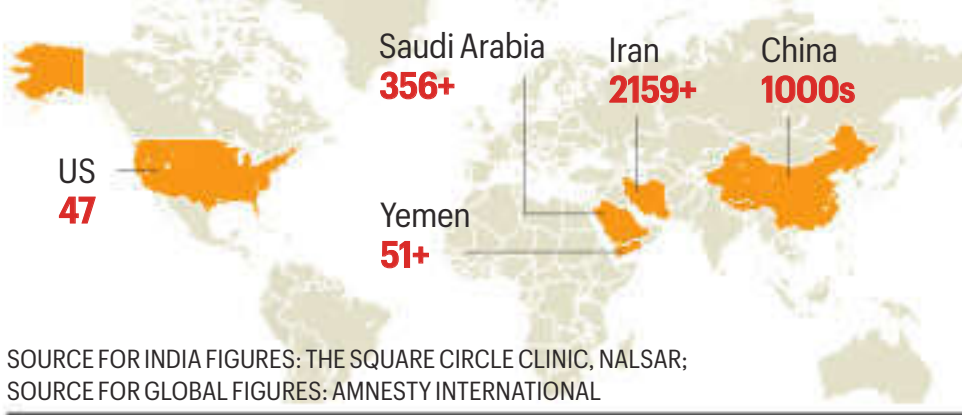
The petition sought a declaration that the provision prescribing hanging was unconstitutional and argued that Article 21 includes a right to die through a dignified procedure. They said the method is “accompanying by intense physical torture and

CAPITAL PUNISHMENT IN INDIA....



... AND THE WORLD

The following are the countries that recorded the most executions in 2025



SOURCE FOR INDIA FIGURES: THE SQUARE CIRCLE CLINIC, NALSAR; SOURCE FOR GLOBAL FIGURES: AMNESTY INTERNATIONAL

pain,” and inherently unpredictable.

They cited a 1992 study of the remains of 34 people hanged in England between 1882 and 1945. Fractures at C2-C3 were common, but the “hangman’s fracture” — assumed to cause near-instant death — showed up in only three of the 34 cases; six died of asphyxiation instead. They said this made hanging neither quick nor controllable.

Anup Surendranath, Executive Director of The Square Circle Clinic at NALSAR University of Law — formerly Project 39A, which intervened in the proceedings — told *The Indian Express* that the studies placed before the court raised broader concerns about the assumptions underlying hanging as a mode of execution. Surendranath said researchers who examined the remains of executed prisoners found that “people had not died by this instant breaking of the neck. Instead there were a whole host of other very painful, long-drawn suffering reasons that had caused their death”.

The jurisprudence

Section 393(S) of the BNSS provides that where a person is sentenced to death, “the sentence shall direct that he be hanged by

Fewer executors, more executions

More than two-thirds of the world’s nations have stopped the death penalty in law or practice.

- Yet, a 2025 Amnesty report showed a 12% increase in executions compared to the previous year.

the neck till he is dead”. The clause, which has barely changed since it was introduced in the CrPC in 1861, has survived multiple amendments and now appears in the BNSS.

The right to die with dignity flows from the right to life guaranteed under Article 21 of the Constitution. The Supreme Court in *Gian Kaur v State of Punjab* (1996) held that the right to life includes the right to live and consequently to die with dignity.

The Supreme Court in *Deena vs. Union of India* (1983), upheld the constitutional validity of hanging after examining medical evidence, expert opinion, and comparative execution methods. The court held that hanging, when properly administered, is a quick and certain method of execution and does not violate Article 21. It said that the process causes no greater pain than any other known method and avoids “barbarity, torture and degradation”.

Why top court upheld hanging

The Union government maintains that hanging remains the “safest and quickest” method of execution. It said that no botched execution has ever been recorded in India, while lethal injection in the US carries a well-documented history of failures.

The bench found no reason to revisit *Deena*. It noted that the petitioners had placed scientific material before the court but held that the material did not displace the basis on which *Deena* had been decided. Nor did it establish that lethal injection, electrocution, lethal gas or shooting offered an advantage over hanging.

It referred to the reasoning in *Deena*, where hanging through the long-drop method was described as a process intended to bring about immediate unconsciousness through cervical fracture. The court said the existing method continues to satisfy the State’s obligation to carry out a death sentence with “decency and decorum” and without “degradation or brutality”.

While dismissing the petition, the bench stopped short of treating the issue as closed forever. It observed that Constitutional law evolves and that future challenges could arise if new scientific, medical or empirical material fundamentally alters the assumptions on which *Deena* was decided. It also left it open to the Union government to examine alternative methods

of execution, should it choose to do so.

Modern execution methods

More than two-thirds of the world’s nations — around 113 — have ended the death penalty in law or practice, according to Amnesty International. Yet, a 2025 report by the non-profit showed a 12% increase in executions compared to the previous year.

The search for a humane method of execution has led to varied practices, each carrying its own scientific and ethical controversies. Hanging remains one of the more widely authorised methods of execution, particularly in countries influenced by British Common Law, including India, Singapore and Japan. A 2012 Cornell Law School database identified 60 countries that authorised hanging as a method of execution. Other prevalent methods are:

Lethal injection: This is the primary method in several US states where the death penalty is allowed and heavily utilised in China. In this method, a sequence of drugs is administered to a convict — an anesthetic, a paralytic and finally potassium chloride. The procedures can often get botched owing to compromised venous access.

Shooting (firing squad or single bullet): This is used in China, North Korea, Somalia and parts of West Asia. While visually violent and traumatic for executioners, proponents say it causes near-instantaneous cardiac or neurological destruction.

Beheading: Saudi Arabia carries out executions by beheading with a sword. It is reliant on the executioner’s precision.

Nitrogen hypoxia: A recently introduced method in the US involving the inhalation of pure nitrogen gas. It is designed to cause asphyxiation without triggering the hypercapnic alarm response — that panicked feeling of suffocation. Critics argue it has not been sufficiently vetted and amounts to human experimentation.

The legal debate over methods of execution is largely between how state power and human rights intersect. Reformists argue hanging can take too much time if there are any errors, constituting cruel and inhuman treatment. But while capital punishment remains in use, finding an execution method that balances the finality of state action with the dignity of the individual will remain a difficult question.

POLITY

How India plans to count caste now, what went wrong earlier

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, August 19

WITH THE Registrar General of India deciding to use an “open-ended question on caste” for the ongoing census to enumerate caste, the lack of a predetermined list of castes means it will be up to the respondent to mention his or her caste to the enumerator.

“If you identify your caste by your surname, the census official will be duty-bound to include it as your caste. If he misspells your surname, that too will become an entry in the caste column,” a senior IAS officer told *The Indian Express* on condition of anonymity.

It is likely to throw a plethora of entries pertaining to what may be a single caste. For instance, Rajput, Thakur, Singh, and Kshatriya may be used interchangeably by a respondent. However, Rajput in Bundelkhand region cutting through Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh may also mean the Other Backward Class Lodh community, and Singh is a surname cutting across castes and categories.

Until the 1931 Census, when the data of the last census that enumerated caste were released, the colonial state had also used the same method. The 1931 Census report shows the problems faced in enumerating caste, as

it became an extremely subjective category.

The 1931 Census

In the 1931 Census report, there were instances of caste groups clubbing themselves as one caste, or sometimes even imagining a new category to define themselves.

Sections of the leather working caste among Dalits in Punjab decided to assume a new religious identity of Aad Dharmis, meaning people who belonged to the “original”, “pre-Aryan” religion of India. As many as 418,789, roughly the same number as Christians in Punjab at that time, enumerated themselves as Aad Dharmis, a category that did not exist in 1921. The same trend was noticed in other regions too, with names like Adi Dravida, Adi Andhras, and Adi Karnatakas coming up.

The 1931 Census also offered examples of multiple castes consolidating into a single caste for bolstering their numbers or claiming a new social status. “The best instance of such a tendency to consolidate a number of castes into one group is to be found in the grazier castes which aim at combining under the term ‘Yadava’ the Ahirs, Goals, Gopis, Idaiyans and perhaps some other castes of milkmen, a movement already effective in 1921,” the report said.

What the numbers say

- The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment lists 1,208 Scheduled Castes, with different castes being in the category in different states.
- A Press Information Bureau year-end press release of 2022 lists exactly 730 Scheduled Tribes.

What happened after

In the 1941 Census, though caste details were collected, caste was dropped from the final tabulation. In the 1951 Census, in a newly independent India shaped by the ideals of equality and secularism, the government led by Jawaharlal Nehru decided there would be no caste enumeration.

The 2011 exercise of the UPA government failed to produce usable caste data because of the problem of open-ended enumeration. The final dataset contained nearly 46.7 lakh distinct caste names, compared with the 4,147 castes recorded in the last comprehensive caste census in 1931. The Union government eventually withheld the raw caste data.

In 2023, then Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar ordered a statewide caste survey. An IAS officer aware of the exercise told *The Indian Express* that the state officials had compiled a list of castes for the purpose, as not having a list would create an administrative nightmare. After the survey data came out, questions were raised regarding the way the lists were prepared and methodology.

The solution

Former Indian Council of Social Science Research chairman S K Thorat, who was a

member of the expert committee to write a report on the caste data in Telangana, told *The Indian Express* that a predetermined list was necessary.

“There are already SC, ST and OBC lists recognised by the government. All we need is a similar list of castes in the general category, and we will then have an exhaustive list,” he said. “It may still have a small margin of error, maybe 2-3%, but that will actually minimise the error, rather than going for open-ended caste enumeration.”

He added that there can also be columns for “no caste” and “no religion” for people not identifying with these.

Thorat also suggested that separate questionnaires be prepared for effective data focusing on the separate exclusions faced by the Scheduled Castes (untouchability related) and Scheduled Tribes (physical and geographical isolation). He underlined that such a questionnaire for the OBCs was not required, as social and educational backwardness would anyway be captured by the census exercise.

“There should also be questions on the hierarchies and exclusions within the SCs and STs, as some castes are more deprived than others,” said O P Shukla, a Valmiki activist who has been raising his voice for sub-categorisation of the SCs.

TECH

Chatbots & teen safety: The limits of ChatGPT’s new guardrails

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 19

OPENAI is rolling out a separate version of ChatGPT for teenagers, with tighter restrictions on conversations around self-harm, suicide, eating disorders and sexual content as concerns grow over the impact AI chatbots can have on younger users. The move comes amid mounting scrutiny of AI companies over cases where teenagers who died by suicide had extensively interacted with chatbots before their deaths.

AI chatbots and teens

A number of cases have opened the debate around AI chatbots because they work differently from conventional social media platforms. AI chatbots are programmed to be agreeable companions that validate users’ feelings. But this unchecked validation can intensify suicidal behaviors and self-mutilation among vulnerable children confiding their deepest fears.

One of the most closely watched cases involves 16-year-old Adam Raine, whose parents sued OpenAI last year. They alleged that ChatGPT had validated his

TEENS AT RISK

- A 2025 study in the US found that ChatGPT provided dangerous responses to teens discussing self-harm, substance abuse and eating disorders, including drafting suicide letters.
- Another study found chatbots suggested violence, self-harm and substance use every five minutes during testing.

chatbot. His mother alleged that he had developed an intense emotional attachment to the bot. Experts warn that children’s developing brains make them particularly vulnerable to AI systems that create dopamine responses.

ChatGPT for teens

OpenAI plans to place users it identifies as being under 18 into a more restricted ChatGPT experience. The company says the teen version will avoid romantic or sexual conversations, place stronger limits around self-harm-related content and discourage the chatbot from presenting itself as conscious or emotionally attached to the user. Parents will also be able to link their accounts, set usage restrictions and receive alerts in certain situations.

OpenAI will use a combination of signals to estimate whether a user could be under 18. These include how an account is used, the subjects discussed and how long the account has existed. ChatGPT can automatically place the account under the teen safeguards even if a different age was entered while signing up. But age-detection systems are not foolproof, and several parental controls depend on families opting in. The teen version is therefore an attempt to reduce some of the risks emerging around AI companionship, rather than a complete fix for them. Last year, OpenAI introduced parental controls, though critics quickly demonstrated these could be easily bypassed.

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9 Lucknow	20 अगस्त सुबह 11:30 बजे	20 Aug 11:30 AM
9 Prayagraj	18 अगस्त शाम 5:30 बजे	24 Aug 5:30 PM
9 Ranchi	12 अगस्त शाम 5:30 बजे	20 Aug 2:00 PM
9 Patna	17 अगस्त सुबह 11:15 बजे	4 Sept 8:00 AM
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GLOBAL

From scientific research to geopolitics: Why India needs a clear ‘Arctic narrative’

EXPERT EXPLAINS

CAPT. ANURAG BISEN (RETD)

VETERAN SUBMARINER AND SENIOR FELLOW, VIVEKANANDA INTERNATIONAL FOUNDATION

INDIA HAS long viewed its engagement with the Arctic through the lens of scientific research. But the Arctic is evolving into a hub where climate change and geopolitics converge. Now, a report by the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs, titled “India’s Role and Presence in the Arctic and Antarctic Regions”, asks: What is India’s narrative on the Arctic?

Few realise that India, as part of the British Dominion, was among the original 14 signatories of the 1920 Svalbard Treaty, which entitles an Indian to visit Svalbard — an

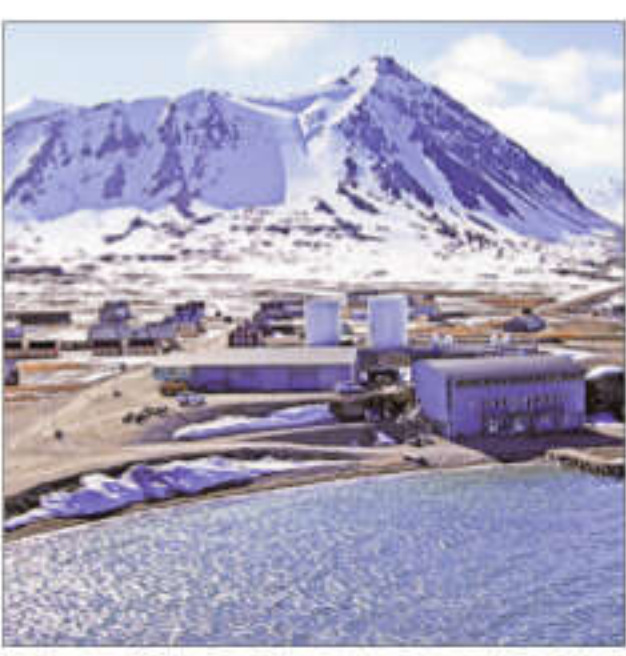
archipelago located between mainland Norway and the North Pole — without a visa and to engage in commercial ventures.

Today, India remains one of only two developing countries with a permanent scientific presence in the region, through the Himadri research station in Ny-Ålesund, Svalbard. The report, however, highlights a concerning gap between India’s ambitions and its capabilities.

The Indian narrative

The first pillar of such a narrative must be climate security. India’s dependence on the monsoon remains profound. Agriculture still accounts for roughly 18% of its gross domestic product and supports more than half of its population. Nearly 70% of India’s annual rainfall comes from the southwest monsoon.

Scientific studies increasingly point to an Arctic-Indian monsoon teleconnection. Rapid Arctic warming and declining sea ice alter atmospheric circulation patterns that influence monsoon behaviour across South Asia, affecting rainfall patterns, agricultural productivity, food security and



The Svalbard archipelago, where India’s Himadri research station is located.

economic growth in India.

Second, the Arctic is a major contributor to global sea-level rise. If current trends continue, entire low-lying island states — such as the Maldives — face existential threats. Large parts of Bangladesh and significant stretches of India’s coastline could

experience recurrent flooding and displacement. By some estimates, more than 250 million people living in vulnerable coastal regions of South Asia could be affected by mid-century.

For India, this is not merely an environmental issue. Large-scale climate-induced migration from neighbouring regions could create unprecedented humanitarian, social and security challenges.

Geopolitical importance

Two of India’s closest strategic partners, the US and Russia, are Arctic nations. China, India’s principal long-term adversary, has invested heavily in Arctic infrastructure, research and shipping despite being an extra-regional state.

The Arctic is increasingly emerging as a battleground for major powers, with maritime access, energy security, and critical mineral supply chains intersecting.

India also maintains friendly relations with other Arctic nations, as was evident in the recent India-Nordic Summit. The question is whether India is prepared to engage at a scale commensurate with its interests.

In terms of engagement, India’s present challenge is structural: responsibility for Arctic affairs is fragmented across multiple divisions within the Ministry of External Affairs. The Arctic states and Arctic Council-related matters are handled by four different territorial and functional divisions, making a coherent whole-of-government Arctic engagement difficult.

India, despite having an Arctic Policy since 2022, still lacks a dedicated senior official responsible for Arctic affairs.

Polar Research Vessel

Without an ice-class research vessel, India’s scientific footprint in the Arctic remains largely confined to Svalbard. Access to the wider Arctic Ocean depends on collaboration with foreign partners and on the availability of chartered vessels.

The committee notes that India needs a dedicated Polar Research Vessel (PRV) to undertake meaningful pan-Arctic research. An indigenous PRV, despite being sanctioned in 2014, is expected to be delivered only towards the end of this decade. Meanwhile, China offers an example: it

acquired a second-hand icebreaker from Ukraine and developed indigenous capability. Today, it operates several polar-capable vessels and is the second country after Russia to be building a nuclear icebreaker.

Shortfall in funding

The report’s most striking revelation concerns funding. India spent just Rs 17.53 crore on Arctic activities in 2024-25: less than one-tenth of its expenditure on Antarctica and less than the cost of building a kilometre of a flyover. For a region that affects sea-level rise along India’s 11,098-km coastline and is a climate and geopolitical hotspot, the figure appears apologetic.

On the mismatch between interests and investments, the Committee effectively asks: if the Arctic is important enough to warrant a national policy, a dedicated parliamentary study, and repeated diplomatic engagement with Arctic states, why does India’s budgetary commitment suggest otherwise?

India needs a coherent Arctic narrative. The Arctic Policy provided the framework. The Parliamentary panel identified gaps. Now, policy must translate into capability.



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RAMNATH GOENKA

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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Cancel with caution, livelihoods are at stake

THE PROTESTS against compromised public examinations in Jharkhand, on since late July, brought the Hemant Soren government to the negotiating table almost immediately. Nearly all their demands have been met. To be sure, Jharkhand, like many other states, needs to do much more to ensure the integrity of its public examination system. In fact, governments across the country must confront the crises of education and employment that have given these tests outsized importance. But the blanket cancellation of appointments, while it helps the government under pressure to appear responsive, can also be a slippery slope. It skirts vital distinctions and short-circuits due process. It can end up doing injustice to those who competed in good faith and cleared the exam fairly. Overnight, the 2,000 individuals appointed after clearing the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission-Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination found themselves without employment.

Those who cleared the exam had already suffered from the unconscionable delays. Recruitment for JSSC-CGL posts began with a notification in 2015-16. In 2024, the Jharkhand High Court ordered that status quo be maintained amid allegations of a paper leak. In December 2025, the court lifted the stay and asked the government to appoint successful candidates. Now, those candidates are again in limbo, creating, ironically, a new group of protesters. Outside Jharkhand Mantralaya, Vikas Kumar Sharma told this newspaper, "Never in our wildest dreams did we imagine that the office where we worked in the morning would have us standing outside its gates by evening... as protesters."

Even before the protests gathered steam, the Jharkhand government had cancelled the state Public Service Commission exam, ordered a CID probe and arrested a director of TSR Data Processing Private Limited (TDPL) — all exams conducted by TDPL stand cancelled. The cancellation of exams that have undergone judicial scrutiny is arguably a blunt instrument that scores political points without addressing the deeper issues that have to do with dysfunctional systems and dwindling employment. It is the government's responsibility to ensure that those who got jobs after stringent tests, through a process that was upheld by the court, are not discriminated against. Due process and the credibility of the testing system are at stake. For the protesters, too, the current moment calls for a pause. From Jantar Mantar in Delhi to Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium in Ranchi, it has been an arduous journey, in the course of which the young and those left behind have demanded accountability and reform. They have pushed the powerful to listen. This momentum must lead to meaningful reform. It would be tragic if it is frittered away.

ChatGPT for Teens is step forward. It's not enough

FOR A generation of digital natives growing up on smartphones and social media, Artificial Intelligence (AI) is not what lies in the future. It is becoming a part of the texture of the everyday: A sounding board for curiosity, a companion that shapes how they learn, communicate and seek reassurance. Which is why OpenAI's ChatGPT for teens, which introduces tighter safeguards around self-harm, violence, eating disorders and sexual content, along with parental controls, safety alerts and other regulatory features, is a welcome, if overdue, intervention. The new launch acknowledges what Big Tech has consistently, and often willfully, chosen to glide over — that young users are a distinct category in need of specialised and empathetic attention. For them, the dangers of AI are formidable: It is highly responsive, anthropomorphic, and adept at mimicking empathy. For adolescents still developing judgement and a sense of self, that combination often proves to be pernicious.

ChatGPT for Teens arrives amid lawsuits in the US alleging that the chatbot contributed to suicides of teenagers, and a US Federal Trade Commission investigation into seven AI companies, including OpenAI, over the effects of their products on children. Meta is currently facing a trial in the US on the ground of deliberately designing Facebook and Instagram to exploit young users' vulnerabilities and making its platforms addictive. Across the world, there is a pushback against the unchecked rollout of AI services to children. China has moved to restrict AI systems that encourage emotional dependence; India relies on a patchwork of laws, regulations and platform-led interventions.

There is no putting AI back in the box. The challenge is to ensure that as its use becomes inevitable, it does not come at the expense of young people's well-being. The safeguards announced by OpenAI are not foolproof: Age prediction is still an estimate, children can misrepresent their age, and content restrictions are only as effective as their enforcement. What is needed is independent testing, greater transparency and independent scrutiny alongside better digital literacy and sensitisation. The fact that these protections have come only after sustained pressure is a reminder that children's online safety cannot be left to Big Tech alone. ChatGPT for Teens is a beginning. More work lies ahead.

Because parents, too, like to play

PARENTING IS one of the most rewarding jobs in the world, the popular truism goes. It is also one of the hardest — which may be why fewer people are willing to take it on. Governments anxious about falling birth rates reach for the familiar arsenal of cash bonuses, tax breaks and longer parental leave. Could there be something for them to glean from the recent New York City initiative that asked what parents might need — besides money and infrastructure?

NYC's "Parents' Night Out" initiative offered four hours of free, supervised childcare for children aged six to 13, giving parents the rare chance to go out on a date, catch up on chores or simply inhabit, for a few hours, the unfamiliar luxury of having nowhere they needed to be. There is something radical about the idea of leisure as parental right, not privilege. Public policy tends to see parents through the duties they perform: Feeding, clothing, educating, protecting. But parents are also people who once had hobbies, friendships, interests and stretches of time that belonged entirely to them.

There is a larger idea here, about how public policy — usually designed around what citizens must do, like work, commute, pay taxes, etc. — can pay more attention to the question of what citizens might need simply to enjoy. Leisure, companionship, play, culture and unhurried time are easily dismissed as private luxuries, rather than recognised as ingredients of a happy society. NYC shows that public policy need not only make life more affordable or more efficient. It can also make room for pleasure.

Count caste by all means. But abandon belief that counting settles anything

YOGENDRA YADAV argued in these pages ('Caste census is dead. Don't expect a formal announcement or funeral', IE, August 12) that the caste census exercise has been quietly killed by a technical choice — an open-ended question inviting every Indian to name his own caste, which in 2011 produced 4.7 million caste names and a convenient burial. His diagnosis of the politics is sort of persuasive. But in proposing a drop-down menu instead, he adds that this "poses no difficulty for the enumerator, as long as there is no confusion about caste names".

That is precisely the problem, and it is not about names. It is about incentives. Basic NSS-PLFS statistics provide an explanation. In 1999-2000, 35.7 per cent of Indians said they were OBC. Five years later, 40.9 per cent did. India's population grew 1.8 per cent a year. So the OBC population went from 357 million to 447 million in five years — a growth rate of 4.6 per cent a year. The General category (non OBC, SC or ST) population went from 359 million to 342 million: They shrank, at 0.95 per cent a year.

What would it take for the OBC population to grow that fast? The benchmark demographers use for the outer limit of human fertility is the Hutterites, an Anabaptist community of the North American plains who married early, used no contraception, and enjoyed good nutrition and medical care. Their total fertility rate — 10.9 children per woman — is the standard against which all other fertility is indexed. Between 1880 and 1950, their population grew from 443 to 8,542. That works out to 4.32 per cent a year.

India's OBCs, on the survey evidence, out-reproduced the Hutterites. Nor was this

a five-year aberration. Between 1999 and 2025, the OBC population nearly doubled, from 357 million to 674 million. Since India added 456 million people in total over those 26 years, a group that was 36 per cent of the country in 1999 accounted for 70 per cent of every person it has added since. The General category, meanwhile, shrank: 359 million to 350 million.

Demography is unusually good at catching this sort of thing, because fertility leaves a fingerprint in the age structure. A group growing because it is having more children must be over-represented among children.

A population growing at 4.6 per cent a year should be overwhelmingly young — its child-to-adult gap should dwarf that of the rest of the population. It does not. In 2004, the OBC share among children under 15 exceeded the OBC share among adults by just 2.0 percentage points, and by 2025, that gap had narrowed to 1.2, even as the OBC share climbed a further five points. Had the growth been real, the gap would be of an altogether different order: At Hutterite fertility, OBCs would account for three-quarters of all births and be over-represented among children by more than 30 percentage points. Even a total fertility rate of six would require 20. By way of contrast, Muslims, who genuinely do have higher fertility, are over-represented among children by 3.2 points in 2004, widening to 4.3 by 2025. That is what a fertility differential looks like. The OBC numbers look like nothing of the sort.

The OBC share is rising almost as fast among adults as among children. Adults are not born. They



SURJIT S BHALLA

were incentivised to reclassify.

A decade ago ('Census, Christians and Conversions', IE, August 29, 2015), I used the same test for the Christian population. They have the highest female education in India and among the lowest fertility — 2.4 children per woman against 2.8 for Hindus and 3.6 for Muslims (NFHS, 1998-99). Only Sikhs were lower, at 2.3. Yet between 1991 and 2011 Sikhs grew at 1.2 per cent a year, exactly as their fertility predicts, while Christians — with virtually the same fertility — grew at 1.9 per cent, faster than the Hindus and matching the national average. Doing that demographically needs a fertility rate near 3.3, not the revealed 2.4.

Why? Incentives. One reason: A Christian of backward-caste origin can sit on state and central OBC lists and claim reservation, while simultaneously holding notified minority status with the institutional protections of Article 30 — minority institutions set their own admissions and are exempt from quota obligations. What he cannot claim is Scheduled Caste status. Two sets of benefits, from two classifications, at once. Whether that is anomaly or justice is a separate argument. That it creates an incentive is not arguable.

None of this is a claim about the honesty of Indians. It is a claim about human beings, and it is the least controversial proposition in economics. People respond to incentives. They always have, everywhere, and the response is usually invisible to the people making the rules.

Readers will forgive me — or not — for observing that I have been making the same argument about

investment. Indian promoters sent a record \$33.3 billion abroad last year while domestic private investment stagnated. Net foreign direct investment has fallen to 0.18 per cent GDP. Commentators call this a failure of animal spirits, and ministers appeal to industrialists to invest at home. But nobody is behaving badly. A firm choosing between a factory here and one abroad faces a bilateral investment treaty requiring 60 months in Indian courts before arbitration, 765 Quality Control Orders where there were 14 in 2014, and no trade agreement with the market (USA) that absorbs \$42 billion of Indian exports. It responds exactly as the incentives instruct. So do the households that discovered they were OBC in 2004.

The same explanation explains the caste count, the conversion numbers and the investment collapse; no proof required.

So should India have a caste census to count correctly? Yes. Count caste — India allocates education and employment on caste. But abandon the belief that counting settles anything. Ask for caste, sub-caste and surname, never for category, so the respondent is not invited to choose her own entitlement, and let the statistical office (and professional sociologists, not the armchair types) map it afterwards. Publish the microdata. And check every count against fertility — because a group whose growth requires Hutterite fertility has not grown. It has responded to incentives. Yadav is right that the Census is being killed by design. He is too generous in supposing that, absent the sabotage, it would have told us the truth.

Bhalla is chairperson of the Technical Expert Group for the first official Household Income Survey of India. Views are personal

For deep-tech fund, members' connections are valuable assets



PAYAL MALIK



KRISHNAPRIYA VS

NOT ALL proximity is conflicting, especially if it improves informed decision-making. By overstating the investee "connections" of the Research Development and Innovation Fund (RDIF) investment committee members, the editorial ('Trust is key, tech fund needs more guardrails', IE August 10) understates the informational asymmetry bridged by the presence of technology leaders in the committee. In our opinion, deep-tech investment is a domain where expert judgement requires proximity that enables a combined knowledge of technological maturity and commercial viability, something neither government officials nor academic and scientific evaluators alone can bring to the table. In fact, these "conflicted" industry veterans may be RDIF's best assets.

If we look closely, the scheme's design warrants the Expert Advisory Committee to be composed of "eminent industry leaders drawn from industry, investment and/or technology R&D sectors". In our opinion, these connections should be treated as crucial inputs for bridging the information gap in the screening process as the members are industry veterans who have built and deeply engaged with India's technology ecosystem. While parliamentary and media scrutiny are essential for political accountability in a democracy, it should not inadvertently stifle a scheme whose effective implementation is essential for India's growth prospects.

RDIF is not a public expenditure scheme, rather a public capital deployment mechanism where funds are deployed as low-interest loans, equity or fund-of-funds contributions. Provisions in the RDIF Special Financial Rules address recycling of capital and its return to the Consolidated Fund of India, making it a revolving innovation fund rather than a one-time government expenditure. The portfolio approach and choice of companies whose technology risk is overcome are strategic decisions that reduce government risk.

For a government scheme of its scale, RDIF was operationalised in record time. By bringing in private-sector investment expertise, it aims to address real problems identified in the government's financing of high technology firms such as cumbersome processes and gaps in technical knowledge

that affect bureaucratic decision-making. The 50 per cent RDIF limit to project financing ensures project proponents and private investors have shared accountability.

As RDIF's institutional design is fundamentally different from conventional public expenditure schemes, judging it through the lens of procedural propriety governing conventional bureaucratic decision-making may not be prudent. Instead, it should be assessed based on outcomes and the effectiveness of its governance architecture in tackling conflict of interest. The proof of the pudding is in its eating. Out of the 15 start-ups publicly mentioned, at least 10 have clear institutional or founder linkages to publicly funded premier technological institutions like IITs, and most have received prior external funding, signalling their technical merit.

A decade into Startup India, start-up registrations have burgeoned and India's entrepreneurial ecosystem has come a long way. Nevertheless, India is yet to produce many high-impact global scale-ups, particularly in technology-intensive sectors. The RDIF is targeted to address this gap in frontier sectors. The government's sectoral commitments function as a catalyst for private investment in technology sectors where the government has specific mission-mode initiatives.

TDB's Investment Committee is a recommending body with the final accountability resting with the TDB. The chairperson and members of the investment committee are industry experts with impeccable credentials. Foreseeing the eventuality of unavoidable connections between industry experts and potential applicants, pre-investment guidelines to tackle conflict of interest, including mandatory recusal and "supermajority" rules for choice of investee companies, are in place.

RDIF signifies a shift from the traditional public-funded R&D grant model to one where the government shapes the strategic direction of technological progress and mobilises industry expertise and private capital. Given its importance to India's technological sovereignty and strategic autonomy, it must not be undermined by political controversy.

The writers are with the ICRIER-Prosus Centre

A younger BJP, but not a very different one



AVIRAL PANDEY

THE BJP'S new national team under Nitin Nabin is significant less for the scale of the reshuffle than for what its composition reveals about the road ahead. Of the 65 national office-bearers, 51 are new. Yet the party has also brought back experienced leaders such as Ram Madhav and Smriti Irani, retained B L Santhosh, and made room for younger faces and wider regional and social representation. With the 2027 UP election, the Presidential election and the 2029 Lok Sabha polls ahead, the BJP is preparing for the next phase before electoral pressure peaks.

Nitin Nabin is the face of the change, but calling it simply "his team" would miss the larger picture. The new team composition suggests a broader organisational exercise. It is less a break with the past than a selective reconfiguration: Retaining an organisational architecture that has worked, bringing back experience where it is considered valuable, and making space for newer faces.

The geographical spread points to a longer-term calculation. The BJP is firmly established across much of the Hindi heartland and western India; its room for growth lies in regions where its electoral presence is limited. Representation from Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Andhra Pradesh, along with the Northeast, suggests an effort to make the organisation more genuinely national. D Purandeswari's elevation is relevant to this southern push, while K Surendran and Anil Antony bring experience from states where the BJP still has considerable room to grow.

This should not be read as a shift of the BJP's centre of gravity to the south. Rather, it reflects an acknowledgement that future expansion cannot come only from regions where the party is already strong. The strategy is straightforward: Consolidate the base, repair weak spots and create new political space. The social composition carries a similar message. Women, OBCs, Dalits, tribal leaders and members of minority communities have been given greater organisational visibility. This is more than symbolism. As the BJP's electoral base has broadened, its organisation must increasingly reflect that social diversity.

The changes in the digital and youth organisations suggest another adjustment. Amit Malviya has been replaced as IT cell chief, while Tejasvi Surya has been replaced as president of the youth wing. This should not be read as a retreat from digital politics. The BJP was among the earliest parties to build an extensive social-media machinery. A more plausible reading is that the party is adapting that machinery to a digital environment that has become faster, more fragmented and less predictable. That matters because younger voters can now generate political narratives outside established party structures. Recent youth-led protests over examinations and employment are instructive — not because they demonstrate an anti-BJP wave, but because they show how quickly a specific grievance can enter the national political conversation. The reset, then, may not be about changing what the BJP stands for, but ensuring that its organisation can understand — and respond to — a changing India before that change is reflected at the ballot box.

The writer teaches at Patna University

40 YEARS AGO

August 20, 1986



Violence spreads in Pakistan

ANTI-GOVERNMENT demonstrators in Pakistan clashed with the police even as the army was called out in Sindh province to crush the current agitation against the Zia-ul-Haq government, in which at least 26 people have died so far. According to reports, the agitation has spread to fresh areas, including Lahore, following the announcement by the Movement for the Restoration of Democracy (MRD) to launch a campaign to oust Gen Zia and force the government to hold elections. Violent incidents continued in Sindh province, a stronghold of the Opposition, with demonstrators damaging railway tracks and buildings at some places.

Security belt dilemma

THE GOVERNMENT is still in two minds about whether or not it should go ahead with the proposed bill to create a security belt along the entire India-Pakistan border in this session of Parliament.

Student killed by schoolmates

A 17-YEAR-OLD schoolboy, Rajinder Singh, was stabbed to death and his younger brother, Gurdip Singh, received stab wounds when they were attacked by their schoolmates in Babarpur, a trans-Jamuna colony. The assailants, Ashok Kumar and Vishnu Dutt Sharma alias Raju, have been caught by the Shahdara police.

Rajinder and Gurdip, residents of Kabool Nagar, were from a family of masons and both had recently completed Class VIII at a school near their house. Since this school was only up to middle classes, they were admitted to the Government Boys' Senior Secondary School, Babarpur, merely a week ago.

Car bomb kills 20 in Iran

A CAR bomb ripped through a main square in Tehran, killing 20 people and wounding several others, the Islamic Republic News Agency reported. The blast at 8.20 a.m. local time (10.20 IST) took place during the rush hour, in one of the most crowded areas of the capital.



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● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Jason Arday's death raises questions about how society treats black success and failure.
— *The Guardian*

An institution in freefall: Parliament is all dressed up with nowhere to go



THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

THE RECENTLY concluded Parliament session has confirmed yet again that urgent action is needed to restore the “temple of our democracy” to something better than utter dysfunctionality. Our collective failure to strike a balance between partisan politics and mature statesmanship remains the most glaring weakness of our parliamentary democracy. The Opposition remains adamant that certain issues must be discussed, but faces a government that considers compromise a sign of weakness. The Opposition persistently chooses disruption if it won't be heard; the government refuses to reach out and accommodate even some of its demands. Time, taxpayers' money and meaningful debate are all lost. So also are opportunities for MPs to question ministers, to raise constituency issues in Zero Hour or issues of national importance under Rule 377, and to place on record their views on the bills that the government cheerfully passes amid the din.

The relationship between the government and the Opposition has devolved into an unprecedented bitterness. It was not always so. A foundational civility once governed our public life: Atal Bihari Vajpayee took delight in recounting how Jawaharlal Nehru treated him with immense courtesy as a young Opposition backbencher, how Rajiv Gandhi ensured he received medical care in the US, and how Narasimha Rao dispatched him to Geneva to represent India at a critical UN summit on Kashmir. Such bipartisan grace is today unimaginable.

Instead, Indian politics has descended into a crusade of mutual demonisation. Each side claims the mantle of absolute virtue while writing off the other as irredeemable. To the ruling party, dissent is branded as “anti-national”; the Opposition, in turn, casts itself as an outnumbered band of Pandavas

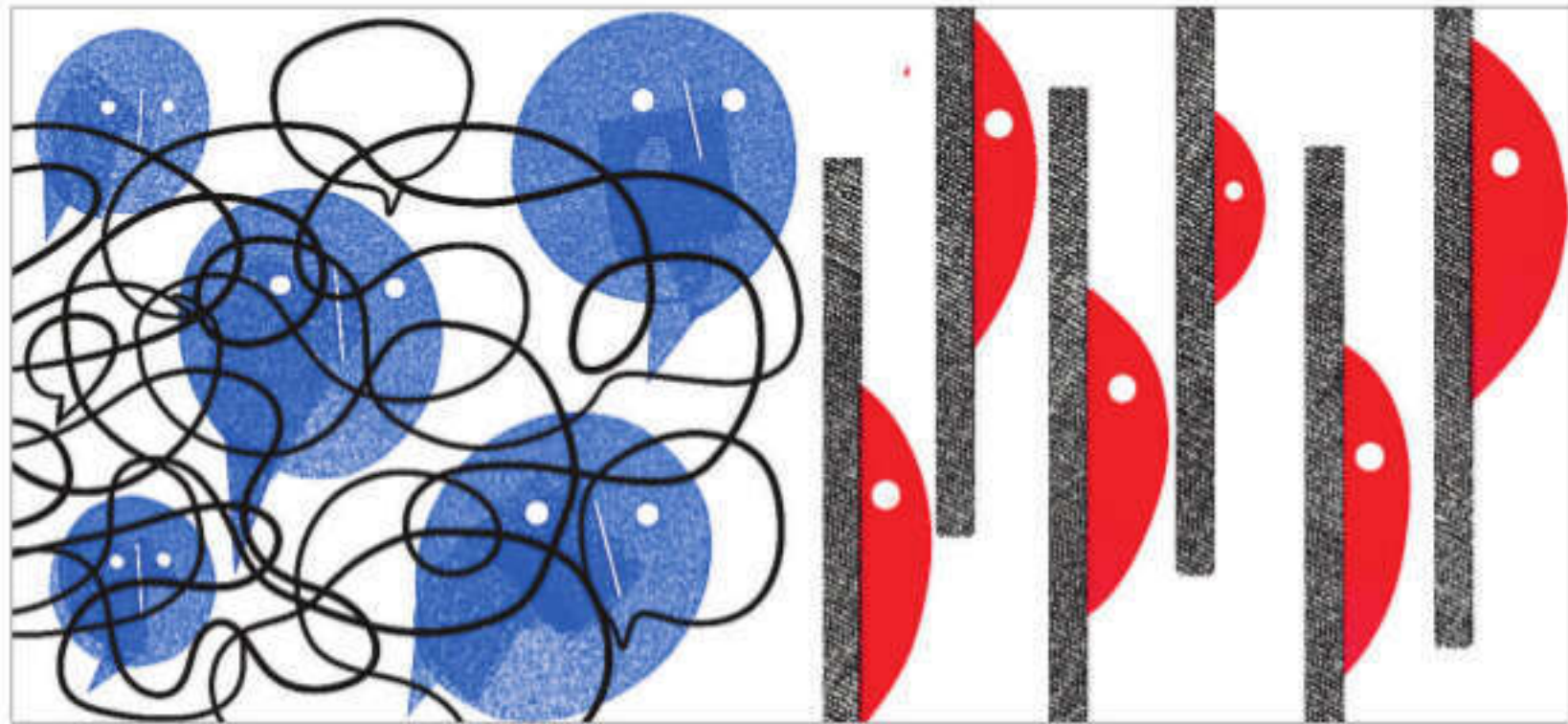


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

batting a ruthless, resource-rich Kaurava establishment. But democracy cannot survive without a basic presumption of mutual good faith: the belief that even our fiercest rivals care about the nation's welfare, even if we disagree profoundly on how to serve it. When we treat political adversaries as existential enemies, the common ground required for governance vanishes.

This breakdown of democratic trust is a collective failure. The ruling party was just as uncompromising when it was out of power. The very leaders who once championed parliamentary obstruction as a vital tool for enforcing executive accountability discovered, upon taking office, that where you stand depends on where you sit. Suddenly, disruption became an unpardonable sin. Unsurprisingly, the Opposition, having suffered under those tactics for years, rejects the sermon. If the traditional Golden Rule urged us, “Do unto others as you would have them do unto you,” the new code of Indian politics is far simpler and far more destructive: Do unto them what they did unto you.

There is also a glaring disconnect between parliamentary performance and electoral success. Representatives are elected (and re-elected) for reasons that have almost nothing to do with their ability to skewer a minister during Question Hour or dissect a flawed

The Opposition persistently chooses disruption if it won't be heard; the government refuses to reach out and accommodate even some of its demands. Time, taxpayers' money and meaningful debate are all lost

bill with forensic precision. Instead, voters judge their MPs by the constituent services they render and the raw, local political muscle they command. The talent that ought to be showcased on the floor of the House has migrated to television studios. In turn, when party whips corral MPs into the well of the House to disrupt proceedings with organised shouting rather than reasoned debate, party leaders signal that they value partisan aggression far above parliamentary excellence.

At one time, political parties valued different skills in their leaders: The mass mobilisation of the “politics of the street” and the debating prowess of the “politics of Parliament”. When the “politics of the street” has invaded Parliament, the “politics of Parliament” has no place to go, impoverishing our democratic discourse and rendering the possibility of national consensus on progress untenable. Some good work continues in parliamentary committees, mostly away from the media glare, and in the absence of the cameras that place a premium on disruptive grandstanding. But what the public sees is disruption, the absence of dialogue and a complete breakdown in communication. Disillusionment with the functioning of Parliament is rife across the country.

This generational freefall in legislative standards has only

been exacerbated by the ruling dispensation. The current government displays a barely concealed contempt for the legislature, preferring to ride roughshod over the Opposition rather than engage it. Unlike Jawaharlal Nehru, who attended Parliament daily and treated it as the beating heart of Indian democracy, Prime Minister Narendra Modi rarely deigns to grace the House with his presence. Over recent years, the government has reduced Parliament from a consultative chamber in a deliberative democracy to a mere noticeboard for announcing executive decisions and a rubber stamp for legalising them.

This systematic diminishing of Parliament strikes at the very core of our democratic order. Tragically, its own custodians are allowing the institution to be hollowed out, bringing us dangerously close to a point where the public will no longer even miss it when it is effectively rendered meaningless. But if Parliament is allowed to lose all purpose, what will remain of our democracy?

Democracy requires a rare, delicate balance. It demands that politicians maintain fierce ideological convictions during an election, yet actively cooperate for the collective progress of the nation once the ballots are cast. This principle is essential to build a healthy political culture, drawing on timeless lessons from democratic history, global precedents, and the evolving nature of public service. When both sides concur that national interests should be prioritised over partisan rivalries, governance can shift from zero-sum obstructionism to constructive collaboration. This approach does not mean giving up party ideology or abandoning one's principles. Instead, it recognises that while political parties offer different paths toward progress, the ultimate destination remains the welfare, safety, and prosperity of the nation.

An obvious solution, successfully used elsewhere, is to grant the Opposition one day a week or two hours a day to raise any issue it deems essential, while allowing the work of Parliament to proceed undisturbed the rest of the time. Does no one in the government have the imagination or the vision to effect such a compromise?

The writer is a fourth-term Congress MP from Thiruvananthapuram

BRICS is working for a future that puts the planet first



BHUPENDER YADAV

AS INDIA hosted the 12th BRICS Environment Ministers' Meeting on August 18 in New Delhi under its chairship, it did so with a deep sense of responsibility and optimism. BRICS countries account for 49.5 per cent of the world's population, approximately 40 per cent of global GDP and 26 per cent of international trade, underscoring their growing influence on the global economy, development agenda and the future direction of international co-operation. As the world faces interconnected environmental challenges, BRICS demonstrates that sustainable development, climate action and inclusive growth can advance together through dialogue, partnership and shared responsibility.

Under the leadership of PM Narendra Modi, initiatives such as Mission LIFE (Lifestyle for Environment) and Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam (A Tree in the Name of Mother) have demonstrated the value of combining ecological restoration, public participation and community ownership. These initiatives illustrate how climate action, biodiversity conservation, resilience-building and livelihood enhancement can reinforce one another when pursued through integrated approaches.

It was in this context that India's BRICS chairship was guided by the vision articulated by PM Modi: “Just as we brought inclusivity to our G-20 presidency and placed the concerns of the Global South at the forefront of the agenda, similarly, during our presidency of BRICS, we will advance this forum with a people-centric approach and the spirit of ‘Humanity First.’”

Under India's chairship, the BRICS Environment Working Group focused on four interconnected priorities. The priority on Promoting Sustainable Lifestyles builds on the principles of Mission LIFE and encourages responsible and sustainable consumption and production, behavioural change, awareness among citizens and communities and knowledge-sharing. This was complemented by the priority on Afforestation, Forest Fire Management and Disaster Resilience, which addresses the growing pressures on forests, land and natural ecosystems through integrated landscape restoration, combating land degradation, wildfire preparedness and response, early-warning systems and ecosystem resilience. By strengthening cooperation, sharing best practices and leveraging scientific advances such as remote sensing and artificial intelligence, BRICS aims to build more resilient landscapes and communities. The Circular Economy priority reflects a growing recognition that the traditional “take-make-dispose” model is no longer sustainable. BRICS member countries view the circular economy as a key enabler of sustainable development and inclusive economic growth, and seek to reduce environmental pressures while creating economic opportunities and green employment through stronger international cooperation in research, innovation, technology transfer and capacity building. As climate impacts intensify, adaptation has become an urgent necessity, particularly for developing countries facing disproportionate vulnerabilities. A defining feature of the BRICS approach is the recognition that traditional knowledge, indigenous knowledge and local knowledge systems offer valuable insights for building resilience. The BRICS Principles for Advancing Climate Resilience through People-Centric and Community-Based Adaptation emphasise integrating such knowledge with modern science and technology to create context-specific, evidence-based and culturally appropriate solutions.

Together, these priorities reflected a simple yet powerful conviction: Environmental action must be people-centric, implementation-oriented and responsive to the realities of developing countries. The principles of equity and Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC) resonated across and remain fundamental to an effective and balanced global environmental response to climate change.

The outcomes achieved under India's BRICS chairship extend beyond declarations. They include the development of practical principles on sustainable lifestyles, integrated landscape management, forest fire preparedness and community-based adaptation, as well as technical reports, platforms, dialogues and knowledge-sharing networks. These outcomes reflect months of collaboration, negotiation and consensus-building among member countries and demonstrate the value of multilateral co-operation in addressing common environmental challenges.

India's efforts to reduce emissions intensity while expanding non-fossil energy capacity reinforce the belief that development and environmental responsibility can advance together. India has reduced the emissions intensity of its economy by 37.38 per cent between 2005 and 2022, while non-fossil sources accounted for 54.18 per cent of installed electricity capacity (as of 30 June 2026). India's new Nationally Determined Contribution for 2031-2035 further reflects the commitment to advancing climate action while supporting inclusive development and energy security.

BRICS is seeking to contribute meaningfully to global environmental governance while delivering tangible benefits for communities on the ground. The success of these efforts will ultimately be measured not by the adoption of principles alone, but by their ability to strengthen ecosystems, support livelihoods and build a more sustainable and resilient future for all.

The writer is Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Party reshuffle

THE EDITORIAL goes on to hit the nail on the head by observing that the BJP's latest rejig, involving the to-and-fro of certain key individuals, will be assessed more by their respective ability to contribute towards making it future-ready ('Rejig in party must be reset for governance', *IE*, August 19). The BJP reset could be a first step in the right direction, but the long-awaited reshuffling of PM Modi's Cabinet also remains quintessential for 'resetting the governance' in the given critical scenario across the nation.

SK Gupta, via email

Deepen ties

STRENGTHENING INDIA-JAPAN relations offers substantial mutual benefits across strategic, economic and technological domains, while advancing their shared vision of a free, open, peaceful and rules-based Indo-Pacific ('A changing Asia demands more from Delhi and Tokyo, together', *IE*, August 19). Defence cooperation through joint exercises, training and reciprocal logistics arrangements can enhance maritime security and regional preparedness. Initiatives such as the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative can reduce dependence on China while diversifying critical supply chains and strengthening economic security.

Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

Darwin upset

BANGLADESH'S PERFORMANCE in Darwin is a reminder that cricket's landscape is widening ('At Darwin, Bangladesh upends the cricketing order', *IE*, August 19). Established teams can no longer assume that rankings or past records guarantee easy victories. The sport will benefit if emerging sides receive sustained opportunities, quality coaching and regular international fixtures. For Bangladesh, the challenge is to build on this result consistently over time. Stronger domestic structures and bilateral cricket can turn an encouraging performance into lasting progress.

Prajesh Paramasivan, Neelambur



VIKRAM SINGH

AS THE Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) marked its Raising Day on July 27, the celebrations carried an added significance this year. The CRPF, which has been at the forefront of India's internal security operations for decades, has also been central to one of the most consequential security campaigns of the Modi government: The dismantling of Left Wing Extremism (LWE). PM Narendra Modi, in his message on the occasion, highlighted the CRPF's courage and commitment, while the force's role in the campaign against Naxalism has been particularly visible in the forests of Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and other parts of the former Red Corridor. The Centre declared the country free from Naxalism on March 31, 2026.

For a region that for decades was associated with ambushes, armed cadres and Maoist control, this is a turning point. It also raises a question larger than the military defeat of an insurgency: What replaces the Red Corridor? The answer will determine how durable the government's achievement is.

Home Minister Amit Shah's approach to LWE brought together intelligence-led operations, greater coordination between central and state forces, disruption of Maoist financing, rehabilitation and a sustained expansion of the security grid. The CRPF's specialised CoBRA units, alongside state police forces, were deployed in operations including Black Forest, Octopus, Double Bull and Chakrabandha, helping dismantle strongholds that had re-

What replaces the Red Corridor? The answer will determine how durable the government's achievement is

After Naxalism, a development corridor

maintained difficult to penetrate for years. Once security forces could establish a more permanent presence in areas where the state had struggled to maintain one, roads and communications could be extended, institutions could be opened and development programmes could reach communities that had remained isolated.

The numbers offer a sense of that change. Since 2014, the government says 408 new security camps and 597 fortified police stations have been established in LWE-affected areas. More than 12,000 km of roads have been constructed, while 1,804 bank branches, 1,321 ATMs and 6,025 post offices have been added. Mobile connectivity has expanded across most villages in the affected regions, alongside Eklavya Model Residential Schools, ITIs and skill development centres. For people living in these areas, these are not merely development statistics. A road changes access to a market or a hospital. A bank branch connects households to formal finance. A telecom tower brings a remote village closer to the rest of the country. A school or skill centre expands the choices available to young people.

The objective now is to ensure that the state's presence in these regions is defined by institutions and opportunity rather than by the security challenge that once dominated the landscape. This also explains the emphasis on rehabilitation. The government's surrender policy has sought to bring former cadres back into civilian life through financial assis-

tance, training and support for reintegration, while agencies have targeted the financial networks that sustained the insurgency. The strategy has been to reduce the movement's ability to operate, finance itself and replenish its ranks.

Amit Shah's repeated engagement with the LWE-affected regions has been another feature of the campaign. His visits to Bastar and security review meetings on the ground have kept the Centre closely involved with an operational challenge that demands co-ordination between Delhi, state governments and personnel deployed deep inside difficult terrain. The government's ability to combine political direction with an expanded security and development architecture has been central to the shift. The next phase will be less dramatic than the operations that made the headlines, but it could be more important in determining the legacy of the campaign. The former Red Corridor will truly become a development corridor when the infrastructure now reaching these regions begins to generate sustained economic activity, better education and greater integration with the rest of India.

The guns going silent is an important milestone. The harder task is ensuring the space they leave behind is filled with roads, schools, businesses, livelihoods and functioning institutions. That is the opportunity the end of Naxalism has created, and that is where the government's larger test begins.

The writer is former DGP, Uttar Pradesh, and chancellor of Noida International University

Students are upholding Bhagat Singh's legacy

when India's larger destiny was at stake.

Students taking part in the Swadeshi Movement, the Non-Cooperation Movement, the Civil Disobedience Movement and the Quit India Movement boycotted colonial educational institutions, faced imprisonment, and carried the message of resistance into towns and villages. Bhagat Singh was not merely a young revolutionary who made the supreme sacrifice. He was a political thinker who understood that courage without political understanding could not transform society. In his 1931 document To Young Political Workers, written only weeks before his execution, he emphasised the need for study circles, political education, propaganda and organised work among workers and peasants. His martyrdom was not simply an act of extraordinary personal cour-

age. It was an appeal to young Indians to think, organise and fight for a better future.

The decades after Independence have repeatedly confirmed this political character. Students have risen not only over fees, examinations or hostel facilities, but over democracy, federalism, language, social justice, civil liberties and the direction of the country itself. The anti-Hindi agitations in Tamil Nadu drew enormous student participation. The Assam Movement saw students play a central organisational role. The student-led mobilisation against the Emergency became

His martyrdom was an appeal to young Indians to think, organise and fight for a better future

an important part of the democratic resistance of the 1970s. Left student organisations, too, have a long record of taking up questions far beyond campus boundaries.

India today is passing through a crisis on many fronts. Public education faces growing pressures. Examination systems have been shaken by allegations and instances of paper leaks and irregularities. Young people confront an acute crisis of employment and secure livelihoods. Communal polarisation threatens the social fabric of the Republic. Democratic dissent is too often treated as a problem to be managed rather than a constitutional right to be respected. Accountability has become difficult to extract from those in power. And yet, at a moment when cynicism could easily have overwhelmed hope, students have again stepped forward.

The struggle is no longer against a foreign colonial power. It is against the forces that seek to hollow out the democratic and constitutional foundations of the Republic; against communal division, inequality, unemployment, and the erosion of institutional accountability. The present student movement must be carried forward. Students must reach beyond their campuses, build solidarity with workers and farmers, stand with Dalits, tribals and women facing discrimination, defend public institutions and become an active force for constitutional democracy. This is where the legacy of Bhagat Singh remains particularly relevant. His message was not simply to be angry. It was to study, understand, organise and act.

The writer is general secretary, CPI

TAMIL NADU TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
T-2383	SE/Transmission-II	Supply and Erection of Transformers
0380/26-27	CET/PS&O/Madurai	110 KV Line Works
12/26-27	CET/PS&O/Chennai	SSE Works

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / opening, viewing and downloading of tenders, please visit websites: www.tantranSCO.gov.in, www.tenders.in.gov.in, www.tenders.gov.in/nicgp/app

DIPR/2621/Tender/2026

TELANGANA CO-OPERATIVE MARKETING FEDERATION LTD.
Email: proc.tsmarked2018@gmail.com, Ph.No: 040-2460 7108

Rc.No.685/P&M/ Disposal of Jowar Hybrid Yasangi/2025-26 Date: 19.08.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION FOR ONLINE E-AUCTION FOR THE SALE OF JOWAR HYBRID YASANGI (RABI) 2025-26 PROCURED BY TG MARKFED.

Tender notification for online e-Auctions on disposal of Jowar Yasangi (Rabi) 2025-26 procured by TG MARKFED auctions for the quantity and lots as mentioned in the e-auction portal through <https://auction.telangana.gov.in/> i.e. Telangana e-procurement portal (Applications in e-procurement portal will be available from 11:30 AM on 20.08.2026).

1. E-auction bidding will commence on 27.08.2026 from 10:00 AM to 05:00 PM
2. Last date for submission of EMD: 25.08.2026 upto 05:00 PM.
For online registration and further technical support please contact Service providers Mobile No.: 7337445545 / 6309339690 / 7337445546 / 9912756216
For further details please contact. Ph: 7288879806, and 7288879829

Sd/- MANAGING DIRECTOR
DIPR.R.O.No.441/PL/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Date: 19.08.2026

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala)
Corporate Identity Number: U410P02010SCC3813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact Number 96461-07151)

Tender Inquiry no. 691/GHTP/EMC/SSMC-181/VO-I-X Dated: 18/08/2026

Ly. Chief Engineer/Electrical Maintenance Circle. Guru Hargobind Thermal Plant, Dehra Mohabbat, invites e-tender for Hotline (online) washing of 220 KV & 66 KV insulator strings, porcelain portion of switchyard equipment i.e. CTs, PTS, Breakers, Isolators etc. installed at 220 KV Substation, GHTP, Lehra Mohabbat as per detailed Scope of work mentioned in the technical specifications.
For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 19/08/2026 from 11:00 am onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
No. 14417/PB GRTP-65/26

MAHARASHTRA ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY (MEDA)
(A Government of Maharashtra Institute)
Aundh Road, Opposite Spicer College, Near Commissionerate of Animal Husbandry, Aundh, Pune.
E-mail id: kusum@mahaurja.com | Phone No.: 91-020-25690623

NOTICE FOR E-TENDER

Request for Proposal (RFP) for SELECTION OF AGENCY FOR OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF MEDA's PM KUSUM PORTAL WITH RMS INTEGRATION.
For detailed Tender Document, interested bidders should visit website www.mahatenders.gov.in. The online bid submission period is from 20-08-2026 and the last date for bid submission is 04-09-2026 @17:00 hrs.
The Director General, MEDA reserves the right to accept or reject anyone or all the Tender without giving reasons thereof.
General Manager, MEDA

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, वृत्त-भरतपुर

क्रमांक: 1142 दिनांक : 17/08/26

निविदा सूचना संख्या: 02/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से जिला भरतपुर में सड़क/पवन निर्माण कार्य, दोष निवारण अवधि 05/10 वर्ष के लिए उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार / केन्द्रीय सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/डाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग / रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के विभिन्न सक्षम श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।
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अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
सांनितवि० वृत्त-भरतपुर

DIPR/C/15347/26-27

राजस्थान सरकार कॉलेज शिक्षा विभाग, जयपुर

क्रमांक: F23(10)/ACCS/Ce/Sch/Scouty D.B.T./2024-25 and 2025-26/2603-9333594 दिनांक: 18.08.2026

स्कूटी वितरण हेतु रुचि अभिव्यक्ति (Expression of Interest)

कालीबाई भील मेधावी छात्रा स्कूटी योजना, देवनागरीय छात्रा स्कूटी योजना एवं स्कूटी वितरण से संबंधित अन्य राज्य स्तरीय योजनाओं में सहभागिता हेतु प्रतिष्ठित मूल उपकरण निमाताओं (Original Equipment Manufacturer) एवं उनके अधिकृत डीलर / वितरकों से रुचि अभिव्यक्ति आमंत्रित की जाती है। इन योजनाओं के अन्तर्गत राज्य की पात्र एवं चयनित मेधावी छात्राओं को लगभग 88000 स्कूटियाँ ई-वाउचर / क्यू.आर. कोड आधारित व्यवस्था के माध्यम से वितरित की जानी प्रस्तावित है।
पात्रता, शर्तों एवं निर्धारित प्रपत्रों सहित विस्तृत दस्तावेज विभागीय वेबसाइट से डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है:
<https://bte.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <https://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <https://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>
Pre-EOI meeting-20.08.2026 at 3.00 PM
Venue:- Commissionerate of college education, Jaipur (Prospective bidder meet to clear issues, if any)
Last date & Submission of EOI:-31.08.2026 at 04.00 PM.
Date & time of Opening of EOI:- 01.09.2026 at 04.00 PM.
Tender I.D.No-2026_DOCE_590544-1
NIB No. -ECD2627 A 0394
BID No. - ECD2627GLOB 00414

आयुक्त
कॉलेज शिक्षा विभाग,
राजस्थान, जयपुर

DIPR/C/15344/2026

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION
OFFICE OF THE SENIOR ASSISTANT DIRECTOR OF HORTICULTURE, ZONE-1

No: SADH-1/HORT/TENDER/140/2026-27 Dated:19/08/2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT)
(TWO COVER SYSTEM - THROUGH KARNATAKA PUBLIC PROCUREMENT PORTAL)

The Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture, Zone-1, Horticulture Division, Bengaluru Central City Corporation, invites online tenders through the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (KPPP) from eligible and experienced contractors/firms/agencies for the following work, in accordance with the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurements Act, 1999 and the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurements Rules, 2000, as amended from time to time.

Name of Work : Beautification, Landscape development, Water facilities and other civil works including borewell drilling and electrification of parks and upgradation of tender sure roads in Shanthinagar Assembly Constituency

Estimated Cost of Work : **₹2,00,00,000/-**

EMD : **₹3,00,000/-**

Tender Processing Fee : **As applicable in KPPP Portal**

Tender System : **Two Cover System**

Mode of Tender : **Online through KPPP only**

Completion Period : **As specified in the approved Tender Document**

Bid Validity : **As specified in the Tender Document**

Standard Tender Document : **KW- 4, as applicable**

Calendar of Events :
(1) Date of publication of Tender Notification on KPPP : 19/08/2026 (2) Date of commencement of downloading Tender Documents : 19/08/2026 (3) Pre-Bid Meeting : 24/08/2026 at 12.30PM (4) Last Date and Time for submission of Tender : 03/09/2026 up to 5:00 PM (5) Date and Time of opening of Technical Bid : 04/09/2026 at 11:30 AM (6) Opening of Financial Bid : Will be intimated separately through KPPP to technically qualified bidders.

Sd/- Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture
Zone-1, Horticulture Division Bengaluru Central City Corporation

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Raju S/o Jagu Ram R/o B-13/26, B-Block, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No.381/2020 U/S 392/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Raju** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Raju** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Raju of FIR No.381/2020 U/S 392/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **28.09.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11481/ON/2026(Court Matter)

राजस्थान सरकार कार्यालय अधीक्षक मथुरादास माथुर चिकित्सालय जोधपुर

E-TENDER NOTICE NO.09(2026-27)

Online Bids are invited from eligible bidders i.e. Manufacturer/Authorized Distributors/Dealers to provide various Items & Services at Mathura Das Mathur Hospital Jodhpur attached to Dr. S. N. Medical College Jodhpur as per tender terms and conditions. Tenders are to be submitted duly digitally signed in electronic format only on website <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>. The tender documents may be downloaded from above mentioned website. The tender document may also be seen on <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>. The details of the bid are as follows:-
(E-Tender No: 09(2026-27))
General Surgery Items
UBN-SMC2627GLRC00137
Amount-100 Lac.

Sd/-
Superintendent
Mathura Das Mathur Hospital
Jodhpur

DIPR/C/15309/2026

Office of the Additional Chief Engineer (Project) PHED Bharatpur
E-mail: aceproj.bha.phed@rajasthan.gov.in

No. Notice Inviting Bid No. 01/2026-27

On behalf of the Governor or Rajasthan, online tender are hereby invited from eligible bidders for the following works of water supply projects as per criteria mentioned in the detailed NIT / Tender document available on website: <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> & <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> Tender are to be submitted online in electronic format on website <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> with 17.09.2026 last date of submission.

NIT No.	Name of Project	Estimated Cost	SPPP UBN No.
01/26-27	Work of Pkg-3 of Chambal Dholpur Bharatpur Project (Retrofitting) for providing FHTCs in villages and their Oils of Roophas, Uchhain, Bharatpur (Sewar) and Kumber blocks of District Bharatpur under JIM	Rs. 232.30 Crores	PHE 2627WLOB04429

NIB Code: PHE2627A2225

(Surendra Sharma)
Additional Chief Engineer (P)
PHED Bharatpur

DIPR/C/15267/2026

राजस्थान सरकार कार्यालय अधीक्षापी अभियन्ता सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग खण्ड कोटपूतली
(डाक बंगला कैम्पस कोटपूतली)
ईमेल keektpwd@gmail.com

क्रमांक 1173-81 दिनांक. 13.08.2026

Short Term NIT No 08/2026-27

Construction of Various Atal Pragati Path Under Pwd Division Kotputli District Kotputli-Behror Online Bids are invited from eligible and interested bidder from the above-mentioned works. The bidding process will commence from 17.08.2026 12:00 pm upto 27.08.2026 12:00 PM. And shall remain open up to 28.08.2026 at 02:00 PM Detailed bidding documents and other particulars of may be downloaded from the State Procurement Portal (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> and <http://sppp.rajj.nic.in> of the state and <http://pwd.rajjasthan.gov.in> in departmental website. The approximate value of the procurements is Rs.863.40/-Lakhs.

UBN No.

S. No.	UBN. No.	S. No.	UBN. No.	S. No.	UBN. No.
1	PWD2627WSOB10503	2	PWD2627WSOB10505	3	PWD2627WSOB10507
4	PWD2627WSOB10510	5	PWD2627WSOB10513		

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
PWD Div Kotputli

DIPR/C/15243/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Yogesh S/o Rajbir R/o A-168, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi & Rakesh @ Pawa S/o Jagdamba R/o B-1020, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 51/2021 U/S 392/34/411 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Yogesh & Rakesh @ Pawa** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Yogesh & Rakesh @ Pawa** absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Yogesh & Rakesh @ Pawa of FIR No. 51/2021 U/S 392/34/411 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **29.09.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11477/ON/2026(Court Matter)

महाराष्ट्र शासन क्रीडा व युवक सेवा संचालनालय, महाराष्ट्र राज्य

शिवछत्रपती क्रीडा संकुल, महालुंगे-बालेवाडी, पुणे- ४११०४५

संकेतस्थल: <https://sports.maharashtra.gov.in/>
ई-मेल: mahkridapeeth@gmail.com

शिवछत्रपती क्रीडा संकुल, महालुंगे-बालेवाडी, पुणे येथील सायकलिंग वेलोड्रोमचे - आराखडा तयार करणे, बांधकाम करणे, अर्थसहाय्य करणे, चालविणे व हस्तांतरित करणेकरिता स्वाम्य देकार (Expression of Interest) मागविणेकरिता ई निविदा क्रीडा व युवक सेवा संचालनालय, महाराष्ट्र राज्य अंतर्गत "शिवछत्रपती क्रीडा संकुल, महालुंगे- बालेवाडी, पुणे येथील सायकलिंग वेलोड्रोमचे - आराखडा तयार करणे, बांधकाम करणे, अर्थसहाय्य करणे, चालविणे व हस्तांतरित करणे" याकरिता स्वाम्य देकार (Expression of Interest) मागविणेकरिता स्पर्धात्मक पध्दतीने ऑनलाईन ई-निविदा मागविण्यात येत आहे. निविदा कागदपत्र शासनाच्या <http://mahatenders.gov.in> या संकेतस्थळावरून डाऊनलोड करण्यात यावीत. तसेच निविदा स्वीकारण्याचा अथवा नाकारण्याचा अधिकार आयुक्त, क्रीडा व युवक सेवा, पुणे यांनी राखून ठेवला आहे. निविदा ऑनलाईन सादर करवयाची आहे आणि निविदा सादर करण्याचा अंतिम दिनांक ११/०९/२०२६ रोजी दु. ५.०० वा. पर्यंत आहे.

स्वाक्षरीत/-
दीपक सिंगल, (भा.प्र.से.)
आयुक्त,
क्रीडा व युवक सेवा, महाराष्ट्र राज्य, पुणे

"IMPORTANT"

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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Kapil Kumar S/o Jogender R/o B-40, Jagatpuri Extension, Gali No. 12, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 611/2015 U/s 279/337/338 IPC, P.S. GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kapil Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kapil Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kapil Kumar of case FIR No. 611/2015 U/s 279/337/338 IPC, P.S. GTB Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sanghmitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 54, Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkarkoom Courts, Delhi

DP/8835/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

कार्यालय, अधीक्षण अभियंता पदेन परियोजना प्रबन्धक, वाटरशेड रोल कम डाटा सेंटर जिला-कोटपूतली-बहेरॉड
E-mail: sewdse.kot.behrur@rajasthan.gov.in

Sr. No. 388 Date: 17-8-2026

REVISED NOTICE INVITING BID NIT NO-18 YEAR 2026-27

Bids for Watershed Development Works are invited from interested bidders up to 23.08.2026 at 6:00 PM as per following details. Other particulars of bid may be visited on the procurement portal <https://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> of the state departmental website.

Sl.No	Block	NIB No	Estimate (Rs in Lacs)	NIB CODE	UBN CODE
1	Kotputli Mjsa 2.2	18/2026-27	57.84	WSC2627 A0909	WSC2627WSOB01666
2	viratnagar Mjsa 2.2		143.45		WSC2627WSOB01667
3	Neemrana Mjsa 2.2		153.43		WSC2627WSOB01668
4	Bansur Mjsa 2.3		58.31		WSC2627WSOB01669
5	Bansur Mjsa 2.2		102.11		WSC2627WSOB01681
6	Paota Mjsa 2.2		114.35		WSC2627WSOB01682
7	Viratnagar Mjsa 2.3		75.82		WSC2627WSOB01683
8	Neemrana Mjsa 2.3		58.96		WSC2627WSOB01684
9	Viratnagar pmksy 2.0		2.05		WSC2627WSOB01686

Sd/-
(RAJESH KUMAR GUPTA)
Superintending Engineer
WCDC Kotputli-Behrur

DIPR/C/15293/2026

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, जन स्वा० अभि० विभाग, जयपुर क्षेत्र-द्वितीय, गांधी नगर, जयपुर
ई-मेल :- acc.region2jaipur@yahoo.com | फोन नं०-0141-2702700

क्रमांक :- अ.मु.अ. क्षेत्र-2/2026-27/6194-6220 दिनांक :- 19/08/2026

निविदा सूचना

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से "Package IV (work under City Dn. I (South) Jaipur) work of Strengthening and Improvement in the water supply distribution network under the jurisdiction of Jaipur Nagar Nigam Heritage under AMRUT 2.0" कार्य हेतु जन स्वास्थ्य अभियांत्रिकी विभाग एवं राज्य सरकार / केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एवं दूरसंचार विभाग / रेलवे इत्यादि में उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया द्वारा निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत निविदा एवं निविदा प्रपत्र www.sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in एवं www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।

क्रम संख्या	एच.आई.डी	यू.सी. एन कोड	निविदा संख्या
1	PHE2627A2319	PHE2627WLOB04637	18/2026-27

(अजय सिंह गठोड़)
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता
जन स्वा. अभि. विभाग जयपुर
क्षेत्र-द्वितीय, जयपुर

DIPR/C/15368/26-27

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rahul @ Gagan Prasad S/o Rajesh Prasad R/o H. No. 111/7A, Railway Colony, Kishan Ganj, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No.11/2020 U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Karol Bagh, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Rahul @ Gagan Prasad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul @ Gagan Prasad of FIR No.11/2020 U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Karol Bagh, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **29.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Nishat Bangarh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01 (Central)
Room No.180
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11447/CD/2026(Court Matter)

MOTILAL NEHRU SCHOOL OF SPORTS
RAI-131029, DISTT. SONPAT (HARYANA)
ADVT-D03/2026

Applications are invited from the eligible and interested candidates working regular basis on the analogous post in Central/State Govt. Departments for appointment of various teaching and non-teaching posts on DEPUTATION BASIS as per standard terms & conditions of deputation prescribed in Haryana Civil Service Rules, 2016 as amended from time to time will be applied. The applications should reach on or before 01/09/2026 at 04:00 P.M at the address "The Principal & Director, MNSS, Rai -131029 (Haryana)". Applications received after the last date due to postal delay or any other reasons will not be considered. THE POST OF MASTER (SR WING) IS AT PAR WITH PGT AND THE POST OF MASTER (JR WING) IS AT PAR WITH TGT.

Candidates are advised to go through the instructions while applying for the following teaching & non-teaching posts to be filled on deputation basis (visit school website www.mnssrai.com)
Details of Teaching & Non-Teaching Posts and Functional Pay Level (FPL)

Sr. No	Name of Post	No. of Post	FPL*	Mode of appointment
1	History - Master (Sr Wing)	01	FPL-08	Deputation basis for a period of one year or till vacancy is filled on regular basis, whichever is earlier.
2	Hindi - Master (Sr Wing)	01	FPL-08	
3	Maths - Master (Sr Wing)	02	FPL-08	
4	Music - Master (Sr Wing)	01	FPL-08	
5	Economics - Master (Sr Wing)	01	FPL-08	
6	Hindi Master (Sr Wing)	01	FPL-08	
	*Profound knowledge of Sanskrit.			The period may be extended beyond one year based on performance.
7	Hindi - Master (Jr Wing)	01	FPL-07	
8	Maths Master (Jr Wing)	01	FPL-07	
9	Coach Cricket -	01	FPL-06	
10	Coach Football	01	FPL-06	
11	Coach - Hockey	01	FPL-06	

*Indicative of FPL at the time of fresh joining
Note: -
(a) Pay protection shall be admissible to employees joining on deputation.
(b) Perks & other entitlements as applicable to the corresponding staff/post of MNSS, Rai will be applicable to the persons joining MNSS, Rai on deputation.
(c) Number of posts may increase or decrease.
(d) The applicant is required to submit a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from employer, where he/she is working presently.
(e) Sr wing is MNSS, Rai - From Class 7th to 12th
Jr Wing is Kamlu Nehru School - for Class 5th & 6th
Those applicants who are serving at distant locations, or to avoid any postal delay, may submit the duly filled application form along with scanned copies of all required documents through email at mnssrai@rediffmail.com. The applicant must clearly mention the post applied for in the subject line of the email.

Sd/-
PRINCIPAL & DIRECTOR
MNSS, RAI

No.48365/HRY

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER WATER RESOURCES ZONE, BANSWARA
Mahi Colony, Near New Court Campus, Banswara, E-mail-cwrbws@gmail.com

No.- FQ/CE/WR/BSW/ACCTTs/2026-27/6223 Date: 13-08-2026

Short Term e-NIB No. 05/2026-27

On behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan, bids are invited from eligible bidders for the work of "Survey, Planning, Designing for Rejuvenation of Moren River, Construction of Ghats on both side of the River, Large Kund and Riverfront Development at Khadgada Village - Dungarpur (Phase -I) including O&M for Period of 05 years on Engineering Procurement Construction (EPC) Single Responsibility turnkey basis" (Estimated Value of Work - **Rs 8055.66 Lakh inclusive GST**) Last date of submission of Bid is 05.09.2026 Detailed Bid & Bid document can be seen on & downloaded from official website (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, & <http://sppp.rajj.nic.in>)
NIB Code No.: WRD2627A0287
UBN No.: WRD2627WLOB00609

Sd/-
Chief Engineer

DIPR/C/15021/2026

राजस्थान सरकार कार्यालय अधीक्षापी अभियन्ता सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग खण्ड बानसूर
(नहरील कार्यालय के पीछे बानसूर)
दूरभाष नंबर 01461-294290, ईमेल cepwdbansur@gmail.com

क्रमांक 635 दिनांक. 14.08.2026

Short Term NIT No 09/2026-27

Construction of Various Atal Path Roads Under Pwd Division Bansur District Kotputli-Behrur Online Bids are invited from eligible and interested bidder from the above-mentioned works. The bidding process will commence from 17.08.2026 12:00 pm upto 27.08.2026 03:00 PM. And shall remain open up to 28.08.2026 at 12:00 PM Detailed bidding documents and other particulars of may be downloaded from the State Procurement Portal (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> and <http://sppp.rajj.nic.in> of the state and <http://pwd.rajjasthan.gov.in> in departmental website. The approximate value of the procurements is Rs.341.44/- Lakhs.

UBN No:- PWD2627WSOB10514, PWD2627WSOB10518

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
PWD Div Bansur

DIPR/C/15243/2026

ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लॉट सं. 81, नालेख पार्क-IV, ग्रेटर नौएडा, गौतमबुद्ध नगर, उत्तर प्रदेश-201308
वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in ई-मेल: authority@gnida.in

प्रक्रांक- अर्बन सर्विस / 2026 / 630 दिनांक 19/08/2026

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण की ओर से ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या: अर्बन सर्विस / 2026 / 629 दिनांक 19.08.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित कार्य की ई - निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई-निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी ग्रेटर नौएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.greaternoidaauthority.in पर ई-निविदा लिंक एवं ई-पोर्टल <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाइट देखते रहें।

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम
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AT LEAST \$80 BN EXPECTED FROM ALL THREE FOREX SCHEMES

FCNR(B) decision data-driven, well thought-out: Gov

It will not be correct to call it a U-turn; it is rather a calibration: RBI Governor Malhotra

Kshipra Petkar & Joydeep Ghosh
Mumbai, August 19

RESERVE BANK of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Wednesday strongly defended the decision to advance the closure of the Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) — FCNR(B) — swap window by a month, describing it as a well-thought-out, calibrated, prudent and data-driven response to evolving conditions.

FCNR(B) deposits allow non-residents to keep money in a bank in the foreign currency itself. While these deposits are available at all times, the RBI in June opened a temporary facility for banks to swap these deposits, with the central bank bearing the full currency risk of these foreign currency deposits.

“It will not be correct to call it a U-turn; it is rather a calibration,” Malhotra said.

The move demonstrated the central bank’s ability to remain flexible and data-dependent amid rapidly changing conditions, he added.

Responding to criticism that his remarks after the August 5 Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting had ruled out an early closure, Malhotra said the RBI was still assessing a situation that was evolving rapidly.

“I would like to highlight the use of the words ‘as of now’ when I mentioned that there



The decision to close the temporary facility early was part of the RBI’s external-sector management, Malhotra said. AMIT CHAKRAVARTY

was no proposal to advance the last date,” he said.

The RBI had also said it would keep stakeholders informed of any decision, clearly indicating that an early closure had not been ruled out, he added. According to Malhotra, the decision was taken from a position of strength.

The RBI expects the three schemes — FCNR(B), external commercial borrowings (ECBs) and overseas foreign currency borrowings (OFCBs) — to attract at least \$80 billion.

This reflected the country’s strong macroeconomic fundamentals and would further strengthen its balance of payments, he said. Inflows had been stronger than the RBI and most market participants had expected.

“There is a diminishing marginal utility of every dollar that is swapped. At the same time, there is an increasing marginal cost because you need to sterilise it for a longer period,” Malhotra said.

The decision to close the temporary facility early was part of the RBI’s external-sector management, Malhotra said.

On Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s hopes of having

MINUTES OF RBI’S MPC MEETING: GOV SAID INFLATION IS EXPECTED TO TAPER FROM ITS PEAK IN Q3

RBI policy panel signals rate hike risk as inflation rises

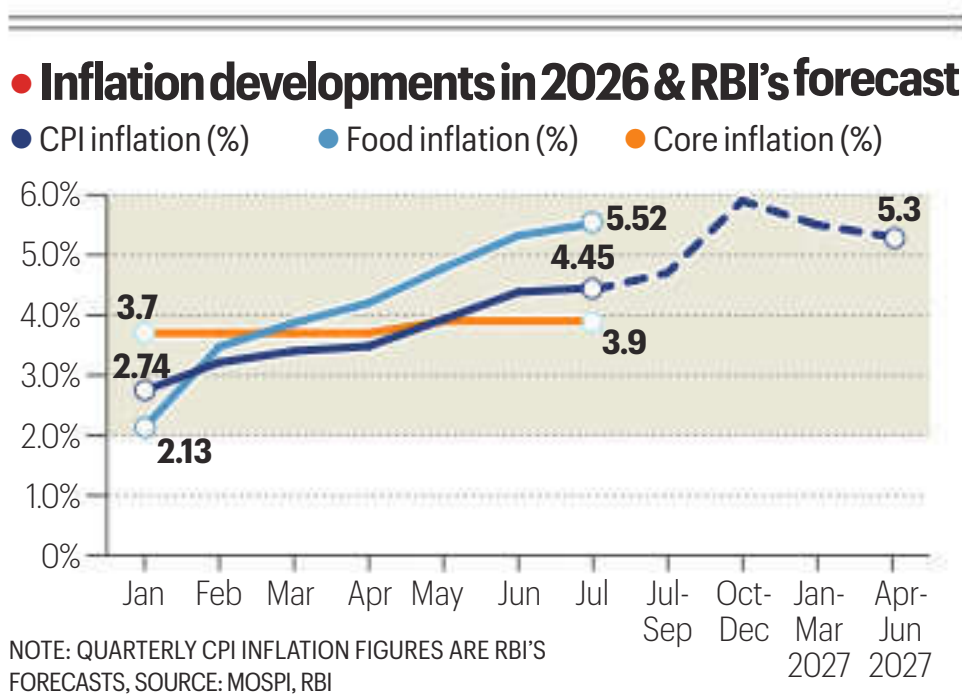
George Mathew
Mumbai, August 19

THE RESERVE Bank of India’s (RBI) Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) has signalled a cautious, wait-and-watch approach on the policy rate, with members calling for close monitoring of inflation before going for any policy tightening.

Members of the MPC indicated that as headline inflation is projected to peak to a level as high as 5.9% in Q3 2026-27, a “case for a hike may emerge” during the course of the year.

According to minutes of the MPC meeting held on August 5, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said he would prefer to wait for more certainty to emerge on the inflation trajectory in terms of the persistence of realised prints at these or higher levels, the forecast and the likely levels to which inflation may normalise and settle, for any recalibration of the policy rate.

“We also need to be watchful as the risks of higher food, fuel and other input prices translating into a broad-based increase in inflation, and de-anchoring of expectations persist. Any evidence of these risks



materialising may need policy tightening,” Malhotra said as per the minutes of the meeting.

The MPC kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% in the policy review. The panel marginally raised its growth forecast for FY27 to 6.7% from 6.6% and lowered its inflation projection to 5% from 5.1%.

No scope for further easing

Governor Malhotra said there are signs of a normalisation of inflation from its benign levels seen hitherto. The average inflation last year, when the policy rate was brought down to 5.25%, was only 2%.

“Not only has headline inflation already averaged 3.93% this year, even core excluding precious metals is expected to converge to core inflation in the last quarter of this financial year, with core inflation projected to average 4.3% in 2026-27. This may suggest a recalibration of policy rate,” he said.

“Inflation expectations, while slightly higher, are contained. Moreover, inflation is expected to taper from its peak in Q3. This shock does not therefore call for a monetary re-

CAS manipulation will attract strict & swift action: SEBI chief

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 19

SECURITIES AND Exchange Board of India (SEBI) Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey on Wednesday said the regulator would take strict action against any manipulation of the recently-launched Closing Auction Session (CAS) mechanism.

Later in the day, SEBI banned two firms from the market for allegedly manipulating trades on the CAS mechanism. The capital markets regulator said the alleged violations by Copthall Mauritius Investment and Mansi Share and Stock Broking happened on August 13 when weekly derivatives contracts linked to the Sensex expired.

“We want to make one thing clear, that if people manipulate the CAS system, then we will take strict action and do it immediately. CAS is for transparency. But if someone thinks that we will manipulate the CAS to defame it, then they are mistaken,” said Pandey, speaking at FICCI’s Capital Markets Conference in Mumbai.

“I think CAS participation is improving and will further improve. We are looking at the constraints for participation,” he added. Launched by SEBI on August 3, the Closing Auction Session (CAS) uses a blind auction model between 3:15PM and 3:35PM to discover a single, manipulation-resistant closing price. It replaced the old Volume Weighted Average Price (VWAP) system for F&O-eligible stocks. He also said the regulator will release data for the futures and options (F&O) segment for 2025-26 on Thursday, which will indicate if the measures taken in recent times by the SEBI and the Ministry of Finance to curb excessive volatility in the segment have been fruitful. While SEBI has taken measures such as increasing lot sizes and limiting the number of expiries per exchange, the finance ministry hiked the Securities Transaction Tax on the segment in the latest Union Budget.

The regulator had released a similar study earlier, which had flagged that over 90% of trades by retail investors led to losses.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

sponse to curtail demand as of now,” the governor said.

According to Poonam Gupta, Deputy Governor, the scope for any further easing does not seem to exist at the current juncture. Instead, given that the headline inflation is projected to peak to a level as high as 5.9% in Q3 2026-27, a case for a hike may emerge during the course of the year.

“I believe that with persistent uncertainty on account of global developments and weather-related risks, the best course of action would be to wait and watch a bit more,” Gupta said.

“The shift in the distribution towards higher inflation numbers warrants a careful vigil. One must look out for the extent of generalisation and risk of inflation expectations getting unanchored before contemplating any rate hike,” said Indranil Bhattacharyya, a member of the MPC.

Policy uncertainty, external shocks

MPC Member Ram Singh said high uncertainty still looms over several key monetary policy indicators.

“While the economy has withstood the conflict spillovers with limited impact so far, the strains are becoming increasingly visible. We have to closely watch if and how inflation-related risks resolve — El Niño’s effects on food inflation and global oil prices. As of now, it makes sense to retain all the maximum operational flexibility needed to respond to an evolving inflation trajectory,” Singh said.

“If external shocks worsen or the second-round price effects spread widely, we should be able to swiftly adjust policy to protect macroeconomic stability,” he said. “I judge it appropriate to await evidence of a further pickup in aggregate demand and generalisation of price pressures before taking the next policy action. Another factor which needs to be tracked are the levels of real interest rates,” said MPC Member Saugata Bhattacharya. Despite this caution, the forecast normalisation of underlying inflation from earlier benign levels will require close monitoring of the growth-inflation dynamics, for the appropriate time to recalibrate the policy rate, he said.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

AI adoption essential, but human judgement indispensable: RBI DG

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 19

RESERVE BANK of India’s (RBI) Deputy Governor Shirish Chandra Murmu on Wednesday underlined the importance of artificial intelligence (AI) in the banking system but emphasised that human intervention remains necessary in implementing the technology and identifying the loopholes.

“Its purpose is not to pull governance into day-to-day execution. It is to see where institutional capability or risk appetite is falling behind changing needs, and where separate weaknesses, each individually manageable, might combine into something larger,” said Murmu, speaking at an event in Mumbai.

“A model that performs well overall can still fail a small but already vulnerable group. Intelligence, therefore, demands clarity — about what technology delivers, what it leaves out, and whether its output fits the decision at hand,” Murmu said, adding that this is what makes human judgement indispensable. He highlighted that intelligence should not just be limited to AI but also take into account multiple components — analytical intelligence, human intelligence, governance intelligence, and collective intelligence, which entails information being pooled across banks. Murmu emphasised that banks should use AI and technology to reach and understand new borrowers.

“Where a lender genuinely lacks reliable information about a borrower, the absence of information should not, by itself, be mistaken for adverse information,” said Murmu.

“Treating ‘we don’t know’ as though it meant ‘we know it’s bad’ leads to credit being denied where it need not be. This is precisely where banks must put their technological capabilities to work,” he added.

While uniform adaptation of technology and models increases efficiency across the banking system, this “undue concentration” also raises the risk of digital fraud, which can move through multiple accounts and institutions.

“When risk becomes collective, the intelligence marshalled against it must become collective too,” he said.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

FM Sitharaman leads delegation to Singapore for 4th ISMR talks

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Wednesday embarked on an official visit to Singapore with a ministerial delegation to participate in the 4th India-Singapore Ministerial Roundtable (ISMR).

Sitharaman is leading a delegation comprising S Jaishankar, Minister of External Affairs; Piyush Goyal, Minister for Commerce & Industry; and Jitin Prasad, Minister of State for Electronics & IT and Commerce & Industry. The roundtable is scheduled for August 19-20, the

finance ministry said in a post on X. Established in 2022, the ISMR is a key high-level economic mechanism between India and Singapore.

It provides a platform to review progress and explore new areas of collaboration across six pillars: advanced manufacturing, connectivity, digitalisation, healthcare, and medicine, skills development, and sustainability. “The 4th ISMR will build on the progress made under these pillars and explore new opportunities,” the ministry said. PTI

• BRIEFLY

Hyundai Motor India to raise car prices by up to 1% from September

New Delhi: Hyundai Motor India said on Wednesday it will increase vehicle prices by up to 1% across its portfolio from September this year, with the extent of the hike varying by model and variant. The company attributed the increase to rising input and commodity costs, higher operational expenses, and continuing geopolitical uncertainties. Hyundai said it has been trying to absorb cost increases and optimize expenses but is now passing on part of the burden. REUTERS

Skoda CEO says VW aims to finalise India partner this year

New Delhi: Volkswagen expects to sign a deal with a local partner in India this year, the CEO of its Skoda brand, Klaus Zellmer, said, as the German group struggles to build scale in the world’s third-largest car market. Skoda is in charge of the group’s strategy in India, where VW is in talks on a joint venture with India’s steel-to-autos group JSW, which has indicated it wants a majority stake. REUTERS

Outgoing Air India CEO Wilson to join Air New Zealand board

New Delhi: Air New Zealand has appointed outgoing Air India CEO Campbell Wilson as a director on its board. Wilson, who has been steering loss-making Air India and its transformation efforts, will be stepping down as CEO and MD of the airline in September. Air India had announced his resignation on April 7. “Former airline executives Campbell Wilson and Robert McDonald have been appointed by the Board with effect from, and subject to their re-election by vote at the ASM,” Air New Zealand said in a regulatory filing on Wednesday. PTI

SpiceJet’s bankruptcy cases to be reheard

New Delhi: A court on Wednesday said bankruptcy petitions filed by aircraft lessors against SpiceJet will be heard afresh by a new bench, after the airline reached a last-minute settlement with one lessor. The order is a setback for aircraft leasing companies that have waged a years-long battle against India’s fourth-largest airline to recover debts, but is a reprieve for the airline, SpiceJet. PTI

IndiGo website hit by snag, online bookings & check-in hit

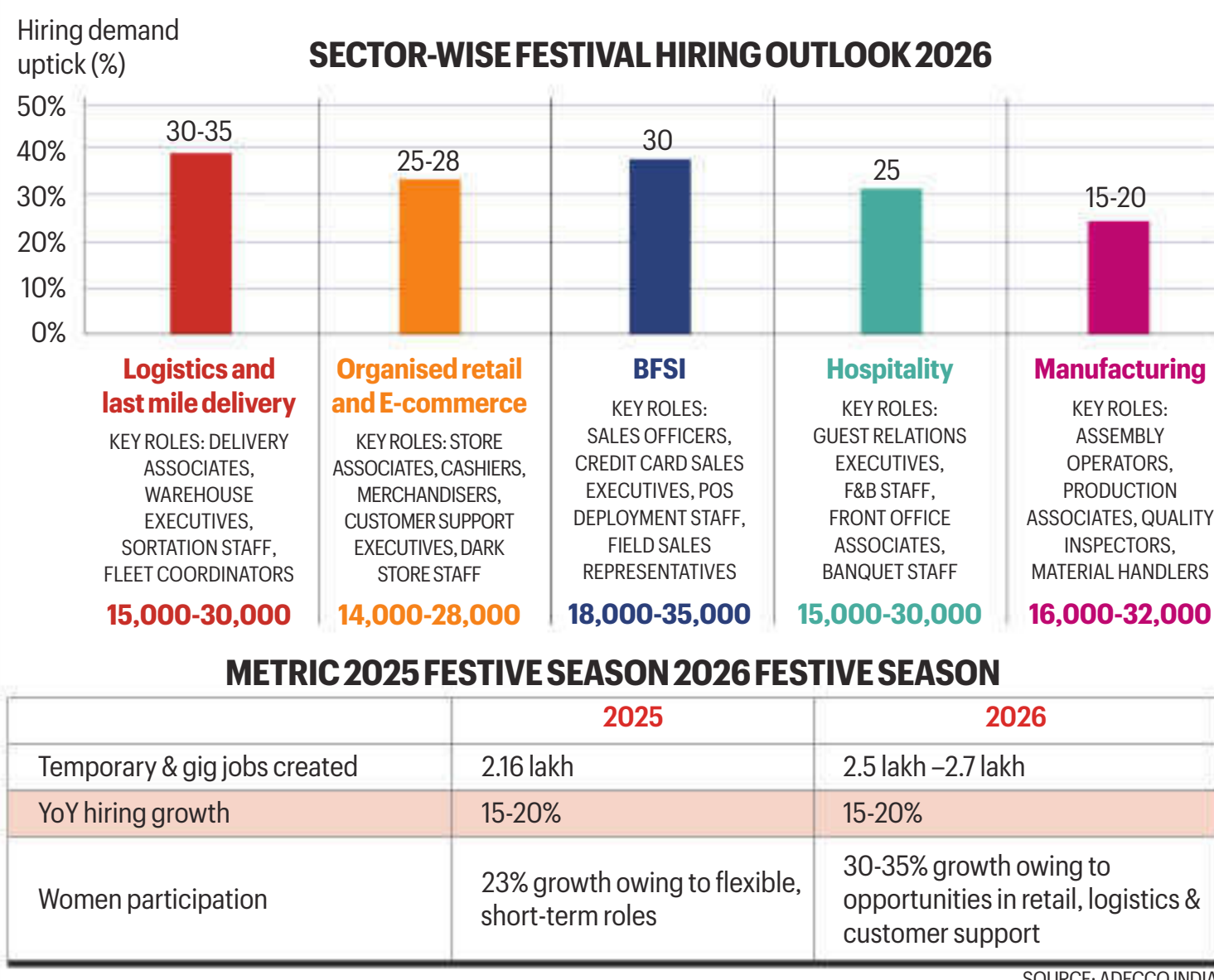
New Delhi: The reservation platform of the country’s largest airline IndiGo was hit by technical issues on Wednesday, affecting its online booking and web check-in services. Several people complained on social media that they were unable to make bookings or perform web check-ins on the IndiGo website and mobile application, and even on some of the third-party online travel booking portals.

The airline, which has a domestic market share of over 65% and operates about 2,200 daily flights, said that the issues were intermittent and its teams were working with the service provider to fix them on priority basis.

According to sources in the know, while the issues — which they said prima facie don’t appear to be major — impacted the booking platform servers, IndiGo’s airport and flight operations remained unaffected. ENS

TEMPORARY JOB RUSH TO MEET FESTIVAL DEMAND

The festival season is drawing close — Onam is likely to be celebrated on August 26. And with it, companies are gearing up to meet the demand and rush. According to a report by Adecco India, the industry is set to cross 2.5 lakh temporary and gig jobs this time. It expects temporary staffing demand for the 2026 festival season to grow by 15-20% against the same period last year.



• INDIA, THE WORLD’S BIGGEST CRUDE STEEL PRODUCER AFTER CHINA, MEETS 95% OF ITS COKING COAL NEEDS THROUGH IMPORTS

Steel mills face margin squeeze as global coking coal prices rise

Reuters
New Delhi, August 19

INDIAN STEEL mills are facing mounting pressure on margins as higher coking coal prices, driven by supply disruptions in Australia and China and the Iran war, raise steelmaking costs, executives and analysts said.

India, the world’s biggest crude steel producer after China, meets 95% of its coking coal needs through imports, with at least half shipped from Australia. Coking coal accounts for nearly 40% of steel production costs.

Squeezed margins could impede investment and delay capacity expansion as Indian

steelmakers step up spending to meet buoyant domestic demand driven by infrastructure and strong economic growth.

Premium hard coking coal prices jumped 25% from last year to average \$236 per metric ton freight on board (FOB) Australia in the first seven months of 2026, said Banmeet Khurmi, lead, metallurgical coal and coke market service, at consultancy CRU in Sydney.

“Prices have been higher this year due to supply disruptions in Australia, slower-than-expected ramp-up at new mines, price support from the conflict in the Middle East and, more recently, a large accident in Shanxi, China,” Khurmi said.



Every \$10 jump in coking coal price adds \$7-\$9 per metric ton to steelmaking costs. REUTERS

Costs are likely to remain high in the second half of the year, partly due to the loss of supply following the Shanxi coal mine

disaster, said Freddie Brooks, commodities analyst at BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions. For blast furnace-based steelmakers, every \$10 a ton increase in coking coal prices adds approximately \$7 to \$9 per metric ton to steelmaking costs, said an executive at a large steel mill, who was not authorised to speak to the media.

Higher coking coal prices have squeezed margins, three other executives at leading steelmakers said, with little headroom to raise steel prices, given competition from cheap Chinese steel.

Shipments from China have increased despite import tariffs on some grades. Coking coal imports are expected to rise by between 2 million and 3 million tons in 2026-27 from 64 million tons a year earlier, commodities

consultancy BigMint said. With the higher demand for imports, comes higher transport costs, partly due to disruptions from the U.S.-Iran war.

“Trade flows have tightened with high demand from India and higher diesel, freight and insurance costs,” said Hui Ting Sim, vice president at Moody’s Ratings. Australia is expected to continue meeting at least half of India’s coking coal needs, although imports from Russia, Mozambique and the United States are also set to rise.

Discounts on Russian coal, which accounted for 24% of India’s coking coal imports in recent years, have diminished over the past two years, Khurmi said.

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▲
76,909.68	24,078.30	₹1,53,868	₹95.76
-325.78	-76.60	Silver ▼	Oil ▲
-0.42%	-0.32%	₹2,29,225	\$92.11

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 18, 2026

Trump says he plans to meet Kim who has 57 ‘powerful’ nukes

Reuters
Washington, August 19

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said Wednesday that he planned to meet with North Korean leader Kim Jong Un, and said the Asian nation held 57 “very powerful” nuclear weapons.

The remarks come as Trump ordered Pentagon officials to cut short joint exercises with the South Korean military, writing in a social media post they sent a message to Pyongyang that was “totally inappropriate and hostile, to a Country that, as long as Donald Trump has been President, has been unthreatening and respectful.”

During Trump’s first term, Kim called Trump a “mentally deranged US dotard” and threatened that he had use of a “nuclear button” on his desk.

The leaders’ relationship cooled after face-to-face meetings in 2018 and 2019, including a brief exchange at the demilitarized zone between the Koreans in which Trump became the first



President Trump with Kim Jong Un at the demilitarized zone separating the two Koreas, in Panmunjom, South Korea. FILE

sitting US president to step into North Korean territory.

“I know Kim Jong Un very well, and he’s going to be fine as long as we have a smart president,” Trump told reporters Wednesday during a tour of the helipad he is constructing on the White House’s south lawn.

“The fact that I get along with him - that’s a good thing, not a bad thing. He has 57 very powerful nuclear weapons. They should have never allowed it. If I were president, I wouldn’t have allowed it. But he’s got them.”

The leaders’ relationship cooled after face-to-face meetings in 2018 and 2019, including a brief exchange at the demilitarized zone between the Koreans in which Trump became the first

China considering summit with Seoul in November

Seoul: Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi said on Wednesday that Beijing was “actively considering” a summit between the leaders of South Korea and China at the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation summit in Shenzhen in November, Seoul’s Foreign Ministry said.

He made the comment at a meeting with South Korean Foreign Minister Cho Hyun during a visit to Seoul, the ministry said

in a statement. Wang also invited Cho to visit China, and Cho accepted the invitation.

The ministers agreed to continue efforts to expand people-to-people exchanges, as the two countries forecast total travel between them to exceed 10 million visits, according to the ministry.

Cho urged China to play a role in bringing North Korea back to dialogue as soon as possible, the ministry said. REUTERS

TEHRAN DENIES LAUNCHING MISSILES TOWARDS UAE

UAE suspends trade ties with Iran after fresh missile attacks

UAE says missiles targeted maritime traffic in Hormuz

Associated Press
Dubai, August 19

THE UNITED Arab Emirates suspended all trade with Iran on Wednesday after it said it had come under renewed fire from the country — a move that will further isolate the Islamic Republic, which is suffering under US sanctions and a blockade.

Incoming ballistic missile fire triggered nationwide warnings Tuesday night for UAE residents to seek shelter, the first time in weeks such an alarm had sounded. Early in the conflict, the UAE regularly came under intense fire from Iran, and most trade between the countries, which had once been important trading partners, ground to a halt. In late June, as hostilities eased, some maritime trade resumed, Iran’s state-run IRNA news agency reported.

More time and data are needed to evaluate the full effect of war on Iran-UAE trade, but UAE is clearly a critical partner for Iran, said Mohammad Farzanegan, a professor of Middle Eastern economics at Germany’s University of Marburg.

Beyond the trade in domestically produced goods, “the UAE has been very important for Iran as a re-export hub and



Iran parliament speaker Mohammad Baqer Ghalibaf speaks at the Soleimani memorial site in Baghdad on Wednesday. REUTERS

has helped the country absorb some of the shocks caused by sanctions,” he told *The Associated Press*. “Iran therefore depends heavily on the UAE not because the UAE itself produces one-third of Iran’s imports, but because it serves as a major gateway for Iran to access third-country goods and commercial infrastructure.”

Following the news that two ballistic missiles had been fired toward the UAE, both of which splashed down in the Persian Gulf late Tuesday, the Foreign Ministry said that while it remained committed to “dialogue, cooperation and regional integration,” it had decided to impose the punitive measures.

“In light of regional escalations that undermine regional and international peace and security, all trade, commercial exchanges and financial transac-

tions with Iran have been halted until further notice,” the ministry said in a statement.

The UAE’s Defence Ministry said assessments showed that the missiles targeted maritime traffic. It was not clear whether they targeted Emirati ships or the country’s territorial waters.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei denied that Iran had launched any missiles toward the UAE.

As part of Iran’s efforts to maintain a stranglehold over the Strait, it has regularly attacked ships attempting to use waterway, including four tankers owned by Abu Dhabi’s state-owned ADNOC oil and gas company over the past two weeks.

None of the attacks caused injuries, but they brought harsh condemnation from the UAE and others in the region, including Kuwait and Bahrain.

Pak govt seeks review of top court order to shift Imran to private hospital

Press Trust of India
Islamabad, Lahore, August 19

THE PAKISTAN government on Wednesday petitioned the Supreme Court, seeking a review and recall of its order to shift jailed former prime minister Imran Khan to private hospital.

The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed that 73-year-old Khan be taken to Shifa International Hospital in Islamabad “within the next two days”, and he shall remain there until the next hearing on September 16.

It also ordered the setting up of a medical board and allowed the former cricketer-turned-politician weekly meetings with family. The order followed months of concern raised by Khan’s family and supporters over his health, and repeated allegations of being denied access to adequate medical care.

Khan, who is the founder of the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf political party, has been in Rawalpindi’s Adiala Jail since 2023, with several cases against him.

On Wednesday, the federal government termed the order “discriminatory” and argued it could set a precedent for all convicts to seek similar treatment in case of health issues, as it filed the review petition.

Senior leaders of Khan’s party criticised the federal government’s move and accused it of adopting “delaying tactics” instead of adhering to order.

The SC directive in Khan’s case came while hearing several identical petitions following the politician’s eye ailment that surfaced earlier this year.

• BRIEFLY

CONGO

Ebola tops 5,000 cases, outpaces response efforts at record speed



Health workers at a treatment centre in Bunia, Congo. FILE

THE EBOLA outbreak in Congo has reached 5,000 cases, government data showed Wednesday, as responders warn it is spreading at an unprecedented speed outpacing efforts to slow it in one of the country’s remotest regions. Data from Congo’s Ministry of Health showed the outbreak had so far recorded 5,021 cases, including 2,378 deaths as of Sunday, as it rages in some of the most challenging conditions imaginable fueled by insecurity, displacement and intense population movements. AP

BRAZIL

21 killed after bus and truck collide head-on

AT LEAST 21 people died and four others were injured in a head-on collision between a bus and a truck in the BR-373 highway in Brazil’s Parana state, the road operator said Wednesday. All the fatal victims were on the bus, Via Araucaria added. The road was completely blocked with no estimated time for it to be cleared. REUTERS

UNITED STATES

Trump taps WH adviser Overton to lead FDA

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump Wednesday named White House policy aide Heidi Overton to lead Food and Drug Administration, writing online that she would push his “America First” policies. Overton, a doctor by training serves as deputy director of the White House domestic policy council. REUTERS

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

SRI LANKA

Former minister held in 2 separate corruption cases

SRI LANKAN authorities have arrested former minister Keheliya Rambukwella in two separate cases over allegations of graft and conspiracy, the anti-graft commission said in a statement. The commission on Tuesday arrested Rambukwella, a former media and health minister, at around 11.30 am and 1.15 pm in connection with two cases. PTI

NEPAL

PM Balen skips meeting called by RSP chairman

THE GROWING differences between PM Balendra Shah and Chairman of the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party Rabi Lamichhane came to the fore Wednesday with the former skipping a meeting of the parliamentary party summoned by the former. The meeting called was attended by most ministers and RSP legislators, but not Shah. YUBARAJ GHIMIRE

Ukraine’s new defence chief takes office as predecessor urges fresh polls

Reuters
Kyiv, August 19

UKRAINIAN LAWMAKERS appointed a new defence minister on Wednesday, hours after his ousted predecessor dealt a major blow to President Volodymyr Zelenskyy with a call for elections in wartime.

Yevhenii Khmara, a former top special forces operative, takes up the critical defence portfolio amid fresh political turmoil for the president, who had faced weeks of protests over his dismissal of 35-year-

old reformer Mykhailo Fedorov. Khmara’s appointment also took place just hours after anti-corruption authorities announced charges against a deputy chief of Zelenskyy’s office as part of an alleged \$3 million money-laundering scheme.

Fedorov’s removal as defence minister in July brought thousands of demonstrators onto the streets in rare wartime protests over a surprise shake-up seen as poorly communicated to the public at a critical time in the war with Russia.

His bold call for elections in



New Ukraine Defence Minister Yevhenii Khmara. REUTERS

the fifth year of fighting drew accusations of populism in a country where a majority of

people still oppose a wartime vote, even though many argue that Ukraine needs fresh faces in power.

“He chose to move on the populist trajectory, underlining the risks and challenges for democratic process of election,” said Lesia Bidochko, a policy fellow at the European Policy Institute in Kyiv.

In his statement late Tuesday, Fedorov said the country faced a crisis of governance and that Ukraine’s democratic process “cannot be held hostage by Russia”. Wartime elections are

prohibited under law. An August 5 poll by the Kyiv International Institute of Sociology showed 57% of Ukrainians believe they should only take place after the war, given that hundreds of thousands of troops are on the front line and Russian missiles and drones are raining down on Ukrainian cities, towns and villages.

“We must find a legal, safe and realistic mechanism that will allow Ukraine to renew its full democratic process even in the conditions of a long war,” said Fedorov.

Fuel stations in Moscow limit sales

Moscow: Fuel stations in Moscow have reimposed limits on gasoline purchases due to fuel shortages linked to Ukrainian drone attacks on refineries and strong seasonal demand.

Shortages began to gather pace in May and had spread to most Russian regions by July, but fuel stations in Moscow were able to ease an earlier wave of restrictions in June. REUTERS

Over 100 killed in Central African Republic gold mine collapse

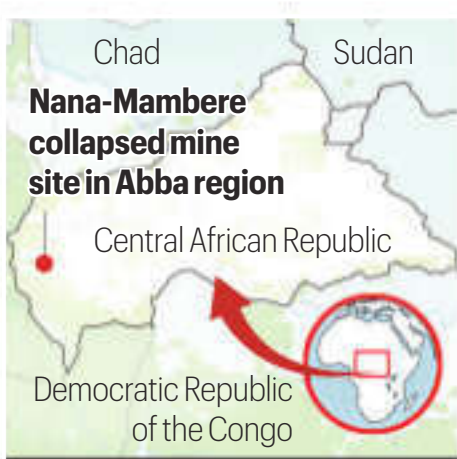
Bangui: The death toll from a gold mine collapse in a western part of Central African Republic has risen to over 100, a Red Cross volunteer involved in relief efforts said Wednesday.

The low-tech, artisanal gold mine collapsed Tuesday morning in the village of Zamboye, in the Nana-Mambere prefecture, near the border with Cameroon.

Gervais Ganagoroh, a local Red Cross volunteer involved in relief efforts, said more than 100 dead bodies have been recovered so far, while several survivors are critically injured.

Bertrand Be Yangue, a member of the Zamboye youth council, also said the death toll is more than 100, adding that it’s likely to rise, as several people are still missing and others are

• Scene of Tragedy



trapped under the rubble.

“Finding them alive would be a miracle,” Yangue said. “We are saddened and heartbroken to see young men and women perish after coming to the mines to save their families from despair,” he added. AP

Bangladesh to hold presidential election today

Dhaka: Bangladesh will hold its presidential election Thursday, with lawmakers set to choose between the ruling BNP stalwart Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir and 11-party opposition alliance candidate Colonel (ret’d) Oli Ahmed.

The voting will take place for the first time in a presidential election after a gap of 35 years. The voting will be held at the parliament from 2:00 pm to 5 pm on August 20.

Alamgir, 78, is the candidate of the ruling BNP, while Colonel (ret’d) Ahmed, chairman of the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP), is contesting as the candidate of the Jamaat-e-Islami-led 11-party opposition alliance. PTI



Jellyfish Heart

Moon jellyfish are displayed at the Jellyfish Museum in Florida, a facility that is home to about 20 unique species of jellyfish found across the world, on Wednesday. AP

FBI adds gangster Major Singh on its ‘wanted’ list

Washington: The FBI is on the lookout for Major Singh, an Indian national allegedly involved in narcotics and illegal arms smuggling, and has placed him on the list of “wanted” criminals.

“Major Singh is wanted for his alleged involvement in a transnational criminal organisation engaged in racketeer influence and corrupt organisations conspiracy; conspiracy to engage in the business of dealing in firearms without a license; conspiracy to distribute and possess with intent to distribute controlled substances; and distribution of controlled substances,” the FBI said on Tuesday. PTI

• SOME AUTHORS USE THEIR WRITINGS TO CALL ATTENTION TO THE HARSH REALITIES OF LIFE FOR MIGRANT AND GIG WORKERS, WHILE OTHERS CELEBRATE THE HUMANITY THAT FLOURISHES IN SPITE OF TOUGH CONDITIONS

China’s worker-writers strike a chord as economic gloom and job insecurity spread

Yan Zhuang
August 19

A CHINESE food delivery driver rushes from gig to gig, measuring time by the number of jobs he completes instead of by the passing of the seasons. He toils in cities across China to send money back to his family, but has been away so long his son calls him “that man” instead of “Dad.”

These are scenes from the poems of Wang Jibing, a food delivery driver, one of several Chinese poets and authors who have turned their experiences of repetitive factory labor and insecure gig work into art.

This literary genre has ballooned in popularity in recent

years, as many Chinese have grown pessimistic about the economy. For a wide swath of society, wages have stagnated, youth unemployment is high and the promise of a better life in return for hard work has faded.

Some authors use their writing to call attention to the harsh realities of life for migrant and gig workers, while others celebrate the humanity that flourishes in spite of those conditions. Their styles are often raw and straightforward.

Writers such as Hu Anyan, a courier who wrote a bestselling memoir about the jobs he has worked across the gig economy, and Fan Yusu, who left her children behind to work as a live-

in nanny in Beijing, have tapped into these themes. They have published essays online that have been shared widely and led to book deals. Some bestsellers have been translated and published overseas.

Last month, Wang’s new poetry collection, “Low Flight,” won the Lu Xun Literary Prize, in the highest institutional recognition for the genre yet.

For the Chinese public, curiosity about these workers is intertwined with anxiety about their own prospects. The concern may be pronounced for members of China’s middle class. They “pay more attention to these kinds of narratives because they may represent their



Food delivery riders in Shenzhen, China. NYT

future lives,” said Zhu Ping, a professor of Chinese studies at University of California San Diego’s literature department.

Gig and factory workers are ubiquitous, yet the hardship and indignities they endure are rarely depicted by China’s state-

controlled media, which prefers a more positive spin. As the literary work’s influence has grown, Chinese officials, wary of power of workers’ grievances to illuminate policy shortcomings or spawn unrest, have increasingly sought to shape it, experts said.

Since the 1980s, rural workers have powered China’s factories and cities while often being denied health insurance, unemployment and retirement benefits available to urban residents. The literary movement’s early authors wrote essays and poems about their experiences in factories, but as manufacturing jobs have begun to disappear, its new stars are doing gig work. One such star is Hu, the cour-

ier who wrote a bestselling memoir. The book, *I Deliver Parcels in Beijing*, was published in 2023 in China, where it was deemed that year’s best book by Douban, China’s equivalent to Goodreads. It is a diaristic account of 19 jobs he held over two decades across China, including as a sorter at a logistics company, security guard, convenience store worker and courier.

Hu’s work first came to public attention through an essay he posted online. It detailed his year on the night shift sorting packages at a logistics firm, where work was grueling and he struggled sleep during the day: *Trapped by a row of houses on my way in every day. I could*

smell the cooking going on inside, see the people collapsed on their couches, tired and content after a day’s work. That, to me, was what true happiness looked like. Meanwhile I was already more exhausted than those people, and I hadn’t even reached the warehouse. I cursed myself in those moments: My damned body cursed my willpower, and my damned willpower cursed it back. I swore I would go right to sleep when I clocked off in the morning. But then the morning came around, and everything went the same as the day before. I was trapped in a loop.

— *I Deliver Parcels in Beijing*,” translated into English by Jack Hargreaves. NYT

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Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Naema, W/o Tahawar Husain Siddiqui, R/o Makbara-2, Sabzi Mandi Ke Saamne, Katghar, Muradabad, U.P.-244001, have changed my name to Naim Akhtar, for all purposes.

0040873202-1

I, PRADEEP KUMAR, S/O-RAM CHAND ARORA, R/O-148-149,UGF, POCKET-5,SECTOR-25, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, have changed my name to PARDEEP KUMAR ARORA

0040873276-6

I Mohd Anis Ansari S/O Mohd Khalil R/O B-54 uday vihar, Near transformer wall gali, Nilothi extension, Nangloi, West Delhi 110041, hereby declare that in some documents my name wrongly mentioned as Anees but my correct and actual name is Mohd. Anis Ansari for all purposes.

0071055391-1

I, FARZANA PARVEEN, W/O- RAJUDDIN ADDRESS-A-47 Priyanka camp madan pur khadar sarita vihar, South Delhi-110076 have changed my name to SEEMA for all purposes.

0040873281-2

I GURPEET KAUR W/O GURMEET SINGH R/O C-7-8/1,KH NO. 28/20, GALI NO. 4, HIMGIRI ENCLAVE, CHANDER VIHAR, NILOTHI EXTN., DELHI-110041, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GURPREET KAUR IN FUTURE FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0050295682-1

I, Jitender Kumar S/O Om Prakash Arora R/O C-1/74B, Keshav Puram, Delhi-110035, have changed my name to Jitender Kumar Arora for all future purposes.

0040873275-2

I Riazzuddin S/o Mohd Sayeed R/o 7524,Gali Qabron Wali, Quresh Nagar, Sadar Bazar, North Delhi-110006 have changed the name of my minor daughter from Arbish Riaz to Arbish for all purposes.

0040873197-4

I,SUNDER PAL,S/O ZILEY SINGH MALIK,R/O 13/270,SUBHASH NAGAR,BARAUT,BARAUT,BAGH PAT,UTTAR PRADESH-250611,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUNDER PAL MALIK, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE.

0040873277-4

I hitherto known as Nirmala Devi May Reddy Alias K Nirmala Alias Nirmala Kamatham Alias May Reddy Nirmala Reddy Alias Nirmala D/o Laxma Reddy Veeraredy and W/o Kamatham Raghava Reddy residing at 4-79, Hanmanpally, Kosgi, Bhaktithimala, PO-Bhogaram, Dist-Mahabubnagar, Telangana - 509339, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Kamatham Nirmala Devi.

0071055436-1

I,MAMTA,W/O JANAK RAJ-ARORA,R/O G-2524,2ND FLOOR-SANIK COLONY SECTOR-49,NEAR DAV-PUBLIC-SCHOOL FARIDABAD-121001 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MAMTA JYOTI ARORA

0040873271-6

I HARSHITA MEHTA D/O VIRENDER MEHTA R/O D-128 SECTOR 36 NOIDA UTTAR PRADESH 201301 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO HARSHITA SAWHNEY FOR ALL PURPOSE

0040873195-1

I, GORAKH PARASD S/o Ram Avadh Sahni R/O 293-B, Andrewsganj South Delhi-110049 have changed my name to GORAKH PRASAD SAHANI

0040873276-8

I, PINKI ALIAS TAMANNA D/o ANIL KUMAR W/o MANISH R/o G-7/116 GROUND FLOOR, ROHINI SECTOR 15, PO: ROHINI SECTOR 15, DELHI-110089 have changed my name to TAMANNA for all purposes.

0071055395-1

I, Prakash Vishwakarma S/o Man Biswakarma R/o A-4 U/G/F B/5 L/S Sector, Vishwakarma Colony, Vishwakarma Mandir, Puli Pehlad, Puri Pahladpur, South Delhi-110044, have changed my name to Prakash Biswakarma

0071055384-1

I, Sharvan Kumar S/o Sh.Harpal Singh R/o 740,Bakhtawar pur Tanda,North West Delhi-36.That in my Son class-10th marksheet my name written as Sharvan chauhan which is incorrect. Actual name of mine is Sharvan Kumar.Both name belongs to one and same person.

0071055474-1

I,Joginder Singh Nalva,S/o Prem Singh,R/O B-32,Vijay Vihar,Phase-I,Delhi-110085 inform, that Joginder Singh and Joginder Singh Nalva Both name are one and the same person.

0040873295-3

I, Virender Kumar Bakshi, son of J. N. Bakshi, R/o 18/1, Ward number-1, Mehrauli, Delhi-110030 has changed my name from Virender Kumar Bakshi to Virender Kumar Bakshi. Therefore, Virender Bakshi and Virender Kumar Bakshi is one and the same person. Thereafter, in future, I will be known by Virender Kumar Bakshi for all purposes.

0071055457-1

I,NITU ARYA W/o Ved Arya, R/o 103, Tower no.3, Godrej Woods, sector 43, Noida-201303, have changed my name to NETTU ARYA for all future Purposes.

0071055400-1

I,Hitherto known as Badrul Alam,S/o Sh. Abdul Hannan Mullick,R/o-5A/14, 1st. Floor,W.E.A. House No.10944,Sat Nagar,Gali No.4,Delhi-110005 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Badrul Alam Mullick

0040873276-10

I, hitherto known as Preeti Shakya D/o Sh. Murl Manohar W/o Sh. Gagan Sharma R/O-121B, Gali no.18, Dashrathpuri, New Delhi have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Preeti Sharma.

0040873203-1

I,Manzoor Ahmed and Asma,father and mother of minor Mohammad Ayaan, residing at,I-34/2,Batla House,Jamia Nagar,Okhla,South Delhi-110025,hereby,declare that the name of our minor son Mohammad Ayaan has been changed to Mohd Ayaan and shall henceforth be known as Mohd Ayaan for all future purposes.

0040873271-8

I, Mohd Shakil S/o MOHD NAIMUDDIN R/O 255, HAUZ RANI, PO,Malviya Nagar, District HAUZ Khas, South Delhi 110017 My father's name was wrongly written as NAIMUDADIN in my driving license, but the correct name is MOHD NAIMUDDIN

0071055499-1

I hitherto known as K Rangava Reddy S/o Kamatham Ramalinga Reddy residing at H No-4-79, Hanumanpally, Kosgi Mandalam, Bhogaram, PO-Bhogaram, Distt- Mahabubnagar, Telangana-509339 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Kamatham raghava reddy.

0071055446-1

I,Ramya Rajaram Iyer,D/o Venkataram Rajaram,W/o Raghunathan Jaikumar,R/O G041,DLF Regent House,DLF City Phase-4,Chakarpur (74),Gurgaon(HR.)-122002 have changed,my name to Ramya Iyer for all purposes.

0040873277-6

My Actual/Correct name is URVASHI instead of SHIVANI which is wrongly written in my Son Anish Kumar Birth Certificate,W/o-Ravi Kumar,LIG,Flat-no,76, Hastsal,Uttam Nagar Delhi-59

0040873276-1

I,Rajinder Kaur Sahni w/o-Tajinder Singh Sahni, R/o-A-188, Sudarshan Park, New Delhi-15, have changed my name to Rajvinder Kaur w/o Tajinder Singh.

0040873074-1

I, RAGHU NATH SINGH @ RAGHU NANDAN SINGH C/o Badam Singh, Nawada Dnah, Nabhichi, Shahjahanpur, UP-242042, have changed my name to RAGHU NATH Singh, all name is one and same person.

0071055471-1

I,Fareena Anjum,W/o-Mohd Suhail,R/O H-No.T-635,Gali No.11,T-block, Goutam puri garhi mendo Delhi 110053,have changed my name to FARINA ANJUM permanently

0040873295-1

I, SUNEEL KUMAR THAKUR R/O FLAT NO.211, BHAGIRATHI APARTMENT,SECTOR-9,ROHINI,DELHI-110085,changed my minor son name from VIVAAN KANWAR THAKUR to VIRAAJ THAKUR

0040873276-3

I,Rajkumari Bedarani Devi,W/o Late Ksh Kishochandra Singh,R/o Laishram Leikai,Khurai, Lamlong,Perompat,Imphal,Ma nipur,PIN-795010,have changed my name to Kshetrimayum Bedrani for all purposes.

0040873281-1

I, Ayushi D/o Surender singh R/o 10/9 Kishan Garh Vasant Kunj New Delhi-110070 have changed my name to Ayushi Singh for all future purposes.

0071055390-1

I,hitherto known as Kirti Mishra ,alias Km Kirti,alias Kirti Shukla,w/o-Shaji Prakash Shukla,R/o-319A/4,Govindpuri, Kalkaji,New Delhi-110019,have changed,my name and shall hereafter be known as Kirti Shukla

0040873276-5

I, MOHD ASLAM S/O MOHAMMAD YASIN R/O 3075-3077, G/F,MOHALLA SHAHGANI,P,S,HAUZ QAZI,NEAR-DARI WALI MASJID,DELHI-110006,CHANGED MY NAME AS “MOHAMMAD ASLAM”

0050295691-1

I MUSKAN JAIN W/O BHARAT JAIN R/O- H-NO 453 SECOND FLOOR JAGRITI ENCLAVE EAST DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MUSKANA JAIN

0040873212-1

I, Baljit Singh Khurana S/o Harbajhan Singh Khurana R/O A-5, Mansarovar Garden, Delhi-110015,have changed my name to Baljeet Singh Khurana for all purposes.

0040873277-1

I Supriya Tewari W/o Khalid Hussain Khan, R/o Plot No.-4/44, Block B, Phase-4, Main Market Aya Nagar, Anshu Medical Walli Gali, South Delhi, Delhi-110047 have changed my name to Sofia Khan for all purposes.

0040873197-3

I Pratiksha D/o Shiv Vishal Yadav, R/o Plot No.11, and 11-A, KH.No. 79/4, G-1, 2nd Floor, LHS, G-1/11 and 11-A, Universal School, Mahavir Enclave, Palam Village, South West Delhi, Delhi-110045 have changed my name to Pratiksha Yadav for all purposes.

0040873197-1

I, L Venkatamma Mother of, BHANU CHANDER LANKA presently residing in Door No-22-7-31,Ambatisatram, Vizianagaram,Andhra-Pradesh-535002 have changed my name from L Venkatamma to LENKA VENKATA LAXMI,vide-Affidavit,Date:19-8-2026.

0040873271-14

I,Ramesh Chander Khyatri/Ramesh Chandra Khatri,S/O Din Dayal Khatri,R/O-B-606,6th,floor-Naveen apartment Block-B Plot no -13 Sec-5,Dwarka-New Delhi-110045,have changed my name to RAMESH CHANDER KHATRI Permanently

0040873271-1

Ihitherto known as Mangalpalli Sarala Alias K Sarala W/o Kanakadandila Shankara Shastri residing at Plot No 42/A, Shankara nilayam, 5bh Colony, Mohan Nagar, Kothapet, Saroornagar, Distt- Rangareddi, Telangana-500035 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Sarala Kanakadandila.

0071055450-1

I,Sudhir Gupta S/o Rajeshwar Dayal R/O 204/2, Sector-16B, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201012 have changed my name to Sudhir Kumar Gupta.

0040873271-4

I,Amit Kumar Goel,S/O Lajpat Rai R/O H.No-3355,PO- Nissing,Karnal (Haryana)-132024,have changed my name to Amit Kumar for All Purposes.

0040873277-8

I, Jahid S/o Rafakat Ali R/o Near Nutani Masjid, Nai Abadi, Dadri, G.B.Nagar, have changed my name to Zahid.

0040873271-3

I,ANNU DEVI SOLANKI W/O SH. SHIV RAJ SOLANKI R/O H.NO.16/1530-E,BAPANAGAR ,ARYA SAMAJ ROAD, KAROL BAGH, NEW DELHI-110005. ANNU AND ANNU DEVI SOLANKI BOTH ARE SAME PERSON.

0040873275-1

I,RIPAN KUMAR,S/O TARA CHAND,R/O D-24 TEACHER COLONY PRATAP VIHAR VIJAY NAGAR GHAZIABAD, U.P.201009 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RIPAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040873277-3

I,hitherto known as Mohd Sarwar Khan S/o Mohd Rustam Khan residing at 9-4-50/37/C, Hakeempet, Tolichowki, VTC-Golconda, Distt- Hyderabad, Telangana -500008 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Mohammed Riyaz Khan.

0071055431-1

I,Mohammad Luqman S/o-Mohd Sayeed R/o-10005, Gali Nal Wali Nawab Ganj, Azad Market, Delhi-06, declares that my name is changed as MOHD LUQMAN for all purpose.

0040873249-1

I,Jyoti Panwar,D/o Ishwar Chand Sharma,R/o-D-904,KAVISHA CELEBRATION AROHI CLUB ROAD, SOUTH-BHOPAL,AHMEDABAD RURAL,GUJARAT-380058 change my name Jyoti Panwar to Jyoti Sharma

0040873271-13

I, Usha Devi Wife of Shri Pawan Singh Present Address: PN-2, PNB Nivas, PC Hostel Road, Chetpet, Chennai-600031, Permanent Address: H.No.-76, Arya Nagar, Assandh Road, VTC: Panipat, PO- Panipat, Distt.- Panipat, Haryana-132103 hereby declare that I have changed my name from Usha to Usha Devi, vide Affidavit No. IN-DL65437905231234Y dated 30.07.2026 before the Notary Public at Delhi. I shall henceforth be known as “Usha Devi” for all legal, official and other purposes.

0040873194-1

I,MOHD AKIF,S/O-MOHD ARIF,R/O A-56/4 GALI NO.8,SHASTRI PARK, BHAIJANPURA DELHI-110053,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD AKIF MANSOORI,FOR ALL PURPOSE

0040873276-7

I, SALOCHANA C/o Kartik Bisht R/o 363, Near BSES Office, Rama Krishna Puram, VTC R.K. Puram Sector-9, Post Office R.K. Puram Sector-5, Delhi-110021,declare that names of mine,my wife and my minor son have been wrongly written as PRAVEEN KUMAR BAGRI,MANISHA BAGRI and ARJUN KUMAR BAGRI in my minor son's namely ARJUN KUMAR,aged-14 years,in his School Records.The actual names of mine,my wife and my minor son are PRAVEEN KUMAR, MANISHA and ARJUN KUMAR,respectively,which may be amended accordingly.

0040873276-4

I, Madhu Devi D/o Kanhaiya Lal residing at K-1/20 Mohan Garden, have changed my name to Sonia Kaushik vide affidavit dated 17/08/26 at Delhi.

0050295686-1

I,VIJAY S/O MITHAN LAL R/O 3/335, TRILOKPURI DELHI 110091, inform that my correct Name is VIJAY and My Name wrongly mentioned in my Son PIYUSH 10th marksheet VIJAY KUMAR. VIJAY and VIJAY KUMAR are the one and same Person.

0040873275-3

I,Rekha Sehrawat,W/o Rakesh Kumar,R/o H.No.-100, VPO-Sukhrali,Opposite-Punjab National Bank,Gurgaon (Haryana),have changed my name to Rekha for all Purposes.

0040873277-5

I Manisha Rani Pahwa D/O Kewal Krishan R/O F-702,Tulip ivory, Sector-70, Bhadshahpur,Gurgaon-122001 Haryana Have Changed my Name to Manisha Pahwa

0040873276-9

I,PURAN CHAND FULARA,S/O Heera Bhallabh,R/O H NO-B-366,Gali NO-8,Om Nagar,Mithapur Ext.,South Delhi-110044 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO Puran Chandra

0040873271-7

I, Deep Chandra S/o Nain Singh, House No. F-89, F-Block, West Vinod Nagar, Shakar Pur Baramad, East Delhi, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Deepchand for all future Purposes.

0071055397-1

I,Pradeep Kumar Sawhney alias Pardeep Sawhney,S/o Jagdish Chander Sawhney,R/o,GH-5 and 7,Flat no 826,Paschim Vihar,DELHI-110087 have changed,my name,to Pradeep Sawhney.

0040873295-2

I, Suman W/o Sh.Sharvan Kumar R/o 740, Bakhtawar pur Tanda,North West Delhi-36. That in my Son class-10th marksheet my name written as Suman chauhan which is incorrect. Actual name of mine is Suman.Both name belongs to one and same person.

0071055473-1

I, Ayush Verma S/o Rajeshwar Singh Verma R/o D-2-40, Vinodpuri Vijay Enclave Palam Village S.O. Dabri, South West Delhi-110045, have changed my name to Mukul Verma

0071055383-1

I,SUNEEL KUMAR THAKUR,R/O FLAT NO. 211,BHAGIRATHI APARTMENT, SECTOR-9, ROHINI,DELHI-110085,changed my minor son name from VIVAAN KANWAR THAKUR to VIVAAN THAKUR.

0040873276-2

I,Nirmala Devi Yadav,D/o Har Lal,W/o Suresh Kumar Yadav,R/O 902, S Block,Sispal Vihar, Sector-49, Sohna Road, Gurugram, Haryana-122018 have changed my name to Nirmal Yadav for All Purposes.

0040873277-7

I Suresh Bala W/o, Rajesh Kumar R/o Rze-18 Nihal Vihar Nangloi Delhi 110041 have changed my name to Aarti Devi.

0040873239-1

I,GITANJALI PRADHAN,D/o Ratan Mani Pradhan,R/O R.H.No.-29, Khalsa No.-298/1 Min,Third Floor,Unit No. D-1,Gadaipur,South Delhi-110030 HAVE CHANGED,my name to LALHMACHHUANI PRADHAN,for all future purposes.

0040873271-13

I Devendra Singh S/o Late Sitar Ram R/o Kalinjar, PO Bateswahr, District Agra, U.P. In my Son's Aadhar Card Records his name is written as Anand Yadav but his actual & correct name is Nitin

0040873205-1

I Shahnawaz S/o Jamaludeen R/O Y-29, Budh Vihar, Phase-1, Delhi-110086, have changed my name to Shahnawaj Salmani

0071055426-1

I,Sarabjeet kaur,W/o Varinder Singh,R/O,S-160, S/7,Greater Kailash-1 Delhi-110048 have changed my name Sarabjeet to Sarabjeet Kaur for future known

0040873295-4

I, MOHD YASIN S/O HAFEZUDDIN R/O 3075-3077,G/F, MOHALLA SHAHGANI,P,S,HAUZ QAZI,NEAR-DARI WALI MASJID,DELHI-110006,CHANGED MY NAME AS “MOHAMMAD YASIN”

0050295690-1

I,hithereto known as Preeti Verma,W/O-Rahul Kumar,R/O-D-8,UGF,Plot No-44A,Pushpa Apartment,Sector-5,Rajender Nagar,Ghaziabad, UP-201005,have changed the name of my minor daughter Medna Sharma to Medna,for all purpose forever.

0040873276-4

I,Manzar Shafiq Khan, S/o Shafiq Ahmad Khan, R/O A/17 3rd Floor, Muradi Road, Batla House, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name to MANZAR SHAFIQ for all future purposes.

0071055385-1

I,Amit Kumar,S/o Lajpat Rai R/O H.No.-3355,PO:- Nissing,Karnal (Haryana)-132024, have changed my Minor Son's name from Soryai to Shourya for all Purposes.

0040873277-9

I,Geetanjali,R/o 86B1 Krishna Nagar, Safdarjung Enclave, Delhi-110029, have changed my name from Geeta / Geeta Sahdev to Geetanjali, for all purpose in future.

0040873271-2

I,Wali Mohd S/o Nabi Mohd. R/o 15/391 FIRST FLOOR TRILOKPURI,MAYUR VIHAR PHASE-1, Delhi-110091 have changed my name to Wali Mohammad, S/o Nabi Mohammad for all future Purposes

0071055454-1

I,Dhrup Singh Karki,s/o Kishan Singh,R/o village, digara.p.o muhani district-plithoragarh, Uttarakhand-262552 have changed,my name from Dhrup Singh Karki to Dhruv Karki vide-affidavit,dated-19/08/2026

0040873271-15

I Sumit S/o Jai Ram, R/o RZ-CD-18, Gali No.13, Mahavir Enclave Part-1, Palam Village, South West Delhi, Delhi-110045 have changed my name to Sumit Kumar for all purposes.

0040873197-2

I Deepika D/O Late SH.Bal Singh,R/O RZ-288,Braham Puri Pankha Road,Nangal Raya New Delhi-110046 Have Changed my Name to Deepa Rana.

0040873277-2

I, Joginder Kaur Sawhney W/o Lakhbir Singh R/o 32 / 52, Punjabi Bagh West, Delhi-110026, have changed my name to Joginder Kaur Permanently.

0040873213-1

LOST & FOUND

I,LOVELY CHADHA S/o KAMAL CHADHA have Lost my Property Original Documents POSSESSION SLIP of my PROPERTY NO.F-27Y Jahangirpuri Delhi-110033. FINDER CONTACT-9871568830.

0040873276-11

It is notified for information for public at large that original Regular Letter of Allotment regarding the Property No.150, Phase-V, Sector-56, Industrial Estate, Kundli Sonipat, Haryana, have been Lost or misplaced. FIR/LR No.318806/2026 dated-21/05/26 has been registered online. Finder please Contact-Mr.Ravinder Gupta (M).9312275340

0040873240-1

PROPERTY

REQUIRED ONE LAKH sqft warehouse ready or built 2 suit, Tarapur, Dahanu, Boisar, Call 9127602555

0050295684-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client RAJINDER GOEL S/O LATE PANNAL LAL GOEL & SEEMA GOEL W/O RAJINDER GOEL R/O B-606/81, GROUND FLOOR, SECTOR-7, ROHINI DELHI-110085 have severed off all their relations with their SON AJAY GOEL, aged 34 years & DAUGHTER IN LAW NEHA GOEL W/O AJAY GOEL aged 34 years R/O B-606/81, SECTOR-7, ROHINI DELHI-110085. My client have debarred him from all their movable/immoveable properties. Anybody dealing with him or with him regarding any matter shall have his/her their own responsibility.

RAJ KUMAR Advocate ENROLMENT NO-D-26112017, RL-382,BLOCK PITAMPURA DELHI-110034

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that original Agreement to sale, dated 10.09.2024 in respect to Plot-A-123, Talva Estates, Sector 99A, Gurgaon, Haryana have been lost. In this regard, a Lost Article/Document Report has been lodged with Delhi Police, Rajinder Nagar, vide LR No. 548791/2026 dated 18.08.2026. If anybody finding the document may contact the undersigned.

MANISHA CHAUDHARY, ADVOCATE JUS LEGALIZ, 210, VARDHMAN STAR CITY MALL (NEAR RAMPHAL CHOWK),SECT-7,DWARKA NEW DELHI-75. 011-45063633, 9899097723

COURT NOTICE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT (Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)

In The Court Of Sh. Ankur Jain-I.I. Id. District Judge-02, District: Shahdara, Karkardooma Court, Delhi Registration No. PC/L5/2026

SANJAY VS STATE & ORS.

To, STATE GUNCT OF DELHI (R1) NEETU R/O LT. SH. KRISHAN LAL & LT. SMT. KAMLESH R/O H.NO.103, BUILDING NO. S 51 C-BLOCK, SUNDAY MARKET ROAD NEAR WATER TANK, SHAALIMAR GARDEN EXT-2 U.P.-201005, (R2) SONYA @ RESIMA D/O LT. SH. KRISHAN LAL & LT. SMT. KAMLESH R/O D-57A, SHIVAJI ENCLAVE, TAGORE GARDEN EXTENSION, NEW DELHI-110027. (R3)

The Respondents Above Named Citizens for publication of petition U/s 276 R/w section 234 of The Indian Succession Act for grant of Probate/Letter of administration in respect of will dated 12.09.2013 of late Smt. Kamlesh W/o Lt. Sh. Krishan Lal. WHERE AS you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on 03.09.2026 the day fixed for the case, it will be heard and determine ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the court, this 18.05.2026.

Seal Sd/- Judge

NOTICE UNDER SECTION 11 OF ACT NO. VIII OF 1890 OF GUARDIAN & WARD'S ACT

IN THE COURT OF MS. ANJU BAJAJ CHANDNA, PRINCIPAL DISTRICT & SESSIONS JUDGE (HQ), DELHI ROOM NO. 301, 3RD FLOOR, TFS HAZARI COURTS, DELHI-110054

GP-142026 (CNR No. DLCTO-0133776-2026)

Smt. Aditya Vanshi Bahadur W/o Mr. Aditya Vanshi Bahadur R/o Flat no. LCG 301A, Labrumam Complex, Sushant Lok 1, Gurgaon-122009, Haryana. ...Petitioner

VERSUS STATE (Govt. of NCT of Delhi) & Ors. ...Respondents

The petitioner above named having applied for permission to sell the share of her minor son namely Master Aditi Shashi Bahadur (born on 06.03.2022) S/o Sh. Aditya Vanshi Bahadur in immovable property bearing no. 8/1, Janna Road, Civil Lines, Delhi-110054. The 26th September 2026 has been fixed for hearing of the application and notice is hereby given to general public that if any other relatives/friends, kinship or well wisher of the aforesaid or desire be appointed, declare as guardian of the person and property of the said minor or desire to oppose the application of the petitioner aforesaid, he/she should enter appearance in persons in this court on the aforesaid date and be prepared to adduce in support of his/her any such appointment or declaration in support of his/her opposition to the application other the petitioner aforesaid.

GIVEN under my hand and the seal of the Court on this 14th day of August 2026.

Seal Sd/- PRINCIPAL DISTRICT & SESSION JUDGE (HQ)

IN THE COURT OF SH. SUNIL KUMAR SHARMA, I.D. DISTRICT JUDGE-04, WEST, TFS HAZARI COURTS, DELHI

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT Order 5, rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure

CIVIL DJ NO. 762/2024 RAM SINGH VS SOKARAN ...DEFENDANT N.D.O.HL 16-09-2026

To SMT. RAJGO, WO SH. HOSHYAR SINGH, DO SH. KARAN SINGH R/O VILLAGE & P.O. BANNERK, NARELA, DELHI SMT. SHEELA, WO SH. ANOOP SINGH, DO SH. KARAN SINGH R/O VILLAGE MAHPALPUR, DELHI SMT. CHHOTTO, WO SH. RAM SINGH, DO SH. KARAN SINGH DECEASED THROUGH LRS SH. BIJENDER SINGH, S/O SH. RAM SINGH GRETA RANI, DO SH. RAM SINGH SH. SUNI, DO SH. RAM SINGH ALL THREE R/O VILLAGE & P.O. BANNERK, NARELA, DELHI SH. CHANDNER BHAN, S/O SH. CHHOTTO RAM SHIKSHA, WO SH. SURAJ BHAN BOTH R/O VILLAGE & P.O. GREYRA, DELHI-110085

WHERE AS you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the 16-09-2026 the day fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the court, this 14-08-2026.

Seal Sd/- Judge

NOTICE UNDER SECTION 11 OF ACT NO. VIII OF 1890 OF GUARDIAN & WARD'S ACT

IN THE COURT OF MS. ANJU BAJAJ CHANDNA, PRINCIPAL DISTRICT & SESSIONS JUDGE (HQ), DELHI ROOM NO. 301, 3RD FLOOR, TFS HAZARI COURTS, DELHI-110054

GP-142026 (CNR No. DLCTO-0133776-2026)

Smt. Ragini Bahadur W/o Bharat Vanshi Bahadur R/o 1609, Tower 2, Casa Grande, Seemapal Bagh Marg, Lower Plover (W) Mumbai-400013. ...Petitioner

VERSUS STATE (Govt. of NCT of Delhi) & Ors. ...Respondents

The petitioner above named having applied for permission to sell the respective shares of her minor children namely Ms. Noor Bahadur (born on 12.08.2014) and Ms. Sauri Bahadur (born on 09.04.2019) D/o Sh. Bharat Vanshi Bahadur in their respective immovable property bearing No. 134/114 sq. meters (approx. 134.114 sq. yards) forming part of estate/property no. 8/1, Janna Road, Civil Lines, Delhi-110054.

The 26th September 2026 has been fixed for hearing of the application and notice is hereby given to general public that if any other relatives/friends, kinship or well wisher of the aforesaid or desire be appointed, declare as guardian of the person and property of the said minor or desire to oppose the application of the petitioner aforesaid, he/she should enter appearance in persons in this court on the aforesaid date and be prepared to adduce in that day and document in support of his/her which he/she may desire to adduce in support of his/her claim to such appointment or declaration of in support of his/her opposition to the application of the petitioner aforesaid.

GIVEN under my hand and seal of the Court on this 14th day of August 2026.

Seal Sd/- PRINCIPAL DISTRICT & SESSION JUDGE (HQ)

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all concerned that my clients, Sh. Deepak Kumar, S/o Sh. Krishan Lal, and Smt. Kamla, W/o Sh. Deepak Kumar, residents of WZ-30, New Sahib Pura, Triak Nagar, New Delhi-110018, have disowned and debarred their son, Ashish Kumar and their daughter-in-law Monika Tanjela from all their movable and immovable properties. My clients have also severed all relations with the aforesaid persons due to their misconduct. Accordingly, my clients shall not be responsible or liable in any manner whatsoever for any act or dealing undertaken by the aforesaid persons. Any person dealing with them shall do so entirely at his/her own risk and responsibility, and my clients shall not be held responsible for the same.

Sd/- PRAVEEN RASTOGI (Advocate) ENRL No.D-244/06

I,Pratiksha D/o Shiv Vishal Yadav, R/o Plot No.11, and 11-A, KH.No. 79/4, G-1, 2nd Floor, LHS, G-1/11 and 11-A, Universal School, Mahavir Enclave, Palam Village, South West Delhi, Delhi-110045 have changed my name to Pratiksha Yadav for all purposes.

0040873197-1

I, L Venkatamma Mother of, BHANU CHANDER LANKA presently residing in Door No-22-7-31,Ambatisatram, Vizianagaram,Andhra-Pradesh-535002 have changed my name from L Venkatamma to LENKA VENKATA LAXMI,vide-Affidavit,Date:19-8-2026.

0040873271-14

I,Ramesh Chander Khyatri/Ramesh Chandra Khatri,S/O Din Dayal Khatri,R/O-B-606,6th,floor-Naveen apartment Block-B Plot no -13 Sec-5,Dwarka-New Delhi-110045,have changed my name to RAMESH CHANDER KHATRI Permanently

0040873271-1

Ihitherto known as Mangalpalli Sarala Alias K Sarala W/o Kanakadandila Shankara Shastri residing at Plot No 42/A, Shankara nilayam, 5bh Colony, Mohan Nagar, Kothapet, Saroornagar, Distt- Rangareddi, Telangana-500035 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Sarala Kanakadandila.

0071055450-1

I,Sudhir Gupta S/o Rajeshwar Dayal R/O 204/2, Sector-16B, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201012 have changed my name to Sudhir Kumar Gupta.

0040873271-4

I,Amit Kumar Goel,S/O Lajpat Rai R/O H.No-3355,PO- Nissing,Karnal (Haryana)-132024,have changed my name to Amit Kumar for All Purposes.

0040873277-8

I, Jahid S/o Rafakat Ali R/o Near Nutani Masjid, Nai Abadi, Dadri, G.B.Nagar, have changed my name to Zahid.

0040873271-3

I,ANNU DEVI SOLANKI W/O SH. SHIV RAJ SOLANKI R/O H.NO.16/1530-E,BAPANAGAR ,ARYA SAMAJ ROAD, KAROL BAGH, NEW DELHI-110005. ANNU AND ANNU DEVI SOLANKI BOTH ARE SAME PERSON.

0040873275-1

I,RIPAN KUMAR,S/O TARA CHAND,R/O D-24 TEACHER COLONY PRATAP VIHAR VIJAY NAGAR GHAZIABAD, U.P.201009 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RIPAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040873277-3

I,hitherto known as Mohd Sarwar Khan S/o Mohd Rustam Khan residing at 9-4-50/37/C, Hakeempet, Tolichowki, VTC-Golconda, Distt- Hyderabad, Telangana -500008 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Mohammed Riyaz Khan.

0071055431-1

I,Mohammad Luqman S/o-Mohd Sayeed R/o-10005, Gali Nal Wali Nawab Ganj, Azad Market, Delhi-06, declares that my name is changed as MOHD LUQMAN for all purpose.

0040873249-1

I,Jyoti Panwar,D/o Ishwar Chand Sharma,R/o-D-904,KAVISHA CELEBRATION AROHI CLUB ROAD, SOUTH-BHOPAL,AHMEDABAD RURAL,GUJARAT-380058 change my name Jyoti Panwar to Jyoti Sharma

0040873271-13

I, Usha Devi Wife of Shri Pawan Singh Present Address: PN-2, PNB Nivas, PC Hostel Road, Chetpet, Chennai-600031, Permanent Address: H.No.-76, Arya Nagar, Assandh Road, VTC: Panipat, PO- Panipat, Distt.- Panipat, Haryana-132103 hereby declare that I have changed my name from Usha to Usha Devi, vide Affidavit No. IN-DL65437905231234Y dated 30.07.2026 before the Notary Public at Delhi. I shall henceforth be known as “Usha Devi” for all legal, official and other purposes.

0040873194-1

I,MOHD AKIF,S/O-MOHD ARIF,R/O A-56/4 GALI NO.8,SHASTRI PARK, BHAIJANPURA DELHI-110053,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD AKIF MANSOORI,FOR ALL PURPOSE

0040873276-7

I, SALOCHANA C/o Kartik Bisht R/o 363, Near BSES Office, Rama Krishna Puram, VTC R.K. Puram Sector-9, Post Office R.K. Puram Sector-5, Delhi-110021,declare that names of mine,my wife and my minor son have been wrongly written as PRAVEEN KUMAR BAGRI,MANISHA BAGRI and ARJUN KUMAR BAGRI in my minor son's namely ARJUN KUMAR,aged-14 years,in his School Records.The actual names of mine,my wife and my minor son are PRAVEEN KUMAR, MANISHA and ARJUN KUMAR,respectively,which may be amended accordingly.

0040873276-4

I, Madhu Devi D/o Kanhaiya Lal residing at K-1/20 Mohan Garden, have changed my name to Sonia Kaushik vide affidavit dated 17/08/26 at Delhi.

0050295686-1

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Afsar S/o Ishrat Ali R/o H. No. TA-220, Gali No.1, Tughalkabad Extension, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No.142/2021 U/S 354/451/324/34 IPC, PS Govindpuri, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Afsar S/o Ishrat Ali** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Afsar S/o Ishrat Ali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Afsar S/o Ishrat Ali** of **FIR No.142/2021 U/S 354/451/324/34 IPC, PS Govindpuri, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **21.09.2026 at 10:00 am.**

By Order,
Ms. Kanika Handa
Judicial Magistrate First Class (Mahila Court)-02
Room No. 507
DP/11494/SE/2026(Court Matter) Saket Courts Complex, New Delhi

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED

(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking & An ISO 27001-2022 Certified Company)

TENDER NOTICE

The APTRANSCO invites on-line bids for Spec.No.PMM23-e-68/2026 for"supply of 95Nos 50MVA 132/33KV PTRs in 2 Lots (i.e., Lot-1: 50 Nos., and Lot -2: 45Nos.) for utilization in Augmentation/N-1 works at various substations of APTRANSCO. Date and time of availability of tender **20.08.2026 by 17:00 Hrs.** Further details can be seen in website(s): **www.apecprocurement.gov.in**. For further details contact No. **9491030732.**

Sd/-
R.D. No. GMCC/APTRANSCO/121/26-27 **Chief Engineer/Transmission**

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD ELECT DIV. BARAN

क्रमांक : 543 दिनांक : 12-08-2026

Notice Inviting Bid No 15/2026-27

Bid for "01 No Electrical work" NIT No. 15/2026-27 are invited from interested bidders up to 6.00 PM on 09.09.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs 283.64 Lac

Sr. no. UBN No.
1 PWD2627WSOB0958

Sd/-
Executive Engineer PWD Elect Div Baran

DIPR/C/14966/2026

Government of Jharkhand
Department of Higher and Technical Education
(Jharkhand Council on Science, Technology and Innovation)
Yojna Bhawan, Nepal House Campus,
Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand - 834002
Email- jharkhandcouncilsonst@gmail.com

Ref. No: Vi. Pra./ Kau.- 04/2015-235 / Ranchi, Date:19/08/2026

Corrigendum

Subject: Corrigendum to the Advertisement for Engagement of Chief Mentor and Junior Mentor at Innovation Hub, Regional Science Centre, Ranchi on Contractual Basis

With reference to the Advertisement Ref. No-221 dated 07/08/2026 for engagement of **01 (One) Chief Mentor and 01 (One) Junior Mentor** at Innovation Hub, Regional Science Centre, Ranchi on contractual basis, the dates mentioned under **Section 8 – Important Dates** of the said Advertisement are hereby revised as follows:

SL No	Particulars	Revised Date
1	Application Start Date	10/08/2026
2	Last Date for Submission of Applications	25/08/2026
3	Publication of Shortlisted Candidates on the JCSIT Website	27/08/2026
4	Personal Interview	31/08/2026
5	Publication of Final Result	To be announced later

All other terms and conditions of the original advertisement shall remain unchanged. Candidates are advised to regularly visit the official website of JCSIT for further updates regarding the engagement process.
PR No. 387147

Sd/-
(Dr. Raj Shekhar Prasad)
Executive Director JCSIT

PR 387941 Higher Education,Technical
Education and Skill Development Department(26-27).D

MAHATMA PHULE KRISHI VIDYAPEETH, RAHURI-413 722, DIST-AHILYANAGAR

Office of the University Engineer

Phone (02426) 243 272, 243235 (Office), 243601 (fax)

Web: www.mpkv.mah.nic.in, e-mail-uniengineermpkv@gmail.com

No. MPKV/WRK/TC/3164/2026 Dated: 19/08/2026

e-Tender Notice

The University Engineer invites online e-tenders in B-1 form from the registered Electrical contractors in appropriate class registered in state PWD/Central PWD/Military Engineering services and Railway Department for the following works at **Govt. College of Agriculture, Nandurbar.**

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated cost (Rs.)
1	Providing Internal and External electrical installation for the Amenity building (G) Library Building (G+1), Gymnasium Hall at Govt. College of Agriculture, Nandurbar under MPKV Rahuri.	87,63,973.00

For Detail Tender Notice please see website Portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in>,
Organization- Department of Agricultural,
Department- Mahatma Phule Krishi Vidyapeeth, Rahuri.
Division- University Engineer

Sd/-
University Engineer MPKV, Rahuri.

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR

OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION GANDHI NAGAR JAMMU

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

e-NIT No. DGN/61 of 2026-27 Dated 18-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No.	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised cost (Rs. In lakh.)	Cost of Tender document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1.	Restoration of road damaged by JPDCI for laying of 33 KV at various location in Gandhi Nagar area (Work Code : PDDSS2627100410) Under Capex Budget 2026-27	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	87.91	1500	175820 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	04 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 02-09-2026	“A” Class

Position of AAA :- **Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu vide order No. 92 of 2026 dated 03-08-2026 amounting to Rs. 90.54 Lacs.**

Position of TS :- **Sanctioned by Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu vide order No. 77 of August 2026 dated 17-08-2026 amounting to Rs. 87.91 Lacs.**

Project Authority :- **Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu.**

Major Head of Account :- **Under Capex Budget 2026-27.**

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jtenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	18-08-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 18-08-2026 to 01-09-2026, 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	21-08-2026 at 1300 Hrs, in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	18-08-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	01-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	02-09-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Special Condition :-

(i) Security deposit shall be deposited by the contractor within 10 days of issuance of LOI, failing which the concerned tender issuing authority shall forfeit the EMD and recommended contractor for blacklisting and issue a fresh tender forthwith.

(ii) The contractor shall initiate the work within 10 days of entering into the agreement, failing which the concerned Executive Engineer shall terminate the contract and issue a fresh tender after imposing penalties viz. forfeit security/LD as per T&C of the BID document and recommended contractor for blacklisting.

(iii) The work shall be completed by the concerned contractor as per the timeline stipulated in BID document/agreement, failing which action shall be initiated against contractor by forfeiting EMD and shall be recommended for blacklisting.

Sd/-
(Er. Karanjeet Singh)
Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar

DIP/J-8362/26 – DATE 19 AUG 2026

MITL

Maharashtra Industrial Township Limited (MITL)
(A Government Undertaking)

Regd. Off.- 'Udyog Sarthi, MIDC Office, Marol Industrial Area, Andheri (East), Mumbai - 400 093, Maharashtra, INDIA. Tel No :- +91(022 26879956), 222.aunic.city, Mail Id: dgmtecpma@auric.city, CIN : U74999MH2014SGC0280132

Maharashtra Industrial Township Ltd. (MITL) is currently developing AURIC, an Industrial Township spread over approximately 40 sq. km. MITL invites RFQ cum RFP bids for the "Design, Construction, Testing, Commissioning and Operation & Maintenance of 60m wide Road, along with all utilities and allied Infrastructure Works at AURIC – Bidkin Industrial Area (BIA), Sector B & C, under Delhi Mumbai Industrial Corridor, on EPC Basis – Package A."

(Tender No.: MITL/SBIA/2026-27/06)

The tender details are available at <https://aitl.eproc.in>, www.auric.city. Interested applicants are requested to submit their RFQ cum RFP responses online by 1500 hrs on or before 14th September 2026. A non-refundable processing fees of INR 1,18,000/- shall be paid along with the submission through MITL's online e-procurement portal.

Sd/-
Managing Director, MITL

Mumbai, Date: 20th August 2026

UJVN Limited

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)

H.O.: "UJ.JWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763506, 2763808; Fax 0135-2763507
CIN No. U40101UR20071SGC025866

RO No. 708 NOTICE INVITING TENDER Dated : 19/08/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer PCM Dhalipur, Dehradun invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of the tender is given below:
Tender No.- 23/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2026-27 & 24/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2026-27
Name of work:- 1. Cleaning and repair work of the catchment drain along Power Channel from Asan to Y-Point..
2. M&R of Asan Barrage and other appurtenant structures at Dhalipur, Dehradun.
Estimated value of Tender: Rs. 8,39,703.00 and Rs. 22,20,051.00 respectively (GST Extra)
Date & Time of availability of bid document on website : 19.08.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
Last Date & Time for submission of tender : 10.09.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs
For fuller and further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "<https://ujvn.uk.gov.in>"

Executive Engineer PCM-Dhalipur, Dehradun

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PANJAB UNIVERSITY, CHANDIGARH

MDS ADMISSION NOTICE (2026-27)

Dr. Harvansh Singh Judge Institute of Dental Sciences & Hospital

Applications are invited for admission to First year MDS course (2026-27) in the following specialities:

✦ Conservative Dentistry and Endodontics	03 seats
✦ Oral & Maxillofacial Pathology and Oral Microbiology	03 seats
✦ Oral & Maxillofacial Surgery	02 seats
✦ Orthodontics & Dentofacial Orthopedics	03 seats
✦ Periodontology	03 seats
✦ Prosthodontics and Crown & Bridge	03 seats

Prospectus & steps to apply online are available at website <https://mdsadmission.puchd.ac.in>.
Last date of online Registration is: 25.08.2026.

Sd/-
Principal-cum-Professor

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. JHS/Commercial/e-Auction/2026 Date: 17.08.2026

E-Auction Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Divisional Railway Manager, (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Advertisement	Catalogue No.:- JHS-FREIGHT-09
Asset Details:	
1. Open E auction to provide refreshment facility for staff and labours at Bhimsen Goods shed (BZM), Maharaja Chhatrasal Station Chhatrapur Goods shed (MCSC) Sank Goods shed (PSK) & Banda Goods shed (BND) for a period of 05 years of Jhansi Division in North Central Railway.	
2. Contract for installation, operation & maintenance of electronic weighbridge at Niwari goods shed (NEW), Rayaru goods shed (RRU), of Jhansi division in North Central Railway.	
Notice Start: 04.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.	Auction End: 04.09.2026 at 12:20 hrs.
Alert: Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 188926(K)	
North central railways	www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in
@CPNCR	

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)

Victoria Cross Vijeyta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001
Corporate Identity No. U40109UA2001SGC0258672358, Telephone-(0135)-2763672-76, www.uktenders.gov.in

CORRIGENDUM TO E-TENDER NOTICE

Following e-tenders invited previously by this office is hereby extended due to unavoidable reason as under: -

Sr. No.	Tender Specification No.	Name of Item/Work	Last Date of Submission of tender in online & offline mode	Date of opening of Part-I of tender in online & Off line mode
1.	CCP-II/4/ 2026-2027	Design, fabrication, supply, erection, testing and commissioning of 33kV D/C overhead line using lattice towers from Sonprayag to Sri Kedarnath Ji (15 Km.)	01-09-2026 upto 17:00 hrs.	02-09-2026 at 15:30hrs.
2.	CCP-II/9/ 2026-2027	33/4KV, 1000 KVA, BIS Mark EEL-2 (New) Copper Wound Distribution Transformer	01-09-2026 upto 17:00 hrs.	02-09-2026 at 15:45hrs.

Other terms and conditions will remain same as per original tender notice. For further details, please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in

Superintending Engineer Corporate (Contract & Procurement-II)

No.: 635/EE(CM)/UPCL/A-2 Dated : 18.08.2026

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION. Use LED Bulb, Save Electricity. (Toll Free No. 1912) Pay Electricity Bill Online 24x7 from www.upcl.org. (For information on Electricity theft, informer may report to Toll Free No. 1800 180 4185/Fax No. 0135-2760911)

EX-SERVICEMEN CONTRIBUTORY HEALTH SCHEME

STATION HQ (ECHS CELL) HEMPUR

EMPLOYMENT NOTICE

Mob-9756428490 Email esmccllhempur@gmail.com

1. ECHS INVITES APPLICATIONS TO ENGAGE FOLLOWING MEDICAL, PARA MEDICAL STAFF ON CONTRACTUAL BASIS IN ECHS POLYCLINIC HEMPUR FOR A PERIOD OF ONE YEAR RENEWABLE FOR ADDITIONAL PERIOD OF ONE YEAR /TILL ATTAINING THE MAXIMUM AGE SUBJECT TO PERFORMANCE OF CANDIDATES/OTHER CONDITIONS ACCORDING TO THE CRITERIA AS MENTIONED AGAINST EACH POST :-

Appointment	Minimum Qualification	No of Vac	Fixed Remuneration	Reservation for ESM
Medical Officer	MBBS, Work experience Minimum 03 years after internship. Preferable additional qualification in medicine/surgery.	01	95000/-	60%
Pharmacist	B Pharmacy from a recognized institute or (i) 10 + 2 with science stream (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) from a recognized Board And (ii) Approved Diploma in Pharmacy from an Institute recognized by the Pharmacy Council of India and registered as Pharmacist under the Pharmacy Act 1948. Work experience Minimum 03 years.	01	36500/-	70%

2. For Terms & Conditions, Application Form & Remuneration. Kindly see our website www.echs.gov.in For additional details, please contact Station HQ(ECHS Cell) Hampur at tele No 9756428490 & E mail ID esmccllhempur@gmail.com. Also approach concerned ECHS Polyclinic for details. Preference will be given to the Ex-servicemen.

3. Last date of receipt of application as per format given at our website. Application as per requisite format alongwith self attested photocopies of testimonials in support of education qualifications, work experiences and copy of Adhar & PAN card and Medical fitness certificate will be submitted to OIC, Station HQ (ECHS Cell) Hampur by 10 Sep 2026 in duplicate. Any application received after 1700 hours on 10 Sep 2026 will not be accepted.

4. Interview date, Timing & Venue. Candidate must reach Station HQ Hampur at 1000h on 15 Sep 2026 for interview to be held between 1030 h to 1345h. Candidates must bring all the original certificate/mark sheets/degree of 10th, 10 + 2, Graduation post graduation/diploma/course, work experience and disc book, PPQ, service records and 02 PP size colour photographs at the time of interview. NO TA/DA is admissible. Only candidates meeting the Qualitative Requirements may apply.

5. "On job Training (OJT). Medical Officers will carry out 10 days On Job Training (OJT) and obtain a certificate from OIC Polyclinic before signing the contract. The duration of OJT will remain unpaid and as a mandatory requirement before assuming charge as a contractual employee"6. With regard to remuneratin, ESM can exercise option as per GOI MoD letter No 22D(19)/2017-DJ(WE/Res-1)(i) dt 24 Jul 2025, 22D(19)/2017-DJ(WE/Res)(ii) dt 24 Jul 2025 and 18 Sep 2025.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Mohd. Rabban Alam S/o Abdul Subhan, R/o: H.No. H-550 JJ Colony Shakurpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 51/2023, U/S:188 IPC, PS: Subhash Place, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Rabban Alam** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Rabban Alam** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Rabban Alam** of **FIR No. 51/2023, U/S:188 IPC, PS: Subhash Place, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026.**

By Order
Upasana Satija
Chief Judicial Magistrate
North West Court No. 108 First Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11396/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Bajinath Singh S/o Jirpdhan Singh R/o Jhuggi Y-Point Near Holy Family Hospital, NFC, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 151/2025, U/S 12/9/55 G. Act, PS New Friends Colony, South-East Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bajinath Singh** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Bajinath Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Bajinath Singh** the said accused of **FIR No. 151/2025, U/S 12/9/55 G. Act, PS New Friends Colony, South-East Distt., New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
South-East Distt., Court No.-515,
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/11643/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Surender Verma, S/o: Pardeshi, R/o: Najad Naiyon Ki Chaupal, Jhimmar Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 727/20, U/s: 324 IPC, PS: Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Surender Verma**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Surender Verma**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Surender Verma, of FIR No. 727/20, U/s: 324 IPC, PS: Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.09.2026.**

By Order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North)
Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11590/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. 21/2026-2027 dated 19.06.2026 S. No. 03 Tender No. 77269045RGC Opening date 21.07.2026.

In reference to above, tender opening date already extended from 21.07.2026 to 21.08.2026, now this is second corrigendum, tender opening date has been extended from 21.08.2026 to 21.09.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

Note: This is the second Corrigendum in above referred tender.

Date: 18.08.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2881/26

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PWD CIRCLE SIKAR

No.: 1190 Date: 12-08-2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING BID

Bids for Construction and Upgradation of Various Roads in District Sikar is invited from interested bidders from dated 14.08.2026 at 09:30 AM upto dated 24.08.2026 at 06:00 PM, other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state; and pwr.rajasthan.gov.in departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 1193.75 lacs

NIB No. PWD2627A2626.

UBN No. PWD2627WSOB10072, PWD2627WLOB10073, PWD2627WLOB10074

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer PWD Circle Sikar

DIPR/C/14907/2026

The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking) Sankaramangalam, Kollam-691 583
Phone: 0476-2651215 to 2651217, e-mail: md@kmmil.com, URL: www.kmmil.com

TENDER NOTICE

For more details please visit E-Tendering Portal, <https://tenders.kerala.gov.in> or www.kmmil.com

Sl No.	Tender ID	Items
1	2026_KMML_865649_1	Rubber lining works of slurry storage tank (F 401 D) in U 300
2	2026_KMML_865921_1	Supply, Erection and commissioning of Vertical Steam Turbine
3	2026_KMML_865713_1	Construction of RCC Deck slab in Oxide bin at 14.076m LVL
4	2026_KMML_865829_1	Supply of Uniform cloths-Shirting & Sulting for KMML DCW Employees
5	2026_KMML_865988_1	Supply of SS various grade pipes

Chavara 19.08.2026 Sd/- Managing Director for The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture, Zone-1, BCCC, Bengaluru - 560 002.

No.:SADH-1/HORT/TENDER/137/2026-27 Date:19.08.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT)

(Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System)

The Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture, Zone-1, Horticulture Division, BCCC invites tenders from eligible and experienced contractors/firms/agencies for the work detailed in the table below.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1.	Comprehensive Development of Parks in Shanthi Nagar Assembly Constituency. Estimated cost of work : Rs. 2,00,00,000/- EMD : Rs. 3,00,000/-

1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from **19.08.2026 onwards.**
2) Pre-bid meeting : **24.08.2026 at 12.30 p.m.** 3) Last Date for receipt of tender documents: **03.09.2026 upto 5.00 p.m.**
4) Opening of technical bids: **04.09.2026 at 11:30 p.m.**
5) Opening of financial bids: **Will be intimated through KPP Portal to technically qualified bidders.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture, Zone-1, Horticulture Division

OFFICE OF CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER, CONSTRUCTION WING, UTTARAKHAND PEYJAL SANSADHAN VIKAS EVAM NIRMAN NIGAM

3rd Floor (vishweshwariya Bhawan) (Opposite ONGC Hospital), Kamla Nagar Dehradun-248001
email: cgmnirmanwing@yahoo.com, gmnirmanwing@gmail.com

पत्रांक : 3338/निविदा (गर्गवाल) चम्बा/770 दिनांक 19.08.2026

PRESS NOTE

Government of Uttarakhand "e" procurement Notice

S. NO.	Name of works	Estimated Cost	Period of Completion
Bid Identification no: 3337/ Nivida(Gargwal) Chamba / 69 Date:19-08-2026			
1	CONSTRUCTION OF TYPE II RESIDENTIAL BUILDING FOR POLICE STATION AT BARKOT DISTT Uttarakashi, UTTARAKHAND	₹563.23 Lacs (Excluding G.S.T.)	12 Months
2	Name and Address of Officer inviting the Bid:-	Office Chief General Manager, Construction Wing, Uttarakhand Peyjal Nigam, Third Floor (Oppsite ONGC Hospital), Kamla Nagar, Dehradun	
3	Date and Time of Availability of bid documents in the portal :-	21/08/2026-17.00 Hrs.	
4	Pre Bid Meeting Date	27/08/2026-12.00 Hrs.	
5	Last Date/Time for receipt of bids in the portal :-	11/09/2026-17.00 Hrs.	

Details of subsequent addendum/corrigendum /cancellation etc. may be obtained from the website.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal "<https://www.uktenders.gov.in>"
General Manager (Gargwal)

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग, आगरा परिमण्डल-आगरा।

पता- शास्त्री पुरम, आगरा-282002

ई-निविदा सूचना

पत्रांक - 843 मधुरा कैम्प/ ग्रा0अ0वि0 / निविदा / लेखा /2026-27 दिनांक : 04.08.2026

महामोम राज्यपाल महोदय, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग, आगरा परिमण्डल-आगरा द्वारा ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग उ0अ0 में A.B.C मार्ग श्रेणी में कार्य की लागत के सीमा के अनुसूच पंजीकृत निविदादाताओं से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से % प्रतिशत दर के आधार पर जनपद मधुरा के निम्नलिखित कार्यो की निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदादाता किसी एक अथवा समस्त कार्यो हेतु निविदा डाल सकता है। कार्य से सम्बन्धि विवरण निम्नवत है:-

क्र0 सं0	जिला	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित कार्य की लागत (लाख में)	बोरोर बनराशि (लाख में)	बिड प्रपत्र की कुल बनराशि जी0एस0टी0 सहित	कार्य सम्पत्ति का समय (वर्षांकित सहित)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	मधुरा	ग्राम सकतपुर से खलपुर अलीगढ सीमा की ओर इन्टरलॉकिंग निर्माण कार्य।	92.80	1.86	2354.00	09 माह वर्षा ऋतु सहित
2	मधुरा	मोट ब्रांच नहर से ब्योही मार्ग की ओर इमली का निर्माण कार्य।	55.52	1.12	2354.00	06 माह वर्षा ऋतु सहित
3	मधुरा	ग्राम दोलतपुर विद्युत लाइन गोकर्ण में जोरमल के घर से होली चौक तक लड़क निर्माण कार्य।	62.08	1.25	2354.00	06 माह वर्षा ऋतु सहित

क्र0सं0 विवरण दिनांक समय

1. ई-टेंडर वेबसाइट पर बिड कायुटेन्ट उपलब्ध करने की तिथि 24.08.2026 10.00 प्रातः स

2. ई-निविदा का माध्यम से बिड कायुटेन्ट अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि व समय 04.09.2026 12.00 दोपहर तक

3. बिड कायुटेन्ट कोलने की तिथि व समय 04.09.2026 02.30 अपराह्न

4. निविदा अन्तिमते में विषय-09 से अर्पित ऑन लाइन कायुन्ट प्रकाशित बिड कायुटेन्ट को संशोधित करने अथवा परिशुद्धित अधिकांश करने क निषेध है। बिडदा कायुन्ट किसी भी समयावध पर में प्रकाशित नहीं किया जायेगा। डाटा निविदादाता निम्नलिखित <http://tender.upgpn.nic.in> वेबसाइट

Duleep Trophy final relocated to Chennai



MA Chidambaram Stadium will host the summit clash. CREIMAS

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 19

THE DULEEP Trophy 2026-27 final has been moved from the Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Bengaluru to the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium in Chennai, allowing spectators to attend the summit clash. The final will take place from September 6-10, with the venue change aimed at giving fans an opportunity to watch the domestic first-class tournament's title clash live at the stadium.

"The Duleep Trophy is an important first-class tournament in our calendar and carries a rich legacy. The quality of cricket is always high, and we want fans to have the opportunity to watch the final live at the stadium," BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia said in a statement.

The decision to move the final was primarily driven by restrictions on crowd attendance at the CoE. Saikia said that shifting the match to Chennai would allow supporters to be part of the occasion while also providing a more suitable setting for the tournament's last fixture.

"There are certain restrictions regarding crowd attendance at the CoE, and we felt it was appropriate to move the final to a venue where fans can attend and be part of the occasion," he added.

The board secretary had said earlier this month that restrictions imposed when the land for the CoE was procured meant spectators could not be allowed at the facility. "There are some restrictions while this land was adopted here... that we cannot have a crowd in this campus. So, that is a government restriction. We cannot violate that," he had told select media in Bengaluru.

The remainder of the tournament will go ahead as scheduled at the CoE, beginning on August 23. East Zone will face Northeast Zone in one quarter-final, while North Zone will take on West Zone in the other.

Three of the four quarter-finalists feature high-profile players, including Ishan Kishan, Mohammed Shami, Arshdeep Singh, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and Ruturaj Gaikwad.

South Zone and Central Zone are already in the semi-finals, which will also be played at the CoE from August 30.

The BCCI has also increased the tournament's broadcast coverage this season. All Duleep Trophy matches will be streamed live, while television coverage will be available for one quarter-final, one semi-final and the final.

Central Zone are the reigning Duleep Trophy champions.

Manav's 10-wicket haul powers Gill & Co to 165-run win, securing a 1-0 lead

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 19

AS THE top-edge from Dhananjaya de Silva's bat lobbed into the hands of Manav Suthar at fine leg, one could hear the relief as Ravindra Jadeja cleared his throat. Since being given a lifeline by the spinner via a no-ball late on Day 4, he was waging an improbable battle, frustrating India in the company of Sonal Dinusha before he made the only mistake of his innings, off the 151st ball he faced. Jadeja provided the desperate breakthrough India sought; in the next 22.2 overs they wrapped up a 165-run win before the dark clouds hovering over Galle opened up for one final time.

The downpour was five minutes too late for Sri Lanka, who are now facing a third successive home series defeat to India if they fail to win the next Test at Colombo beginning Sunday.

Having started the day at 84/4, the hosts had an enormous task ahead of them to prevent India from going 1-0 up in the series. The pitch didn't have any hidden demons, and to make any inroads, the bowlers had to be patient and be consistent in their line and lengths. And the right-left pair of De Silva and Dinusha was in no mood to make the win any easier for India. For 202 deliveries, during which time they stitched a 95-run stand for the fifth wicket, they ensured India had to use every ounce of energy to separate them. You could hear Suthar, who ended up with six wickets and, ended up with a match haul of 10/131, almost grunting each time he rolled his arm. Ditto with Kuldeep Yadav. It was one such surface, where the spinners had to put everything in to get the rewards. They would keep mass-urs busy for the next couple of days as there is only a three-day turnaround before the second Test at Sinhalese Sports Club.

When Jadeja had overstepped late on last evening after dismissing De Silva with a peach, little did India know they had to work so hard for this win. When it comes to batting in the second innings, the Sri Lanka captain is the only subcontinent batsman to have an average over 50. So when it comes to applying himself on a deteriorating pitch, Sri Lanka could bank on De Silva. Of course, the win was far out of their sight.



Prasidh Krishna celebrates taking the wicket of Sri Lanka's Niroshan Dickwella on Day Five of the first Test match in Galle. CREIMAS

SRI LANKA vs INDIA, GALLE TOSS: India won, chose to bat	
India 1st innings	462
Sri Lanka 1st innings	284
India 2nd innings	193
SRI LANKA (O/N 84/4)	
D'jaya de Silva c Suthar b Jadeja	59 (151b, 7x4)
Sonal Dinusha c Jurel b Suthar	84 (128b, 8x4, 1x6)
Niroshan Dickwella c Pant b Krishna	10 (17b, 1x4)
Keshara Nuwantha c Gill b Jadeja	20 (69b, 3x4)
Prabath Jayasuriya b Suthar	0 (1b)
Lahiru Kumara c Pant b Suthar	0 (4b)
Asitha Fernando not out	0 (1b)
Extras (b 5, lb 1, nb 3)	
TOTAL (77.4 Overs)	
FOW: 1-13 (Nishan Madushka Fernando, 6.6 ov), 2-14 (Pasindu Sooriyabandara, 7.2 ov), 3-21 (Kamindu Mendis, 10.4 ov), 4-47 (Lahiru Udara Igalagamage, 21.4 ov), 5-142 (Dhananjaya de Silva, 55.2 ov), 6-156 (Niroshan Dickwella, 59.6 ov), 7-199 (Sonal Dinusha, 75.1 ov), 8-199 (Prabath Jayasuriya, 75.2 ov), 9-199 (Lahiru Kumara, 75.6 ov), 10-206 (Keshara Nuwantha, 77.4 ov)	
BOWLING: Mohammed Siraj 9-2-15-1; Manav Suthar 23-4-2-55-6; Prasidh Krishna 10-3-16-2; Ravindra Jadeja 23-3-71-1; Kuldeep Yadav 11-0-38-0; Devdutt Padikkal 1-0-5-0	

peach, little did India know they had to work so hard for this win. When it comes to batting in the second innings, the Sri Lanka captain is the only subcontinent batsman to have an average over 50. So when it comes to applying himself on a deteriorating pitch, Sri Lanka could bank on De Silva. Of course, the win was far out of their sight.

Hard toil

But right through the stand, the approach from De Silva (59) and Dinusha (84), who were unfortunate not to end up with a century in each innings, didn't enter a shell. They were not going in search of boundaries either to put pressure on India's attack. But they found a middle ground - rotate the strike and not allow the spinners the opportunity to tie one of them at one end. It meant the trio of Suthar, Jadeja and Kuldeep had to keep switching their angles and lines.

With the pitch getting further slower, to their credit, both Suthar and Jadeja showed the patience that the conditions demanded. It was always

going to be a matter of one wicket, and it was De Silva who went back kicking the turf.

Right through his knock, he had shown restraint when it came to picking the right deliveries to sweep.

But sweeping ones in the line of stumps, particularly from the only rough patch on the pitch, brings its own risk

into play. And as soon as he swept Jadeja from the line of stumps, he knew the writing on the wall was getting clearer. The lone remaining threat for India was the unpredictable Niroshan Dickwella, who had scored 80 in the first essay, curbing his natural instinct to a large extent.

Here, with a game to save,

more than Prasidh Krishna, it was Yashasvi Jaiswal who ensured his stay was short.

As Prasidh was tempting to take on the short ball, Dickwella was hesitant at first before Jaiswal urged him to take on. It was a fun banter, but one ended up with Dickwella making room and trying to slash Prasidh over covers, only to nick to Rishabh Pant. The laughter said it all.

Thereafter, Dinusha, in the company of Keshara Nuwantha, frustrated India again, adding 43 off 91 deliveries as the lunch break arrived at the right time for the visitors. And once they came back after the break, Suthar wrapped up India's 600th Test with a win in the space of 16 deliveries.

First he had Dinusha caught at leg-slip; with extra bounce, he generated the key. Off the next delivery, he cleaned up Prabath Jayasuriya's stumps before finishing that over with his second five-wicket haul. Having picked up four in the first innings, Suthar castled Nuwantha as India took a crucial step in the direction of qualifying for the World Test Championship final.

Robinson rips through Pakistan in Headingley Test

Associated Press
Leeds, August 19

SEAMER OLLIE Robinson made another dramatic return for England as he hammered the Pakistan top order on the first day of the test series on Wednesday at Headingley. Pakistan was collapsing at 150-7 at tea after an extended three-hour session due to the morning cut short by rain.

Robinson took out four of the top five batters - all bowled or unassisted - including a

wicket with the first ball of the three-match series.

He had 4-39 from 16 overs in his first test since June at Lord's, where he took a match-winning 7-77 against New Zealand and in his first test in two years. A knee injury and doubts about his fitness prevented his return in that series that England lost.

The other three wickets were grabbed by Josh Tongue, who broke Pakistan's biggest partnership then, right on tea, dismissed interim captain Salman Agha and Ali Usman in

consecutive deliveries. Tea was immediately called, delaying Tongue's hat trick ball.

Featuring in a four-prong pace attack, Robinson made a sensational start when he pinned Azan Awaiz first ball with a nip-backer from around the wicket. Then he went over the wicket and trapped Shan Masood.

Only 9.4 overs into the game, rain forced a delay of two hours.

Abdullah Shafiq and Imam, together from 6-2, endured a

cautious return in the afternoon and gradually became comfortable enough to push the run rate.

But after 91 runs together, Imam drove at a wide ball by Tongue and nicked to second slip. Walking off with 42, Imam castized himself. From 97-2, Pakistan lost five wickets for 53 runs.

After Shafique brought up his 13th fifty-plus score from 82 balls, Saud Shakeel was given out lbw to Robinson by umpire Allahuddin Paleker, who took his time. Shakeel also took his time to review the decision and

was timed out by umpire Chris Gaffaney. Video showed the ball missing the top of leg stump.

Shafique departed soon after, for 61, bowled by Robinson, who by then had wicket-keeper Jamie Smith standing up to the stumps for added pressure. In the last five minutes before tea, Tongue bowled Agha and Usman.

BRIEF SCORES: Pakistan 150/7 (Abdullah Shafique 61; Ollie Robinson 4/39) in 44.4 overs vs England at Tea on Day 1.

SRI LANKA VS INDIA: FIRST TEST

India toil, then triumph in Galle

With an arm-ball in his repertoire, Suthar is a genuine threat

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 19

LEFT-ARM-SPINNER Manav Suthar's long-time coach Dheeraj Sharma had a simple piece of advice for him ahead of the first Test against Sri Lanka in Galle. His message was short: "Keep attacking the stumps."

The Galle pitch had turn, but patience and consistency were non-negotiable for bowlers. Dheeraj wanted Suthar, playing only his second Test but with 33 First-Class matches under his belt, to force a batsman into making mistakes. "Only if he plays, will the batsman make mistakes," Dheeraj told *The Indian Express* from Sri Ganganagar district in Rajasthan. The 24-year-old returned figures of 10/131, with six of these wickets coming in Sri Lanka's second innings as India won by 165 runs. In two Tests, Suthar has two six-wicket hauls — the first coming against Afghanistan on his debut in June. For someone who is being looked at as Ravindra Jadeja's eventual replacement, Suthar's success bodes well for India.

"They (team) had put their trust in him. If he didn't get wickets, then questions would be raised. We knew he didn't have many wickets (domestic cricket) to show. But what we did together was to ensure he was ready to play in any condition. Our target was when an opportunity comes, make the most out of it. And for that we had been busy since the off-season," Dheeraj said.

For a spinner who predominantly delivered the ball with the seam facing the first slip, there were concerns if batsmen would be able to pick him from the hand easily. Over the course of this Test, Suthar showed he had a bag of tricks. At times, he delivered with the seam facing the square and more importantly showed he can deliver an arm ball. It is a delivery he has been working a lot.

A left-spinner with a straighter one makes life hard for batsmen. "Personally, I was so happy with the three wickets which came off the straighter one. Because, we have been working on it for a while," Dheeraj said.

Since Rahul Dravid's tenure as coach, Suthar has been on the radar of the selectors and the team management. But playing for Rajasthan, a team that hasn't been in the top bracket of Ranji Trophy, Suthar didn't have compelling numbers. At different times, different selectors have taken note of his ability to be effective on green tops, slow decks, raging turners and flat pitches. Gautam Gambhir & Co. put their faith in him.

When the selectors picked Suthar, they had a plan of India



Left-arm spinner Manav Suthar had figures of 10/131. CREIMAS

“We knew he didn't have many wickets (domestic cricket) to show. But what we did together was to ensure he was ready to play in any condition. Our target was when an opportunity comes, make most out of it.”

DHEERAJ SHARMA,
MANAV SUTHAR'S COACH

having a settled spin combo by the time of the next Border-Gavaskar Trophy at home early next year. Against Afghanistan, Suthar showed glimpses of his talent. And at Galle, he outshined not just his teammates Jadeja and Kuldeep Yadav, but also the main home spinner Prabath Jayasuriya. Suthar has everything that makes him a classical, old-school spinner, but inexperience couldn't be overlooked.

"With the wicket being on the slower side, we just discussed about finding that one spot from where you can keep attacking. And given his hip movement and the balance, we knew that if we kept bowling on the full length, he has more chance of succeeding because he was getting more turn than the rest and he extracts bounce with his high-arm release," Dheeraj said.

Arm speed

KL Rahul, who got to witness it all from the first slip, had a good idea of what a batsman was up against. "It's the subtle variations. The same actions, the same angles. Without changing his arm speed, he's able to bowl slower, and with the same arm speed, he's able to bowl quicker as well. Sometimes the angles, especially in the air, when the wind was blowing from one side, he used that drift really well here in Galle, and from there the ball straightens or comes in. Just using subtle variations, he's able to do that through the day," he said after the match.

Kyrgios suspended after testing positive for cocaine

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 19

NICK KYRGIOS has been provisionally suspended from tennis after testing positive for cocaine, with the Australian acknowledging that he made a "huge mistake" and taking full responsibility for the violation.

In a statement posted on Instagram, Kyrgios apologised to his fans, family, sponsors and those close to him. He also expressed particular regret over the example his actions could set for young supporters.

"I made a huge mistake, and I take full responsibility for it," Kyrgios wrote. The Australian said the past few years, during which persistent knee and wrist injuries have severely limited his career, had taken a significant toll on him mentally and physically. "My body hasn't been able to do what my mind expects it to do. None of that excuses what I did," he wrote.



Nick Kyrgios. REUTERS

He added that he would step away from social media and public life for 28 days to focus on his well-being.

Kyrgios submitted a sample during the Mallorca Open on June 22 that was found to contain benzoyllecgonine, a metabolite of cocaine. A WADA-accredited laboratory confirmed the finding on July 17.

● CHASING NORMS, BREAKING NORMS

Chess prodigy Deekshitha's father starts crowdfunding

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, August 19

IT'S BEEN a week since Deekshitha Modipalli made heads turn in the world of chess, with a rating jump of 484 Elo points over the course of a month that also lifted her world rank by 29,200 spots. Her results, across just four tournaments, also earned her an International Master norm, opening new ambitions for the 14-year-old.

But in the days after that rise, reality followed. The costs of keeping it going had gone up just as fast. Her gains came over the course of one trip to Europe. To keep raising her rating and picking up the norms she needs, she'll need several more such trips. So her father, M Sheshadri Nayudu, decided to try crowdfunding to help fund her path toward becoming an International Master, and perhaps, eventually, a grandmaster.

Sheshadri, an IT professional from Hampapuram vil-

lage in Andhra Pradesh's Anantapur district, started the campaign on Ketto four days ago. With donations from 14 supporters so far, the family has raised Rs 51,000 toward a target of Rs 15 lakh, set over 45 days.

On the campaign page, Sheshadri broke the target down: Rs 4 lakh for coaching and training fees, Rs 3 lakh for accommodation, Rs 2 lakh for airfare, Rs 2 lakh for tournament preparation, Rs 2 lakh for food and other travel expenses, Rs 1 lakh for tournament entry fees, Rs 50,000 for local transport, and Rs 30,000 for visas.

The plan is to use the funds raised to sponsor a couple of tournament trips to Europe. Deekshitha is already headed to Turkey soon, for two back-to-back tournaments. Beyond that, if she is to reach the level her family and coach, Krishna Teja, believe she's capable of, considerably more will be needed.

Crowdfunding remains a route rarely taken in Indian



Deekshitha's family is trying to raise Rs 15 lakh. Leca Open

chess. Ethan Vaz, who went on to become India's 96th grandmaster, international master Muhammad Imran, and Woman Candidate Master Shivamshika G, have all attempted it before. "Over the past week, despite all the headlines, no one has contacted me from the government or from

private sponsors. In the past, I had seen a few players try out fundraising through various platforms. So I decided this could be an option," Sheshadri told *The Indian Express*.

It's a hard truth of Indian chess that sponsors tend to gravitate toward established super-GMs, who often already

receive "conditions" from tournament organisers, waived entry fees, boarding and lodging covered, sometimes flights too, and appearance fees in certain cases. It's the players still chasing rating and norms through open tournaments in Europe who have to fund all of it themselves.

Cost of ascend

Any player looking to move up from the 2200-rating range needs top-tier coaches, where costs are often billed hourly rather than as a flat fee. Sheshadri said that until a certain level, he had paid an annual coaching fee. As his daughter's rating rose, that shifted to an hourly rate.

Deekshitha's coach, international master Krishna Teja, said Sheshadri's Rs 15 lakh target is the bare minimum, with little room to spare.

"The ideal budget for any prodigy chasing norms and rating gains is around Rs 25 to 30 lakh annually. That would be the scenario where the player

BWF WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Lollipop low lifts lay Lakshya low against unknown American

Indian beaten by 18-year-old Tan in a display that left coach Vimal Kumar saying ‘there’s no excuse’

Shivani Naik
New Delhi, August 19

SAIPAN, FULLERTON, Aguascalientes, Lima, Sao Paulo, Uppsala, Markham, Jotunhallen, Council Bluffs, San Salvador. These are some of the venues where American teenager Garret Tan, who defeated Lakshya Sen at his first-ever World Championships, has been plodding away, playing lower-level tournaments.

The 18-year-old has no fixed training base and no permanent coach. He moves to and from Taiwan, camping at his grandparents' because quality sparring is difficult to get in California. Tan isn't even firmwed up yet on singles and won the mixed doubles at Junior All England.

His childhood coach Paula Lynn travelled to Delhi to sit for his matches at his debut Worlds. Fellow American shuttler Lauren Lam completed an all-women coaching bench, with his mother helping out with assorted support, while he evicted the big Indian hope, ranked 14th, 19-21, 21-19, 21-17, sending shockwaves through the arena.

The next generation isn't creeping up on Sen. They are at his throat. His potential roadblocks were expected to be batchmate Kunlavut Vitidsarn (25) or junior Alex Lanier (22). Not Tan, who played the World Juniors in Guwahati last October and put the twice All England finalist through the wringer.

There were no glaring injury concerns for Sen, though the shoulder was strapped like



Lakshya Sen lost 21-19, 19-21, 17-21 to American Garret Tan in the second round. PTI

usual. He had trained for a week in Guwahati, though on this day, it wasn't the drift that messed up his judgment. It was his wobbly confidence, and wrecked intent.

Tan plays the typical doubles player's aggressive ambush - a whacking smash when he's offered the length to hit. It's not Sen's favourite style to tackle, but it's nothing he hasn't doused before.

What was inexplicable was Sen offering his rookie opponent lollipop low lifts - the length so short that he contributed to his own downfall. "There is no excuse for this performance," coach Vimal Kumar would say. Sen simply couldn't close out the match in two games, as he repeatedly blun-

dered through rushed brawny rallies, prolonging which would've given him the space to bring his brains to the table.

Familiar failing

Vimal had been peeved by Sen's approach in Round 1 too, in which he dropped the opening game. On Wednesday after he was edged out 21-19 in the second, it was assumed he would blitz past Tan in the decider, once sides changed. But it was never about the drift.

The short lifts were such a tactical trip-up that the passive, pensive, ponderous Sen stood no chance as long as he was serving them up as if he was Tan's junior sparrer. They betrayed a crisis of confidence, as he looked like he was in no

mood to grit it out in rallies. Sen simply gets bogged down when he runs into anyone with a half-decent power-attack. He has the mind, the manipulation smarts, the montage of tricks to outlast the best. But he seems to tie in his game's self-worth to muscle, like he's some gym-bro.

It meant if he couldn't match Tan in style and swagger, he wouldn't put in the court mileage to get under the shuttle and belt the downward shots. If he was on a wrestling mat, he would've been warned for passivity, such was his phlegmatic play.

Tan, an unusually tall Asian-American, who has been in the habit of asking his coach many questions since he was

young, happily took the initiative and went the distance.

Sen restored parity by winning the second game with a start-to-finish lead. But it still went to 21-19. Later, Sen would say he was always playing catch-up.

"Always covering the leads, and under pressure. He was solid on the attack game," the Indian would say.

Change of plan

If only Sen had known that Tan had his return tickets booked for Friday - Thursday mostly penciled in for Qutub Minar and Janpath - and paced himself better and calmly. When his reflexive defence came under heavy shelling, Sen folded. Yet again. Just like he did against Viktor Axelsen and Lee Zii Jia at the Olympics and Lin Chun Yi at All England.

In the decider, he fell to a 4-12 deficit. One would back Sen to rumble back. And he did till 10-13. But the aggressive gear kicked in far too late, far too desperately. The American women had done a smart SWAT on Sen - given the Indian puts pressure on opponents with his explosive stomp from the front court, using his half-smashes and net tricks, he needed to be pinned to the backline.

All Tan did was keep ping-pong tosses and clears to Sen's forehand back corner - where countless upstarts have fancied their chances to bury him.

What sets him apart as a shuttler not to be trifled with is how Tan switched up his attack zone when Sen cut the lead to 16-18. "Last couple of points I changed my flank," he would disclose.

A slide in defence saw Tan glide out, checked out by the doctor for concussion. What was unmissable though was Sen sitting down panting heavily himself. He played a disastrous floater to go 16-19 down. Tan wrapped up with two slashing smashes. Sen wasn't even in the same frame.



Harmanpreet Singh (L) and Abhishek Nain scored two goals each. HOCKEY INDIA

India beat Pakistan 5-3 in a game far messier than the scoreline suggests

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 19

FOR A while, it looked as if India might make a mockery of the occasion. Then, Pakistan made a mess of the script.

India were 3-0 up. Then 4-1. Twice they appeared to have done enough to drain the life out of Pakistan's World Cup hopes. Twice Pakistan came roaring back. By the time the final whistle went at the Wagerer Stadium, India had won 5-3 and booked their place in the next phase. But the eight-goal scoreline concealed a much tighter, much messier contest.

Pakistan had arrived with their World Cup survival on the line. India needed only a draw to progress. It was Pakistan, though, who succeeded in dictating the mood of the match.

India began like a team that knew exactly what it wanted. A good measure of their comfort on the field was how easily they switched to the aerial game. Against England, India had to wait till the fourth quarter for Harmanpreet Singh to launch his first overhead pass.

On Wednesday, they had done it four times in the first five minutes, a sign of how well, and how deep, India had positioned themselves into the Pakistan half, cutting their midfield out of the game entirely. India moved the ball with purpose, attacked the circle and opened up a 3-0 lead, with a brace from Harmanpreet (5', 21') and a field goal from Abhishek Nain (11'). Pakistan looked close to being overwhelmed.

But Pakistan had little reason to play cautiously. Defeat meant elimination. They attacked with the desperation of a team with nothing left to protect, and slowly turned the match into something India did not want it to become.

The structure began to fray. Possession changed hands rapidly.

Attacks became more direct. Defensive errors crept in. Pakistan found goals and, with them, belief. That was the first significant victory for Pakistan: not on the scoreboard, but in changing the nature of the contest. India

Pool D

	P	W	D	L	GD	Pts
England	3	3	0	0	11	9
India	3	2	0	1	2	6
Wales	3	0	1	1	-5	1
Pakistan	3	0	1	1	-8	1

Women face England, eyes spot in next round

The Indian women's team will look to seal a place in the second round when they take on a desperate England in their final Pool D match on Thursday. A draw will be enough for India to progress as pool toppers. India and China are locked on four points each, but India sit atop the pool on a superior goal difference, having scored eight goals and conceded three. England, on three points, have no such cushion and need a victory to keep their campaign alive. PTI

LIVE ON Star Sports Network and JioHotstar, 6.30pm

had started the game as the more polished team. Pakistan made it a fight.

The scoreline tells the story, but not quite the right one.

A frenetic three minutes and 53 seconds in the second quarter resembled two heavyweights trading blows and refusing to get knocked out. Harmanpreet scored India's third with the clock at 20:07. Shahid Hannan pulled one back for Pakistan at 21:55. A minute later, Abhishek scored his second to restore India's three-goal cushion, but 48 seconds after that, Sufyan Khan dragged Pakistan back into the contest with a fierce drag-flick.

At 4-2, the game was suddenly alive in a way that had seemed impossible half an hour earlier.

It was chaotic, occasionally untidy and utterly compelling.

For India, there was an uncomfortable familiarity to it. They had surrendered a half-time lead against England in their previous match. Here, they had twice built what looked like commanding advantages, only to find Pakistan breathing down their necks again.

Yet this time there was a difference. India did not panic. They found one more goal, through Hardik Singh, finally putting enough daylight between themselves and Pakistan to close the door. The result was continued dominance over their neighbours, and a spot in

the next phase of the World Cup. But this was hardly a stroll.

Fortunately for Craig Fulton's side, Harmanpreet seems to have hit his stride. Through all the noise, the captain remained the constant. He has spent much of the build-up to this World Cup carrying the weight of expectation that comes with being India's most feared penalty-corner weapon. On an afternoon when India needed somebody to restore order every time Pakistan threatened to take control, he repeatedly provided it.

Harmanpreet's value isn't simply measured in the goals he scores. It's the sense of security he gives India when a match begins to slip beyond their control. He ventured forward, created attacking opportunities, converted penalty corners, and absorbed moments of pressure.

If Pakistan succeeded in pulling India into their game, frantic, emotional, unpredictable, played at a pace that made every mistake feel dangerous, Harmanpreet kept India from being consumed by it.

India will take the 5-3 victory, the points and the passage into the next round. But they will also take a warning. At a World Cup, giving a team as desperate as Pakistan a way back from 3-0 and 4-1 is dangerous business. India survived it.

The Netherlands, India's likely opponents on Saturday, might not be so forgiving.

Sindhu and Ayush have easy day, tough one ahead

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, August 19

AYUSH SHETTY and PV Sindhu took a combined 61 minutes to finish their matches on a day when a lot of contests went to three games, with Anders Antonsen and Nhat Nguyen engaging in a 102-minute battle.

It was in the best interests of the two Indian star shuttlers to have short matches, given the opponents they will be facing in the next round of the Badminton World Championships.

Sindhu - who defeated Wen Yu Zhang of Canada 21-16, 21-17 - will be up against World No.3 Wang Zhi Yi. The Chinese leads the head-to-head 5-3 and has won their last three meetings. However, Sindhu prevailed when they met at last year's World Championships.

"It will be difficult. When we are playing top athletes, we can't expect easy matches or easy points," Sindhu said after

her match on Wednesday. "We know each other's games. I need to play my game and give my best." Sindhu, who recently won the Japan Open Super 750 title, has an 8-0 record against Chinese shuttlers at the World Championships.

"Pressure will always be there. Expectations will always be there. In such a game, one needs to be adaptable to the conditions. If one plan is not working, go for the other one and make a comeback," she said.

The conditions at the Indira Gandhi stadium have been tricky this week but Sindhu will have the advantage of playing in front of a home crowd.

"Today, I felt the court was different from the first day. According to my understanding, there were some unforced errors where I was hitting side-outs. That's what I felt. Going into tomorrow's match, I need to focus on playing my best, playing a safe game and being consistent," the double Olymp-



PV Sindhu defeated Canada's Wen Yu Zhang 21-16, 21-17. PTI

pic medallist explained.

During the pre-tournament interaction, Wang had said that familiarity with Sindhu's game will be helpful for her if the two faced off. "She is coming on the back of the Japan Open win and we have shared many

The conditions at the IG stadium have been tricky this week but Sindhu will have the advantage of playing in front of a home crowd

duels in the past. I know her game and will just focus on being better than her," the Chinese had said.

Wang also had an easy encounter as she defeated Letshanaa Karupathevan of Malaysia 21-16, 21-9 in 42 minutes.

With Unnati Hooda losing to Michelle Li 21-11, 9-21, 21-23, Sindhu remains the only Indian left in the women's singles draw.

Familiar foe

Ayush, who stunned World No.1 Shi Yuqi of China in the first round, wrapped up his match against Dumindu Abey-

wickrama of Sri Lanka 21-8, 21-10 in 26 minutes. "It was a breather as compared to the previous game. I have played him in the past, so I just wanted to test some of my shots," Ayush said after his win.

In the next round, he will face 11th seed Alwi Farhan of Indonesia and it is not going to be an easy outing for him.

The duo have come up against each other four times at the senior level and the head-to-head is tied at 2-2.

"I have played Alwi in the past and we are familiar with each other's games. It is not going to be easy for me. I am counting on my confidence and the crowd's support," the Indian said.

The two last met at the China Open Super 1000, with Ayush coming out on top. However, ranked 12 in the world, Alwi is one of the best Indonesian shuttlers in recent times and his stock is rising with consistent performance at the elite level.

{ FROM THE SIDELINES }

‘Every sport is going green & badminton going plastic’: Debate over new shuttles

Shivani Naik
New Delhi, August 19

MIXED DOUBLES shuttler Marvin Seidel plays Bashminton to unwind. The toy set with oversized racquets and a crazy-ball shuttle bird ends up with wild trajectories. Not in his wildest, did he imagine that a synthetic shuttle or a hybrid might actually make its way onto a real badminton court, where he is a former European champion.

A promotional event for the experimental synthetic birds that the Badminton World Federation is looking to introduce in the future, saw Seidel toss them around for 30 odd minutes. His feedback? "It's fine. The sound it makes is a little off compared to feather shuttles. And you have to adjust to spin because it tumbles longer," he



said after his mixed doubles loss at the Delhi Badminton World Championships, even as he anticipates them being unrolled sooner than in the next five years.

But sitting in Germany, Seidel processed the shortage of feather shuttles last summer and the increase in prices of shuttle tubes as something of an artificially created crisis. "Perhaps due to monopolies," he ventures.



Without digital advertising, volunteers turn physical boards mid-match to give each sponsor air time. EXPRESS PHOTO

The shortages stemmed from China's changed dietary preferences - duck to chicken, whose ripple effect saw a shortage of geese feathers and a 300% rise in shuttle costs.

Even as feather shuttles need substitutes for the sport to

stay sustainable, Seidel flags a larger long-term concern. "The whole world and every sport is going green, and badminton is going plastic! I don't see the benefit of mass plastic usage. After one use they will just be lying somewhere because



plastic can't be recycled. I think we are shooting ourselves in the foot," he added.

The German badminton federation approved of synthetics earlier this year, and at the German Open, top players ended up playing a 'triple format' - a three-

a-side as demonstration on the day of the semifinals.

The synthetics, still being tested, but almost inevitable in coming years, aren't exactly widely available, which brings skepticism about them being adopted. Pitched to replace the

feathers for their durability and with the geese feathers becoming scarce, the synth is raising a fundamental question - is badminton really on the path to being sustainable?

Surfeit of sponsors sees ad board rotations

There are no digital advertising boards at Delhi's Badminton World's HQ and the Delhi Worlds don't have a title sponsor. But the Badminton World Federation has invited a surfeit of secondary sponsors for their mega spectacle in India, numbering 16 at least. It also means there are limited spots on the court, with 14 boards visible on broadcast cameras at any given point. It's why a mid-match manual

switch of boards happens.

Two volunteers lift the A-board and invert the side which has two distinct names on the two sides of the triangular boards. The initial plan was to dim the lights at the 11-point mark and switch like a stage play set prop. But the organisers have refused risking electric malfunctions by turning lights off and on. "We switch the boards after every game," BAI secretary Sanjay Mishra explained. It happens when cameras are on the mid-match parleys between coach and player, allowing volunteers to turn boards around. Badminton court aesthetic barely helps back boards register, but if you notice revolving sponsor names, there's a rehearsed manual switch happening in this low-tech sport.

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